Transformation: A Unifying Vision of the Church's Mission

Edited by

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Foreword

by

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FOREWORD

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During the past three years, hundreds of Christian leaders have been preparing for the 2004 Forum on World Evangelization. The leaders of the 2004 Forum have been led by the Spirit to identify 31 major issues facing the Church in the mission of world evangelization as we enter the 21st century. These include both major opportunities and obstacles that are before us at this vitally important time in the history of the Church.

At the same time, Dr. Luis Bush, Dr. Wilbert Shenk of Fuller Seminary and scores of other Christian leaders from throughout the world have been laboring on a parallel track in cooperation with the 2004 Forum leaders. This band of the Lord's servants have been conducting a World Inquiry involving almost 7000 Christian leaders in some 850 cities from scores of nations around the world.

The major focus of these World Inquiry gatherings has been the question, "What is the Spirit of God saying to His Church at the beginning of the 21st Century though His servants?" The results of the World Inquiry complements and supplements the issues being considered by the 2004 Forum on World Evangelization.

The specific findings of the World Inquiry have been compiled in six volumes. This particular volume focuses upon the discovery and identification of significant transformation movements in many cities and communities in a number of nations from around the world.

In a real sense, this book issues a trumpet call for Christians around the world to become involved in personal and societal transformation by our Lord Jesus Christ through His Body – the Church – in the power of the Holy Spirit to the Glory of God the Father resulting in blessing to the nations of the world.

We are indebted to our brother, Dr. Luis Bush, for facilitating this important initiative and for authoring this volume. I pray that this book, that includes articles by a number of highly respected Christian leaders from various disciplines and denominations of Christ's Church, will be a source of help and encouragement to all who read it.

By God's grace, I pray that we would be not mere "readers" of these pages but "doers" of all that God is calling us to do to advance His mission around the world. And I pray that we may do so through every means that He is providing in order that men, women, young

people, children, families, local churches, cities and communities and even nations may be spiritually transformed by the love and grace of our Lord Jesus Christ and by the power of the Holy Spirit.

PREFACE

Jesus said to his followers, in reference to God the Father: "Seek first his kingdom and his righteousness" (Mt. 6:33a). Seeking the Kingdom of God results in personal and cultural transformation which has emerged as a unifying vision for the mission of the Church at the beginning of the twenty-first century.[1] God is on a mission of transformation. A global transformation movement has begun. It's God's movement. This book reports on some of the contributions, the considerations, the context and conclusions regarding *transformation as mission.*

The thesis of this book is that God is calling His servants to act as catalysts in mobilizing the whole body of Christ to bless the nations through the transformation of people, churches and culture.

Almost three years ago I began a *journey in the listening mode.* The World Inquiry, short for *Evangelizing our World Inquiry*, was born out of a simple desire to hear what God was saying to his people. An e-mail in August of 2000 from Paul McKaughan, President of the Evangelical Fellowship of Mission Agencies, prompted me to embark on this quest by a personal e-mail when he wrote:

> I don't know of any time in my 35 years of mission experience that I have seen or felt mission executives more ready and willing to change and adapt. At the same time, I also don't know of any period in my career that there is less certainty about what changes to make. The future is uncertain. We know it will be greatly different but are not sure in which ways it will be different. We know that the patterns of the past are showing "wear" and are in need of repair. In many ways the fit between our strategies and way of thinking does not fit our present reality well. We know that they probably won't move us into the future God has for us. Yet the new paradigms that help us interpret and organize our strategies for the future have not become clear. We seem to be in a time of parenthesis between what God blessed in the past and what He has not yet made clear for the future.

The interest in taking "the journey of the listening mode" was further enhanced during the final months of the year 2000. An abiding question in my own mind was: *Where do we go from here in world evangelization?* The encouragement of my fifteen-year accountability/support group led me to reflect on this question by means of a doctoral study at the former Fuller School of World Mission, now School of Intercultural Studies (Fuller) under the active and able oversight of Wilbert Shenk, Chuck Van Engen and Sherwood

Lingenfelter. While looking through the lenses of the Scriptures, theology, missiologists, church history, global mission conferences, the AD2000 Movement and Christian leadership, it soon became clear that the focus of the dissertation, which was completed May 2002, would more appropriately be on informing the question, rather than seeking to provide answers.

And so began a quest to know the mind of God through the burdens, visions and dreams of his people as we move into the future. A World Inquiry compressed the reflective process into a practical instrument. The World Inquiry started out as an exercise to probe the minds and hearts of evangelical leaders in the major cities of the world. The Inquiry began and has continued not as a rigorous, methodologically-driven research project, but rather a "listening venture" that sought to tune in to God's voice through His people—especially those voices and leaders who are now emerging onto their local, regional and national scenes in the Two-Thirds World. I was reminded of the words of John Stott in his book titled: *Christian Mission in the Modern World*, "Life is a pilgrimage of learning, a voyage of discovery, in which our mistaken views are corrected, our distorted notions adjusted, our shallow opinions deepened and some of our vast ignorances diminished."[2]

As we listened to one another and sought God through His Word to hear what the Spirit was saying to the Church, we saw streams of church and mission emerging on the periphery of mainline ecclesiastical and mission structures; we shared the visions on the hearts of God's servants; and we heard from respected missiologists as to what fresh missiological paradigms are emerging.

Fuller Theological Seminary sponsored the World Inquiry, providing advice at various stages of the research, design and conduct of the inquiry process. It was conducted in collaboration with the Lausanne Committee on World Evangelization, with a view to a presentation of the findings at this World Evangelization Issues Forum. This brings this journey of the listening mode through the World Inquiry to an end. The preliminary findings were presented, reviewed and discussed in May 2003 in Seoul, Korea by an International Coalition of 120 missiologists, practitioners, and church and mission leaders chaired by Sang-Bok David Kim.

Purpose of Inquiry

The purpose of the World Inquiry was to listen to hear and look for expressions of the *missio Dei*[3] (the mission of God). In using the term *missio Dei* the emphasis was on the perfectly pure motive and essence of the mission of God, or that which finds its root and foundation in the character of God. We sought to listen to what God is doing and saying by collecting insights, beliefs, and attitudes with regard to:

- The people and the programs God is using;
- The challenges to God's mission via factors external to the churches;
- The obstacles internal to the churches;
- What God is calling us to as the body of Christ;
- What services can a global structure committed to world evangelization can offer;
- The identification of a compelling, unifying paradigm; and
- The identification of emerging leaders, and of streams of church and mission.

People to be Listened to

The emergence of Christian leadership in Africa, Asia, and Latin America, combined with the initiative towards world evangelization efforts over the last twenty-five years of the twentieth century from these regions, demanded that their ideas help shape the direction of world evangelization in the twenty-first century. It is clear that many wish to do so; the question is how to help catalyze the true reflective inputs and resultant directions.

One of the major trends is the "Shift in geographical and vital center of gravity of the Church from the West and North to the East and South." Out of this new spiritual nerve center, initiative for world mission has grown exponentially. "As Christianity has globalized, indigenous missions have sprung up around the world."[4] The Christian mission and church leaders from all around the world express their view of what the Spirit is saying to the Church at this time. However, more than ever before that expression is coming from Asia, Africa and Latin America:

In light of the fact that the Christian majority is now to be found outside the West and missionary initiatives from the churches of Asia, Africa, and Latin America are at the cutting-edge of the Christian world mission, we must ask: What kind of theology of mission will best serve the global Christian mission in the future? What fresh theological resources can be brought to bear on this new phase of the Christian mission?[5]

The active participation of Christian leaders from the world in shaping twenty-first century world evangelization initiatives is crucial for this Inquiry. Almost 7,000 Christian church and mission leaders from more than 800 cities. Of the total people involved, more than 90% were from the Majority World.[6]

We were watching to see whether a fresh missiology would emerge that both deepened and extended our witness through the Gospel. We prayed that information might mesh with relationships of the broader world community to foster increased evangelization, so that there can be a significant advance in the Christian Movement over the next quarter-century.

Process of Inquiry — a Personal Interpretation

The World Inquiry process can by illustrated from the remarks of Richard Howell, the General Secretary of the Evangelical Fellowship of India. The commentary reflects Howell's own perceptions in the third week of a month-long series of sixteen inquiries in India. It came in the context of Richard waiting for a delayed flight from Calcutta to go to the thirteenth major city inquiry in India on Jan 22, 2003.

The Inquiry process, starting January 6, 2003 to the present day, has confirmed God's timing. I have seen this to be a timing of God for India. Personally, the different streams have converged in my life through the Inquiry process to give me a more integrated view of ministry, in my personal life and at a conceptual level. It has clarified how to implement the vision. It has also shown me there is no need for polarities that are man-made primarily because our vision is small.

If the vision is of God and His Kingdom, then the process of renewing is unleashed. God has opened my eyes to something very wonderful—His Kingdom—which I have preached before and struggled over in the past. The unfolding of it will still take time—but the journey for me has begun.

Looking back, I can interpret recent ministerial developments, talking to people of other faiths, relationship with ecumenicals and Catholics—this process has helped to interpret the meaning of these developments. There is definitely a personal renewal deep down. God has touched the core of my being. It was seeing what happened in the inquiries in Ludhiana, then Chandigarh, where I became a convert to this. It got a hold of me. It came from people. The baby was born. It has been one reconfirmation after another.

The day before yesterday, it was Serrampore, at the college that William Carey founded. There were 50 involved in the Inquiry including the Principal, VP, faculty of the seminary, pastors and Christian leaders in the community, and the graduating class of the seminary. The principal kept saying, "This is the kind of meeting I had been hoping to have for a long time." Amazingly, with such a varied group present, in part because of the minority they are as Christians in the Serampore city, a definitive city-based initiative birthed with vision statement, mission statement, and core group, including representation of all the constituencies present at the meeting.

Yesterday we had the Kolcata event despite the visit of the President of India into the city.

Several of the key leaders had indicated they were going to stay for one half-day. In the

end, they stayed through to 4 p.m., and with deep conviction, a city-based initiative was birthed with ten in the core group.

It is the birthing of a vision for cities that will bring focus and integration for doing mission in the cities. It will be a movement of transformation that will bring the various streams together in partnership to impact the cities and the nation.

It is the mission in the cities that will also have a ripple effect into the towns and villages. I am excited, really excited, for the impact on the evangelical movement—and more so because the ecumenical church is looking to the evangelical church for the spiritual vitality to transform the ecumenical churches and leadership itself. So what I am talking about is that this new movement will lead to renewal.

When I say *it is birthing,* I refer to the Inquiry process which is bringing together a wide range of Christian leadership in the cities; and the initiative is birthing in the broader base of the Christian church in India. The need for transformation, the need for vision and united prayer, has been stated in the Inquiry focus groups. The issue is not only the transformation of the city as the goal; it's the transformation of the churches going on at the same time.

The Church in India is all saying it needs transformation, and what is emerging has the potential of bringing dramatic transformation to the Church. The vision is broadening the base of church/mission leader involvement, while at the same time calling for and igniting a spirit of renewal. It is not only the city and the Church that needs transformation—it is the Christian leader and his family and other Christians that do.

Paradigm Emerging

As reported and extensively discussed at the World Inquiry International Coalition preliminary findings event in Seoul in May 2003, *mission as transformation* emerged out of the review of the results of the five different lenses used in the World Inquiry process to discern *missio Dei*. These lenses were

- The more structured quantitative survey of individuals and the qualitative survey of focus group;
- Forty-eight documented emerging streams of church and mission, presented for the most part by the author/leader of that stream in Seoul;
- The reflection of respected missiologists on the world, by Delia Nuetsch Olver; the church, by Wilbert Shenk; and her mission in the world, by Rene Padilla;
- The burden and vision on the hearts of God's servants in many places; plus

- The city-based action plans that emerged in the Inquiry consultations in sixteen cities in India. India Evangelical Fellowship Secretary Richard Howell made the statement at the conclusion of the first phase of inquiries in that country: "A national transformation movement has begun in India." In this instance leaders from different traditions and ethnic backgrounds who conducted the survey responded immediately to the consensual transformational vision of the group and determined to take action based upon that common vision.

All five lenses used in the World Inquiry process showed that *mission as transformation* has emerged as a new compelling, unifying paradigm at the beginning of the twenty-first century. *Mission as transformation* is built upon four foundational pillars of truth. First, we are living in a broken world; second, individuals are being called to be conformed to the image of Christ; third, churches are being challenged to be renewed and reformed to align with God's greater purposes; and fourth, cities, communities, peoples and nations are being transformed.

This book is the final of six books reporting on the outcomes based on the different lenses through which the World Inquiry was conducted. All the books reveal the transformational theme emerging. Three of the authors selected titles using the term itself as in *Transforming Church and Mission* by Rene Padilla, *Transformation from the Periphery, Emerging Streams of Church and Mission* by Paul Pierson, and *Transformational Action* by Richard Howell.

In this book I reflect on mission as transformation by considering 1) the context within the last fifty and one hundred years, 2) some contributions toward the transformation of communities, cities and countries and 3) the considerations regarding transformation as a paradigm of *missio Dei* and consequently the mission of the Church and God's servants in the 21st century.

INTRODUCTORY OVERVIEW

What happens when the Church moves outside of its four walls and gets involved in the greater spiritual and social needs of its community?

On the Pacific island of Fiji, we can begin to find answers to that question. Tribal leaders are being reconciled. Denominational leaders have come together in heart, mind and vision. The Prime Minister begins the day early seeking God. The governmental cabinet seeks to do what is right.

The restorative work of God is even becoming evident in nature itself. God is demonstrating His approval all over the islands through regenerating coral reefs. Fish are returning to their habitats. Fruit grows on plants that had ceased to bear for decades.

Torch lights carried from village to village by revived Fijian government officials symbolically impart revival to catalyze new transformation venues, of which there are sixty in this tiny nation.

Five Transformational Streams

What is happening in Fiji is not unique. Five diverse transformational streams have been welling up and flowing across the world, in places as distant from one another as Indonesia, South Africa, and Colombia, converging under God's hand into one great "transformational river".

Fiji's transformation exemplifies the Revivalist Stream, characterized by divine visitation and revival. God acts on the Church, bringing revival. He acts on society, bringing spiritual awakening. He acts on political leaders, bringing ethical leadership, concern for the needs of the people, and readiness to review political and economic structures and systems in light of Kingdom values.

The Church Growth Stream, which increasingly reflects church-planting movements around the world, is permeating every segment of society with the love, truth and saving power of Jesus Christ. The vision is to nurture vital, healthy churches in every class and kind of people that are within practical and relational reach of every person.

The City-reaching Stream builds on this foundation of vital, Biblical churches to mobilize apostolic people with an apostolic mission to transform peoples, places and the cultures within which the Church lives around the world.

Through community development, the Transformational development Stream is creating a better future for the poor. Those living in poverty are often caught in mutually reinforcing systems that dis-empower them and mar their identity. The hope of transformation lies in addressing these pervasive systems as well as coming alongside needy communities.

The marketplace – comprising business, education and government—constitutes the heart of a nation. For a nation to be transformed, the marketplace must be transformed. Thus the Marketplace-redemption Stream. Leaders in all three sectors of the marketplace play an essential role in the transformation of their communities and nations.

A New Paradigm: Mission As Transformation

As we begin the twenty-first century, mission as transformation has emerged as a new paradigm. This paradigm builds on the foundational vision of "the whole church taking the whole Gospel to the whole world". In this view of mission, the focus is on the intended impact of mission-related ministries – the transformation of individuals, communities and nations – and on the ways in which specific ministry activities can support this process.

A Biblical Perspective On Transformation

Transformation is the progressive, ongoing measurable supernatural impact of the presence and power of God working in, through and apart from the Church on human society and structures. It involves seeking positive change in the whole of human life materially, socially and spiritually, as we recover our true identity as human beings created in the image of God and discover our true vocation as productive stewards, faithfully caring for our world and its people.[7] Deep and profound change is possible in human beings and is equally possible for the social organisms that we call communities, cities and nations.[8]
The term itself derives from the Greek word *Metamorphoo*, which means to change from one degree of glory to another, as "we, who with unveiled faces all reflect the Lord's glory, are being transformed into his likeness with ever-increasing glory, which comes from the Lord…" (2 Cor. 3.18). The transformation process is sometimes gradual, as described here, or more immediate, discontinuous or disruptive, as in the change in Zacchaeus after he encounters Jesus (Luke 19.7-8) or the transformation of the saints at the last trumpet (1 Cor. 15.50-54).

Thus transformation is a concept deeply rooted in the New Covenant (see John 4:14; Rom. 12:2; II Cor. 5:17; I John 3:9). It is the spiritual equivalent of a caterpillar being metamorphosed into a butterfly. Unlike reformation, it does not merely tinker with people and communities as they are; it operates at the heart level, changing them from the inside out..9 It involves a radical change from a condition of human existence contrary to God's

purposes to one in which people are able to enjoy fullness of life in harmony with God (John 10:10; Col. 3:8-15; Eph. 4:13). This transformation can only take place through the obedience of individuals and communities to the Gospel of Jesus Christ. His power changes men and women by releasing them from the guilt, power and ultimate consequences of sin, and enables them to respond with love toward God and towards others (Rom. 5:5), making them " new creatures in Christ" (2 Cor. 5:17).[10]

The Kingdom of God advances as individuals hear and accept the Gospel by faith, are born again, and experience inward regeneration, and transformation expressed in obedience to "all I have commanded" (John 3:3, 16; Acts 2:21; Rom. 1:16-17). However, God's concern goes beyond the salvation of individual people. His redemptive plan encompasses the healing and transformation of entire nations (Gen. 12:1-2; Matt. 28:19-20). Nations are discipled as the Church makes the invisible Kingdom visible by faithful obedience to God's Word throughout culture—in every area of life, and every realm of society including the family, the community, the arts, sciences, media, law, government, schools, or business (Gen. 1:26-28; 22:18; Deut. 4:5-8; 30:11-20; Col. 1:18b).

Transformation Initiatives To Bless The Nations

A comprehensive approach to transformation must be "rooted in the theology of the mission of the Kingdom of God and seek to express the Lordship of Jesus over every aspect of life, economic, religious, personal, political. It does not give priority to any area of life as an area for mission . . . but this change will be effected whenever people address issues of life directly, rooted in a Gospel perspective."[11]

As the head of the Church, Christ initiates and His body responds – as one body.
Transformation initiatives under Christ's direction must be inclusive in approach, comprehensive in scope, and holistic in nature.

Efforts to mobilize the whole Church compel us to include every willing believer. Just as the Godhead is a community, so we believe that God's nature and character are most clearly manifest in the world as the Church lives out the Kingdom life in incarnational community (Eph. 4:11-13).

Commitment to a nation or community requires a comprehensive scope that includes all peoples, problems, and conditions that affect community or national life. It calls for the persevering unity of the body of Christ and persevering leadership to overcome the obstacles within the Church and meet the challenges from the world. The whole Gospel requires holistic methods that are a balanced integration of proclamation and incarnation. A comprehensive movement to bless communities and nations includes many emphases.

Mission initiatives among the last and the least prioritize the spiritually needy, integrate the physically needy, and ensure that no country is out of *focus*.

God is Lord of all, and therefore, His redemptive concern is comprehensive—seeking to bring healing and restoration to "all things" by means of Christ's blood shed on the cross (Gen. 1:31a; Rom. 8:18-23; Col. 1:19-20). The Kingdom of God advances to the extent that local churches reflect God's comprehensive, redemptive concern for the whole of creation (Matt. 4:23; Luke 4:18-21). Therefore, the ministry of the Church must be holistic—encompassing the whole person (spiritual, physical, and social), and all of their relationships (with God, with others, and with the environment. Gen. 1:26-28). The answers to these questions should set the agenda for the local church: What would our town look like if Christ were mayor? What would our nation look like if Christ were president?

Such movements are enhanced by the presence of “transformation associates” who invest in transformation coordination and transformational leadership.

- Transformation associates around the world are contemplating and then seeking to cooperate with the beauty of God’s movements.
- Transformational leaders are committed to engage new generations in participatory leadership with them.
- Transformation coordination is being exercised in the belief that we can do more together than we can separately, and that this will enable us to move to a new ministry realm which operates on entirely new laws of input and output.

Like the gushing forth of the waters, the love of God through the people of God is already unleashing multiple mission initiatives in which divine resources are channeled through willing servants to meet human needs to the glory of God. We are being called not to dilute, adulterate, moderate, water down, reduce, weaken or pollute that which the Spirit of the living God is purifying and gushing forth on this dusty plain we call Earth.

Conditions Leading To Transformation

We are being called to seek God in all His holiness, to humble ourselves as did Isaiah, to respond to God with a “Yes” when He asks whom He shall send, to seek the unity of God’s servants and to cultivate creative transformational community initiatives to bless peoples and nations.

What qualities and characteristics are needed to achieve the vision for transformation?

Spiritual Vitality – Laying the foundation for transformation and ministry through corporate

spiritual growth

Experiencing the holiness of God with other leaders leads to repentance, humility, and a deeper life commitment to Christ and His mission in the world.

Relational Priority – Fueling momentum for ministry through loving relationships

Reconciling, forming and developing relationships of mutual love, respect, and trust enables leaders to work together for the common good of their community.

Compelling Shared Vision – Aligning transformational efforts by maintaining vision for the desired results

Listening to one another's visions to discover common themes lays the groundwork for a clear, compelling vision that is comprehensive, reflects a broad consensus and draws in all willing participants. Shared values and strategy, common language and goals, and an urgency to act galvanize a team for action.

Empowering Leadership – Identifying leaders and initiating a process for community transformation

Empowerment thrives in contexts where a growing base of committed leaders courageously face challenges and remove barriers to the involvement and contribution of others. Through prayerful planning, effective leaders recognize the activity of God in the community and make the large-scale adjustments needed to join Him in that activity. They shepherd people and guide processes, putting together strategies and supporting systems and structures to carry out God's vision.

Thorough Research – Increasing understanding of the current realities of one's community

Churches that desire to be relevant and effective in their communities require good information – that describes the community's people and needs, the true condition of the Church, and the spiritual forces which influence current reality. The Church must see themselves and their communities as they truly are, not as they wish they were or as they seem to be. Accurate data, when properly understood, help reveal God's priorities and identify ministries likely to have the greatest impact and lasting results.

Loving Service – Taking advantage of key opportunities to minister to the community

Building bridges through acts of service and kindness establishes relationships of trust

and credibility with the community. People open their lives to those who genuinely care about personal and community needs. They are then more ready to open their heart to the One who empowers loving service.

Intentional Learning – Making a fresh commitment to individual and corporate learning around needed skills and effective ministry models.

> Finding out what the Church needs to learn to bring about greater impact is crucial to the Church achieving its goals. For many of us, community transformation means a shift in our underlying philosophies, as well as learning new skills. Building the Church's ability to facilitate change in individuals, communities and nations requires a community of learners who are committed to giving and receiving feedback, practicing loving critique, and discovering new ways to achieve God's plans and purposes.[12]

Signs Of Transformation*[13]*

Jesus did more than preach the Kingdom; He demonstrated its reality with "signs of the Kingdom", public evidence that the Kingdom He was talking about had come.

Since "the reason the Son of God appeared was to destroy the devil's work" (1 Jn. 3:8), He inevitably came into conflict with the prince of darkness and his rule. But there was no question who would be victorious. Jesus declared that once the strong man has been overpowered by the Stronger One, his possessions can be taken from him (Mt. 12:29; Lk. 11:22) and his dominion destroyed.

So the signs of the Kingdom were also evidence that the devil was retreating before the advance of the King. The "signs of the kingdom" are equally signs of transformation which evidence the advance of the King of Glory in the twenty-first century:

The first sign of transformation was and still is ***Incarnation*** - Jesus himself in the midst of his people (Lk. 17:21; Mt. 18:20, Heb 2.14-17). His presence brings joy, peace, and a sense of celebration (Jn. 15:11; 16:33; Mk. 2:18-20). Incarnation also involves God's people living and serving in the midst of their communities around the world.
The second sign is prophetic and compassionate ***Proclamation*** - the declaration of Truth and the preaching of the Gospel to every people in relevant media, forms and language. Christ came proclaiming the Gospel of the Kingdom, with its radical message of reconciliation, and left his followers with the mandate to preach this Good News of the Kingdom to all, especially to the poor (Lk. 4:18, 19; 7:22), and point people to the Kingdom.
The third sign of transformation is ***Liberation*** – from evil spirits and evil systems as well as sickness, human frailty and the ordinary laws of nature. But it is equally liberation from

worldviews and belief systems, religious and secular, that bind people and keep them from seeing and experiencing the truth (cf Acts 10.28). As in Jesus' time, God is equally free and powerful in this age to perform miracles of deliverance and healing, especially in frontier situations where the Kingdom is newly advancing into enemy-held territory. These miracles demonstrate God's power as well as his compassion for the poor and suffering.

A fourth sign of transformation is ***Repentance*** and ***Regeneration*** - the miracle of conversion and the new birth. God's power for salvation is displayed in the Gospel (Ro. 1: 16). Whenever people "turn to God from idols, to serve the living and true God" (I Th. 1: 9, 10), a power encounter takes place in which the power of idols, whether traditional or modern, and of the spirits, is broken. Converts who have been rescued from darkness to light and from the power of Satan to God (Acts 26:18) are said to have "tasted ... the powers of the age to come" (He. 6:5).

These third and fourth signs not only point to the reality of the Kingdom's arrival, but also anticipate the final Kingdom from which all evil, rebellion, disease, hunger, disorder and death will be forever banished.

A fifth sign of transformation is ***Koinonia*** - the people of the Kingdom in community. "Once you were not a people, but now you are the people of God." (1 Peter 2.10). In the Church is manifested the Christ-like qualities which Paul calls "the fruit of the Spirit". And through the expression of the gifts of the Spirit, the whole Body is built up in love and able to minister effectively. For the gift of the Spirit is the supreme blessing of the Kingdom of God. Where He rules there is unity, and love, joy, peace and righteousness rule with Him (Ga. 5:22, 23; Ro. 14:17).

A sixth sign of transformation is ***Humility*** and ***acts of Reverence and Love*** – that flow from the Holy Spirit's presence and power in the Church, and are often remarkable and extravagant. These qualities naturally issue in worship (toward God), in intercession (toward God and humanity), in outreach with good news and good works (toward humanity). Good News and good works, evangelism and social responsibility, undergirded by worship and intercession, are indissolubly united.

The seventh sign of transformation is ***Suffering –*** and ***the readiness to suffer.*** It was necessary for the King to suffer in order to enter into His glory. Indeed, He suffered for us, leaving us an example that we should follow in His steps (I Pet. 2:21). To suffer for the sake of righteousness or for our testimony to Jesus, and to bear such suffering courageously, is a clear sign to all beholders that we have received God's salvation and have embraced His Kingdom (Phil. 1:28,29; cf. II Th. 1:5).

The result of transformation is always remarkable, and often beyond imagination. It cannot be predicted or extrapolated from the current situation, nor from present resources or methods. “So will it be with the resurrection of the dead. The body that is sown is perishable, it is raised imperishable; it is sown in dishonor, it is raised in glory; it is sown in weakness, it is raised in power; it is sown a natural body, it is raised a spiritual body.” (1 Cor. 15.42-44)

The Transformational Individual: characteristics of individuals as catalysts of spiritual and social transformation

Christ's disciples must have their minds renewed by actively putting off false worldviews—distortions of the truth used by Satan to enslave individuals and nations—and be transformed by the biblical worldview (Matt. 22:37; Rom. 1:18-23; 12:2; 2 Cor. 10:3-5; Col. 2:6-8; 1 Peter 1:13). The discipleship of nations requires that Christ's followers allow the Biblical worldview to enlighten every area of their lives, and carry it outward into every sphere of society (Isa. 11:9b; Matt. 28:18-20; John 8:31-32).

Typically, a transformation process begins with a catalytic core of saints who embrace a lifestyle of persistent repentance, humility, and sacrificial servanthood. This both demonstrates and attracts the favor and presence of God, and breaks the predominating influences of the ruling powers of human flesh and negative spiritual forces.

Christians engaged in a transformational mission – “transformational catalysts” – begin with a fresh awareness of the holiness of God which leads to greater humility. The humility of the servants of God makes way for a spirit of unity. Greater unity leads to the cultivation of a transformed and transformational community sensitized to discover, embrace and become servant catalysts on His mission of transformation. These transformational catalysts from around the world contemplate the beauty of God’s movements and then seek to cooperate with Him, as they invest themselves in transformation coordination and leadership.

- Transformation coordination is exercised in the belief that we can do more together than we can separately, and that this will enable us to move to a new ministry realm which operates on entirely new laws of input and output.
- Transformational leaders are committed to engage new generations in participatory leadership with them.

And the cycle repeats itself.

The Transformational Church: characteristics of the Church as an agent of spiritual

and social transformation in the community

The Church—the body and bride of Christ—is God's principally ordained agent in advancing the Kingdom of God (Matt 16:18-19; Eph. 1:22-23; 3:8-11). The present expression of the universal Church is the living, worldwide body of redeemed people who have placed their faith in the person and work of Christ alone for the forgiveness of their sins, have been adopted as children of God, and have been given the Spirit of God as a pledge of their inheritance.

The local church is an intentional community-based expression of the universal Church that meets regularly for worship, equipping, fellowship and service, and is the principal agent of God's agenda in the community where it serves (Eph. 2:14-22; 1 Pet. 2:9-10). Each local church is called to live as a Kingdom community, making the message of the Kingdom credible as the incarnate Body of Christ in the particular locale where it serves (1 Cor. 12:4-13; 12:27-28). Nations are discipled as local churches send their members into every sphere of society as servant leaders who promote the reign of Christ over all creation (Eph. 4:11-13).

But how does a local church become an agent of spiritual and social transformation in its community? Formulae and strategies alone are insufficient.

Churches that are having a truly transformational impact share certain characteristics that contribute to that impact. In the church, as in the lives of individuals, transformational change is characterized by increased holiness, reconciled relationships, and an appetite for prayer and worship.

A church that is truly the "salt of the earth" and "the light of the world" is one in which God's Spirit is free to act so that in it the Word of God becomes flesh. A church that is moving toward its own transformation and the transformation of the community it serves gives priority to living out its identity as God's redeemed and renewed people in:

- *Complete* commitment: Its commitment to Jesus Christ as Lord of everything and everyone.
- *Comprehensive* commitment: Christian discipleship as a missionary lifestyle to which the entire church and every member have been called
- *Community* commitment to inaugurate a new humanity: as the community that confesses Jesus Christ as Lord and lives in the light of that confession.
- *Ministry* commitment: using its gifts and ministries as instruments that the Spirit of God employs to prepare the church and all its members to fulfill their vocation as God's co-workers in the world, involved in loving service through holistic ministries that touch

every area of life.

This kind of church is often characterized by accelerated conversions and an increased relevance to greater society and participation in it.

Transformed Communities and Nations: examples of the impact of transformational churches ministering under the guidance of the Spirit of God

More and more stories of transformation are being told around the world. In this sphere, transformation may be characterized by pervasive awareness of the reality of God, a radical correction of social ills, a commensurate decrease in crime rates, supernatural blessing on local commerce, healing of the brokenhearted (the alienated and disenfranchised), restoration of the productivity of the land, and visible expressions of kingdom righteousness.

Case Studies of Transformation

Fiji: There are 60 transformation venues in Fiji alone. Tribal leaders are being reconciled. Denominational leaders have coalesced in heart, mind and vision. The Prime Minister begins the day early seeking God. The governmental cabinet seeks to do what is right.

The restorative work of God is even becoming evident in nature itself. God is demonstrating His approval of all the islands through regenerating coral reefs. Fish are returning to their habitat. Fruit grows on plants that had ceased to bear for decades. Torch lights carried from village to village by revived Fijian government officials symbolically impart revival to catalyze new transformation venues.

Indonesia: Transformational city-focused prayer initiatives have been taking place since 1989 in Indonesia. More than 350 cities currently have inter-church and inter-mission prayer committees offering seminars for facilitators trained to enable transformational initiatives. Last May, 80,000 Christians filled the major stadium in the nation to pray for the transformation of the cities.

Africa: Annual transformation prayer days have grown exponentially since Graham Power heard the call of God to gather His people to seek the His face at the stadium in Cape Town, South Africa on March 21, 2002. On May 2, 2004, an estimated 20 million people in 52 countries, met in more than 1200 African stadiums as God's people came together for several hours of fervent, united prayer. There were 58 reported events in Egypt alone, 1000 in Nigeria and another 1000 in Ghana. A week before the prayer day in Africa God's people gave generously to bless communities, cities and nations. Positive changes are

being reported by secular newspapers. Event co-patron Michael Cassidy said, “We need to get with what the Lord is doing and move from prayer in the stadiums to transformation of the cities.”

Latin America: The city of Cali, Colombia, the village of Almolonga, Guatemala and the country of Argentina display various portraits of transformation. The Cali, Colombia, story on video details a city where 20,000 Christians jam the municipal stadium for all-night prayer vigils every 90 days. In Almolonga, Guatemala, video footage tells the story of city jails closed for lack of crime. The presence of God is claimed by more than nine of ten people who live in the city, and the agricultural production is beyond imagination. City-wide transformational initiatives have been taking place for well over ten years in Argentina. Harvest Evangelism holds its 14th annual international institute expounding a new concept: “City Reaching is expanding... through national transformation marketplace redemption.”

GLOBAL: Representatives from 17 Christian relief and development organizations met in February 2004 expressed their vision as a collective association that the whole Church become a transforming and transformed sign of Christ’s Kingdom among all people.

The Process of Community Spiritual Transformation

Stage	Action by Party	Action Path	Key Words
Spiritual Beachhead	Preparation (man inspired by God)	Predictable (Known principles)	Petition, Principles & Desperation
Spiritual Breakthrough	Harvest (God assisted by man)	Unpredictable (Human limitations)	Response, Presence & strategy
Spiritual Transformation	Renewal (God assisted by man)	Predictable (Standard fruit)	Destination, Product & Maintenance

The Stage Indicators of Community Spiritual Transformation[5]

***Indicators that we are approaching the threshold of a spiritual breakthrough**:*

1. Fervent prayer and fasting becomes focused, frequent and widespread.
2. Interest in spiritual issues increases markedly among non-believers (this is often impelled by special circumstances that God has either arranged or exploited).

***Indicators that we have actually entered the Breakthrough stage**:*

1. Intercessors report a lifting of their prayer burden.
2. An intense awareness of God's presence settles over the community.
3. Non-believers speak openly of their sin and lostness (this occurs even where there have been no special programs or crusades).
4. Rapid and substantial church growth occurs across a variety of socio-economic and denominational settings.
5. A powerful spirit of unity emerges between many believers.

Indicators that we are approaching the threshold of a spiritual transformation:

1. Converted politicians, businessmen and professionals consider ways to translate new kingdom values into godly policies and practices.
2. Convicted believers publicly dispose of illicit, besetting possessions.

Indicators that we have actually entered the Transformation stage:

1. Political leaders publicly acknowledge their sin and dependence on God. (II Kings 11:17-18; 23:2; Jonah 3:6-9)
2. New laws, curricula, and business practices are put into effect. (II Chronicles 19:4-10; Nehemiah 10:3 1)
3. The natural environment is restored to its original life-nurturing state. (Leviticus 26:4-5; II Chronicles 7:14; Ezekiel 34:27; 36:29-30)
4. Economic conditions improve and lead to a discernable lessening of poverty. (II Chronicles 17:3-5; Psalm 144:14; Isaiah 60:5; Amos 9:13)

***Indicators that we have actually entered the Transformation stage**:*

1. There is a marked change in social entertainment and vices as Kingdom values are integrated into the rhythm of daily life. (Ezra 10:1-4; Nehemiah 8:10, 16; Ecclesiastes 10:17; Acts 19: 17-20)
2. Crime and corruption diminish throughout the community. (II Kings 12;13-15; Nehemiah 5:6-12; Isaiah 60: 17-18)
3. Volunteerism increases as Christians recognize their responsibility to heal and undergird the community.(Isaiah 58: 10-12; 61:1-4)
4. Restored hope and joy leads to a decline in divorce, bankruptcy and suicide. (Nehemiah 12:27-28, 43; Isaiah 54:11-14; 61:3,7; Jeremiah 30:17-19; 31:11-13; Hosea 2:15)
5. The spiritual nature of the growing socio-political renewal becomes a hot topic in the secular media. (II Chronicles 20:29; Nehemiah 6:16; Isaiah 55:5; Ezekiel 36:36; Acts 19:17)
6. Overwhelmed by the goodness of God, grateful Christians take the embers of revival into surrounding communities and nations. (II Chronicles 17:9; Isaiah 61:6; Acts 11:20-26)

A transformed world is a place where the power, the presence and the peace of God are experienced by all. The power of God is unleashed. The peace of God rules. Shalom-Salaam embrace. The presence of God fills the earth.

SECTION ONE: TRANSFORMATIONAL CONTRIBUTIONS

Chapter 1

Countries Practicing Transformation

Brazilian Transformation Project www.transformacao.com.br

What began as a dream and a prayer, along with the shedding of tears, led to a letter of intention, followed by an act of faith, and then a project. It is called "Brazil Transformation Project."

> It is the implementation of the movement of the Spirit of God. It has shaken up the Brazilian church. A new song is being sung for worshippers throughout all of Brazil, courageous believers are rising up, the nation is being claimed for Jesus![14]

Since then, great gatherings of God's people are happening in the main cities of Brazil. Believers join together in prayer, in intercession, in a spirit of worship, and to hear words from the Lord. Brazil has become a place where God's presence can be experienced.

The first national transformational conference took place during a moment of prayer and fellowship among some Brazilian evangelical leaders. It happened in the midst of a solemn assembly on the 4th of April, 2001, at a moment of communion with God and one another. Fifteen leaders of the Evangelical Church in Brazil experienced a call from God to awaken the conscience of Brazilian Christians—so that they might live a life of victory under the principles of the Word of God and His Kingdom. Seven months later, the first national transformation event took place in the city of Belo Horizonte, which was to become one of the cities that would catalyze the transformation project. It was on that occasion that a letter of intention was drafted for what at that time was called the "Rescue Brazil Project."

In the next few years, the vision for transformation was broadened and deepened. At the national conference in 2002 in Goiânia, the letter of intention was consolidated with increased mobilization of the churches throughout the nation. During the national conference of 2003 in Sao Paulo, the Brazilian Transformation Project was launched (previously called Rescue Brazil, with a foundation made up of various pillars). The 2004 event is planned for the 8th to the 11th of December in Recife. God is working through the process. There are various practical steps emerging that include the preparation of

transformational leaders, along with strategies for each of the five pillars to work harmoniously to bring personal, community, and national transformation.

The letter of intent follows:

LETTER OF INTENTION (a summary)

Gathered in Belo Horizonte on November 14-17, 2001, about 7,500 servants of God from all the states of Brazil, we became burdened by the need to change the culture of Latin America. This occurred through a powerful visitation of the Holy Spirit. We believe this will take the form of establishing the ethical values of the Kingdom of God among all the spheres of society, provoking a spiritual revolution that radically transforms the life of our people in religious, economic, cultural, and political arenas. This transformation will take place to such a degree that our cities will receive a new name, because of which we can declare: "And the name of the city from that time on will be: Yahweh Shammah, THE LORD IS THERE" (Eze. 48:35b).

In the meeting, the following subjects were discussed:

1. Awareness of our responsibility to fulfill the Great Commission in our generation;
2. Awareness of our spiritual inheritance as a result of the ministries raised up for God in the past and in our day;
3. Awareness of the place of the Brazilian nation in the plans of God for our generation;
4. Awareness that only the Body of Christ qualifies to fulfill the giant task of delivering the Native land to its legitimate owner in our generation;
5. Awareness of the invincible force of the Body of Christ to defeat the kingdom of darkness;
6. Trusting the leadership and ability of the Holy Spirit;
7. Imbued with a passionate determination to launch all the spiritual and human resources at our disposal, we are united in our intent to transform Brazil for Christ in the next five years, embracing the challenge to:

    a) Seek with intensity the spirit of favor and supplication that results in confession and repentance for the sins of the Body and the society (Zech. 12:10; II Cr 7:14);
    b) Mobilize our churches to pursue God in our lives and, consequently, in our nation, through fasting in the spirit of Isaiah 62:6-7, "I have posted watchmen on your walls, . . . ; they will never be silent day or night. You who call on the Lord, give yourselves no rest, and give him no rest till he establishes . . . and

makes her the praise of the earth."

c) Awaken our churches to a consistent return to the reading, meditation, memorization, and study of the Word of God and the authentic Biblical values of the Kingdom of God;
d) Prioritize the worship of God to occupy first place in our personal lives and in the life of the Church;
e) Adopt a Great Commission lifestyle;
f) Embody a discipleship program in our churches based on the priesthood of every believer, with the goal that each disciple become a minister and each house a center of worship (Acts 5:42);
g) Inculcate the ethical values and cultural expressions of the Word of God in all segments of Brazilian society, through mass media such as radio and television; and establish Christian principles of education at all levels, until marks of the visitation of God are concrete not only in the Church, but also in the transformation of society.

With this intention, we agree to:

1) Organize seven annual conferences on a national level, in the different regions of the country, to be hosted in the following cities: Belo Horizonte, Goiânia, São Paulo, Salvador, Manaus, Recife, and Porto Alegre;
2) Organize smaller conferences in some cities of Brazil, with the focus directed toward strategies to reach these cities, in order to motivate church-planting movements, so that all the Brazilian cities have vigorous churches with a strategic vision for Kingdom building;
3) Mobilize the largest number of evangelical leaders and churches from all the denominations for the joint project of evangelizing our cities;
4) Commit to a systematic plan of fasting and prayer for the cure of the Brazilian economy, so that poverty is eradicated;
5) Encourage the partnership of ministries for the moral and cultural change of radio senders and television in order to spread the Gospel of Jesus Christ and the values of the Kingdom of God;
6) Awaken evangelical leaders for the establishment of schools and universities based on Christian values.

Understanding that this is only the beginning, we will seek to continue hearing what the Holy Spirit is saying to the churches of Brazil toward the transformation of this nation—in all its breadth and depth—that it may be said of Brazil: "Yahweh Shammah, THE LORD IS THERE."

The strategy adopted includes several pillars: first, a united, national, intercessory network; second, the inculcation of Christian principles of education in schools throughout Brazil; third, the launching of and a center for an inquiry into the nature of spiritual and societal transformation; fourth, becoming Kingdom change agents in all sectors of Brazilian society, seeking to introduce Kingdom values; and fifth, that social action be the direct product for the betterment of society.

Our dream is to establish a Transformation Center committed to analyzing the history and facts of Brazil, bringing to light the current subjects of the economy, politics, marketplace, education, and arts, as well as current situations surrounding poverty, misery, and corruption. This Center would inform the Body of Christ and encourage the transformation of Brazil to the glory of Jesus Christ!

The letter of intention was written only three years ago. Now, three years later, the secular press takes notice. It recognizes that the evangelical church is on a mission of transformation to introduce the value system of the Kingdom of God. On June 7, 2004, a front page article titled “Moved by the Spirit to Govern” appeared in the *Los Angeles Times*.[15]

In an opening interview with Adelor Vieira, a congressman is quoted as saying: “The churches to which evangelicals belong have a mission, which is to promote the kingdom of God.” It was as though Vieira was thinking of that letter of intention written up in 2001.

> In Brazil, the region's largest country and an unshakable Catholic stronghold for centuries, census figures show 15% of the population to be evangelicals — about 27 million people.
>
> . . . For many here, faith remains a private affair, their devotion playing out at church and at home. But others are heeding what they believe is a divine calling to shine the light of Christian truth on "works of darkness," which encompass perceived evils as varied as abortion and the corruption rampant in Brazilian politics.
>
> "We cannot be silent when those things happen," said Walter Pinheiro, an evangelical Christian deputy in Brazil's Congress. "We have to bring light to and condemn those practices."
>
> By "we," Pinheiro means an evangelical contingent in Brazil's lower house that has grown over the last few years and, last September, formed an official lobby in Congress, the Evangelical Parliamentary Front.

> The group, whose goal is to ensure that public policy falls "in line with God's purposes, and according to his Word," boasts 58 deputies and three senators out of nearly 600 legislators. . . .
>
> The group opposes any liberalization of Brazil's already-strict abortion laws. Gay marriage is anathema. So are legalizing drugs, handing out clean needles to addicts as a public-health measure, and distributing condoms in schools.
>
> One of the group's biggest victories in Congress last year was amending a bio-safety bill to outlaw the cloning of human embryos to harvest stem cells for research. On the local level, the evangelical governor of Rio de Janeiro state, Rosinha Matheus, has outraged scientists by authorizing public schools to teach creationism.
>
> Yet to view the evangelical front as a simple analogue of the religious right in the United States would be off the mark. . . . the Brazilian deputies belong to a motley, squabbling bunch of rival groups that span the ideological spectrum.

The latest national transformational event for the Brazilian Project involved more than 8,000 Brazilian Christian leaders in assessment, review of the progress, adjustments, and expansion of the vehicles for implementation of the vision. It called for fresh commitment to the vision and mission to transform Brazil. They have begun planning for Christian leaders engaged in transformation from the Church around the world to participate in Transform World: Brazil 2008.

UK
By John Smith, UK Director, Evangelical Alliance

In 2000 Evangelical Alliance, representing a constituency of 1 million across the UK, launched the vision of a mass movement – a Movement for Change - setting a mission agenda for unity, that of societal transformation – uniting to change society. At its heart is a call to holistic or integral mission which takes seriously the full Gospel mandate as expressed for example in Jesus' Nazareth manifesto of Luke 4. It stresses grassroots identification and involvement, emphasizing the 'me' in the movement and the 'all' in alliance.

In 2002, *facevalues* provided a framework for churches to engage in social justice, and social action agendas alongside evangelism.

Seventy mission agencies badged their products and programmes under *facevalues*.

Evangelical Alliance made available

- a mission menu
- adaptability, a CD Rom based diagnostic tool for social action;
- prayer resources; a provocative poster set featuring kingdom values;
- a Say Sorry Sunday
- a National Forgiveness Day.

Advertising and PR provided a backcloth for local activity in a campaign with a national identity. Some 3000 local churches participated in some way in this mission project. An independent review concluded 'no-one can undertake national mission in the UK again without taking account of *facevalues*.'

facevalues was a short-term expression of Movement for Change designed to raise the profile of holistic mission and to engage with society on the issue of values.

Movement for Change continues to develop on several fronts.

- a theological colloquium has reflected on the characteristics and influence of other transformational movements
- a strategic forum draws together thinkers from several agencies considering opportunities to influence education, politics, arts and media, business and professions, identified as key change-drivers in society;
- salt and light research will quantify the benefits of Christian based social action projects
- an annual values engagement will raise the profile of a kingdom value – this year 'hope' – this will include resources for churches and a press and media campaign.

A major strategy of Movement for Change taken up principally by the Alliance– *changemakers* – is designed to help church leaders equip, mobilise and support church members to become agents for change through their daily activities. This involves a serious reflection on the purpose of church, and emphasises a paradigm shift from simply 'the church gathered' to include 'the church dispersed' or scattered. The task has been described as 'turning the church inside out to turn the world upside down'. In pursuing the

vision of a Movement for Change, Evangelical Alliance is conscious of a number of parallel initiatives using similar language of change and movement, and with closely related objectives, e.g., the faithworks movement of Oasis and the change activist programme of Care. A clear priority for Movement for Change is the avoidance of competition and the concern to bless and encourage what God is raising up.

Chapter 2

Cities Preparing for Transformation

Indonesian Cities

By Iman Santoso[16] with Soleiman Irwan[17]

The Preparation for Transformation through City-based Concerts of Prayer

Prayer for the transformation of the cities of Indonesia has been going on since 1989. From the year 2000 to 2003, a rapid expansion in the development of a prayer network for the transformation of the cities of Indonesia took place. As of August 2004, there are prayer networks in at least 350 cities in Indonesia, accompanied by reconciliation between Christian leaders and fresh expressions of unity in the Church. The Jakarta Concert of Prayer at the Jakarta Convention Center (held February 13, 2003) was filled to its capacity of 5,000 people. During the prayer concert, an historic reconciliation took place between leaders from different Christian streams in Jakarta. The organizers said this reconciliation was a major spiritual breakthrough.

The Preparation of Facilitators as Agents of Transformation

If our purpose and goal is toward the transformation of the cities or of the country, we need to have a holistic and global perspective on the movements of God that work simultaneously in different areas of life. We cannot separate the prayer movements from mission movements or other movements of God, for example, in mass media, church planting, evangelism, or acts of mercy.

In order to have a maximum impact for the work of the Kingdom of God, there needs to be the role of facilitators who can relate and join many functioning parts of the Body of Christ. Within the last one or two decades, we have seen movements of God rising up in a new model of ministry: ***the facilitating ministry***.

City-based "Seminars to Equip Facilitators" are being held throughout the country of Indonesia.

Manila, The Philippines

By Rafael C. Navarro[18]

Envisioning transformation is how Christian leaders took the first step of planning for the transformation of the city of Manila along with the Church of Manila. What a transformed Manila and church in Manila look like was the question. Out of the discussions that were held, a vision emerged for the city and the Church in the city.

The Vision for the City

- Metro Manila: a global metropolis where the spiritual witness, holistic ministry, and moral ascendancy of the Church and Christians help transform it into:
- a city of moral rectitude and safety;
- a city of order and discipline, where justice works and people obey the rule of law;
- a city of a productive economy and balanced ecology—jobs with clean air for all;
- a city of hospitality and cultural tolerance;
- a city that provides affordable housing for the poor and basic services that are affordable and accessible by all;
- a city governed by honest and competent politicians and public servants.

The Vision for the Church

- We see a prayerful, holy, and loving Church
- of empowered and equipped members,
- united by their love for the Lord and His Word,
- who reach out to disciple individuals and transform villages
- into God-fearing, law-abiding, neighbor-loving, economically prosperous, and ecologically balanced communities.
- We see churches multiply,
- formed and led by lay leaders or bi-vocational pastors, who receive on-the-job training, and are honest, have a servant spirit, and are competent leaders.

These vision statements are summaries of the stated preferences of the participants in the workshops. Succeeding attachments reflect all they said. These statements are works in progress; additions and improvements are welcome.

MISSION HOUSTON
A CASE STUDY OF CITY TRANSFORMATION

by Jim Herrington[19] and Laura Sorrel[20]

Mission Houston emerged as an organization in 1995. It did not emerge in a vacuum. The global focus on unity that grew out of the Lausanne Conference on Global Evangelism influenced leaders around the world. One of those was Doug Stringer, a pastoral leader in Houston who founded a ministry called Somebody Cares. In 1996 he convened more than a hundred pastors from a variety of cultural and denominational backgrounds for forty days of prayer and fasting at a place he called *Prayer Mountain.* Doug's leadership was among a variety of influences that converged in Houston in the mid-nineties.

From those influences, a group of pastoral servants in Houston grew increasingly convinced that the church growth paradigm had unintentionally fostered some beliefs and practices among congregations that were working at counter purposes to Kingdom advancement. Ten years later, it is clear to us that city reaching or community transformation is the paradigm that reflects what God is doing in the world today. As the transformation paradigm emerges, the church needs practical examples of how cities are seeking to join God in what He is doing. Houston, Texas is one example – held up here not because it is a model or a story to be reproduced, but because real men and women who love God and want to see their city transformed are courageously and transparently seeking to obey the Lord's leadership.

Mission Houston (www.missionhouston.org) was born through the efforts of a broad range of people from a wide range of cultural and denominational backgrounds. Jim Herrington served as the first executive director. Steve Capper is the current executive director.

We have learned that transformation is not a program or a sequence of steps. It is best characterized by a river whose strength comes from the convergence of its various tributaries. The transformational process to which Mission Houston has contributed has unfolded in this ministry through the following tributaries.

Vision casting: In September of 1995, Mission America, DAWN Ministries and the Sentinel Group hosted a conference in Houston. In this conference the stories of transformation that are now captured on the *transformation videos* were told. Those stories captured the hearts of a number of pastors in Houston. For the next two years following the conference Jack Dennison, George Otis, Ruth Ruibal, Jackson Senyonga, Ed Silvoso and other leaders of the movement returned to Houston at our invitation to tell stories of transformation. The vision casting was foundational. It accomplished two things.

First, it helped communicate a vision of a unified church working together to advance the Kingdom. Second, it brought hope to those who had fully embraced the church growth paradigm and who were increasingly disillusioned with the results they were experiencing.

In the early stages, the vision casting was mostly story telling from other cities and countries. By 2001, we were casting vision for our city. It was a vision of the whole Body of Christ in Houston focusing its resources on reaching its communities by means of establishing leadership teams in forty-five communities across the city. These leadership teams will be pastors and congregational leaders who are deeply committed to one another and the mission of transforming their communities. They will develop a diagnostic map of their community and will facilitate prayer based planning that allows the assembled Body of Christ to ascertain where God is moving in their community so that they can join him there.

Interceding: From the vision casting, God led us to begin mobilizing prayer. We learned from other transformation experiences that they always had a unified prayer foundation. We also knew that the Spirit would have to move deeply in our city in order for this paradigm shift to be embraced.

In the spring of 1997, and with the guidance of International Renewal Ministries (www.multnomah.edu/IRM), we hosted our first Pastors Prayer Summit. A Pastors Prayer Summit is a three to four day event in which pastors gather for the sole purpose of seeking God's face for themselves and their city. One hundred seventy-pastors attended and they spoke eleven languages and represented nine denominations. In that gathering, the assembled pastors empowered Jim Herrington to serve as Mission Houston's first leader.

On the final day of the first Summit, we formed the pastors into locally based pastors prayer groups. By the spring of 1998 following the second annual prayer summit, fifty-one pastors prayer groups were functioning.

Parallel to the pastors prayer groups, a variety of people – including Pastors Steve Riggle and David Self and Mary Ann Bridgwater, Magda Hermida, and Peggy Gerst – were working to call believers from across the city to pray. From 1999 through 2002, numerous attempts were made to call the Church together to pray. We experienced varying degrees of success.

In 2003, we took a different approach. Rather than gathering people from across a city of five million people to a central prayer gathering, we divided the city into 45 administrative regions and worked to foster smaller prayer gatherings in communities across the city. In collaboration with fifteen intercessory prayer stream leaders, Mission Houston began to call

together and facilitate an emerging citywide prayer movement called Houston Prays Houston Prays is a network of more than 300 intercessory prayer networks in the Greater Houston area. Rather than basing unity on gathering in a central location, we refocused our efforts on mobilizing these prayer networks to *pray in agreement* regarding strategically identified prayer targets.

Today, Houston Prays catalyzes and coordinates fervent focused prayer with over 300 prayer networks. They do this through prayer gatherings designed to unify and mobilize the Church to touch every people group and community.

One of the most exciting things that emerged in Houston Prays is a partnership between Houston and the nation of Indonesia. Brokered by Houstonian Tom Victor of *The Great Commission Coalition*, this partnership has mobilized over 2 million intercessors in Indonesia who are praying for the strategic needs in Houston. This is a tremendous initiative from which we still have much to learn.

Research: In the fall of 2002, the Lord led us to establish some pilot projects. Jack Dennison's book, *City Reaching: On the Road to Community Transformation* provided a template for helping congregations in a community discern and act upon God's plan for transformation. From our pastors prayer groups, we invited groups to join the project. The pilot projects were designed to implement Dennison's template in communities across the city. As a part of the pilot projects, we worked to help the communities establish a diagnostic map.

This gave birth to Mission Houston's research arm, Houston Profile Project (HPP) (www.houstonprofileproject.org). Using our 45 administrative regions, HPP is working to provide a clear, comprehensive diagnostic map of individual administrative regions. The map includes data that comes from four sources: random telephone interviews, updated demographic information, community leader interviews, and a prayer walking/driving survey. HPP is also seeking to create group narratives of the various international people groups in the city, describing their worldview and cultural characteristics.

We are currently ¾ complete on the HPP project. Once completed, Houston Baptist University has agreed to provide computers, space, and leadership to make the all the data available on-line and to work with Mission Houston to update the data on an ongoing basis.

Leadership development: As the effort to mobilize the whole body of Christ unfolded, it became increasingly clear that city reaching leaders are trained differently than those who are focused primarily on the church growth paradigm. As Mission Houston was emerging, a leadership development ministry called *Leaders Edge* (www.leadersedge.org) was given

birth by Pastor Ken Shuman and Union Baptist Association. As these two efforts emerged, it became evident that God was preparing Mission Houston and Leaders Edge to partner. Today Leaders Edge has a comprehensive two year leadership development process that has welcomed over 200 leaders into an intensive experience in which pastors and congregational leaders are introduced to the foundational paradigms of transformation and provides needed skills and effective ministry models for implementing those paradigms.

The workplace: Within the past year, it has become increasingly clear that transformation will only come when believers are being the church in the place where they spend most of their waking day - for most adults that is in their workplace. Inspired by Ed Silvoso, and catalyzed by Debbie DeWitt at Continental Airlines and Jerry Gallion at The Kirby Corporation, in the spring of 2004 we launched Mission Workplace, a pilot project designed to mobilize believers in the workplace. (www.missionworkplace.org). From an initial vision casting luncheon in the spring of 2004, nine pilot projects are now underway. Ultimately our goal is to create missional Christian community in workplaces across the city.

Church planting: DAWN Ministries and City Reach International have been primary sources of information about the relationship between saturation church planting and transformation. Locally Union Baptist Association has been a key catalyst in this movement. In 2001, Glenn Smith left his ministry at Sugar Creek Baptist Church to form New Church Initiatives (NCI) (www.newchurchinitiatives.org). Through his work at Sugar Creek, Glenn led that church to plant over 30 churches in ten years. NCI's ministry trains and mentors church planters across denominational lines.

Social action: From our earliest days, we have known that transformation is tied to congregations expressing the tangible love of Christ to the most pressing human needs in the city. We must enact high leverage opportunities to minister together to the community through acts of service and kindness, especially to the poor and oppressed. Somebody Cares Houston (Doug Stringer, Founder and Executive Director) – www.somebodycares.org - and Urban Link (Brian Schaffer, Founder and Executive Director) – www.urbanlink.org - are two ministries in the city that seek to mobilize resources for ministering to the needs of the poor and disenfranchised. In the summer of 2005, Urban Link is partnering with Mission Houston to identify and staff 100 ministry projects in the city.

Conclusion: Why is Houston held up in this case study? It is not because we have seen deep societal change – yet! It is because we are seeing the Holy Spirit orchestrate an unprecedented relational unity that brings passion and gifting from all the streams of transformation to the table.

Even so, the transition from the church growth paradigm to the community transformation one is challenging. This transition will not be brought about by one thing – prayer, church planting, leadership development, research, etc. – but the interaction of these various streams as they come together under the leadership of the Holy Spirit. Our experience is also that no one person or group of people can *lead* transformation. The Holy Spirit does that work. It is our conviction that the Spirit needs willing, humble, servant leaders who are able to collaborate while living in mutual submission and accountability.

Lessons we are learning

1. **It's a marathon not a sprint.** Ours is a city of nearly five million people. Divisions in the body of Christ are real and deep. Even if this were not true, it is a highly complex task to develop a multi-cultural, cross-denominational infrastructure that is built on relationships and fosters shared discernment and collaborative action. Our communities have been deteriorating for more than 50 years. Unless God sovereignly engineers something, it will likely take a generation for deep change to occur.

2. **Humility must be combined with ownership.** In an area like the cities of Houston, God has raised up many leaders. We have people from over one hundred countries who live in the greater Houston area. We are learning that God plants the vision of transformation in the heart of many leaders. A part of our task is to identify those leaders that God has raised up and get into relationship with them. But, when a room full of leaders gathers, everyone believes that he/she has the heart of God. It's both the curse and the blessing of leadership. Fostering humility with initiative – prayer with action - is an ongoing challenge. Our journey has not been an easy one. A new leader emerges on the scene – the vision is hot in his heart. She has ideas and people who are a part of her network. Other leaders – and often those who are the followers of other leaders – get offended.

   We've learned that face to face conversations, shared meals that don't have a task agenda, and lots of time praying together matter enormously in coalescing leaders in a city.

3. **God's ways are not our ways.** Our ways are to program and systematize everything. God's Spirit moves where it wills. We have attempted to hold two things in tension as we have travelled this journey. On the one hand we have attempted to utilize the best that we know of intentionality and planning. Our struggle has been to learn NOT to make our plans and ask God to bless them. Instead we are holding ourselves tenaciously to the discipline of prayer planning. Our planning sessions are characterized by preparation and long seasons of prayer and worship. As God

speaks, we seek to give expression to His leadership and then to hold ourselves accountable to obey what he speaks.

And yet, there are moments where we believe we have heard him clearly – and then new information emerges and new people come on the scene. Our pride and our need to be in control calls us to hold on to the plans we believe God has given. But, humility calls us to hold things loosely and to trust Him to be the leader of leaders.

4. **Unity does not mean doing everything together.** One of the most difficult challenges has been recognizing that unity does not mean that everyone works on the same thing at the same time. Unity is more about purpose. Diversity is more about what part one plays in achieving purpose. Unity is more about relationship and mutually respecting and preferring one another. Diversity is about courageously playing the part God ordains while honouring and respecting those who play a different part. Much of our early work called people to a common task. Today we are more focused on a common mission with a myriad of tasks that are coordinated under the headship of Jesus Christ.

Chapter 3

Communities Pursuing Transformation

That Kingdom values can bring about positive change in community can be clearly seen in the following two stories. Both of these stories have one thing in common: God used transformed individuals to be His transformational servant-catalysts. As servants of God and of His community, they catalyzed dramatic change leading to the notable improvement of their communities. This occurred as a result of adherence to values and the consequential positive impact on society.

A Story of Cultural Transformation from Uganda

When a lion comes into your village, you must raise the alarm loudly

The first case takes place in Uganda. Responding effectively to the HIV/AIDS epidemic is a crucial test for the African church in the 21st century. It is considered by some to be the greatest human emergency in history. Twenty-nine million people are living under the death threat of HIV/AIDS in Africa. Uganda is where it began. By 1994, 30% of the population of Uganda was infected—one of the countries hardest hit in Africa. Today that number has dropped to 6%. Stephen Langa, a businessman from the city of Kampala, serves on the board with the first lady in one of these efforts. Stephen reported to the author the remarkable account of the turnaround in Uganda.

In finding ways to address the issue, President Museven drew inspiration from tradition. "When a lion comes into your village, you must raise the alarm loudly." This is what we did in Uganda; we took it seriously, and we achieved good results.

> The AIDS awareness message was also facilitated by the deliberate empowerment of women as part of the democratization process. Women's empowerment was achieved by putting women at the highest level of leadership (ministers); Uganda's Vice President is a woman. This was aimed at breaking the psychological barrier and giving women confidence. It sent a message that girls are not useless. It had an impact on AIDS empowerment; we know that women need to be empowered before they can assert themselves in a sexual relationship.[21]

This sent a message that girls are not useless. In fact, the leading voice sounding the alarm was the President's wife Janet, who had her own view that her husband supported:

". . . the most important thing was focusing on our spiritual foundation and values."

At the Medical Institute for Sexual Health's annual meeting, Janet was given the "Hero Award": ". . . for the efforts she and her husband put forth to create awareness and for their success in promoting abstinence over 'safe sex' methods." [22]

Uganda's willingness to embrace the abstinence-until-marriage program helped turn the AIDS crisis around. Museveni cited a 2000 report in which 95 of 100 Ugandans were either abstinent or only had one sexual partner. She added that 99.7 percent of the population in Uganda is aware of HIV/AIDS.

In the late 1980s, Uganda was one of the countries hardest hit by the epidemic. "The situation looked bleak. . . .Uganda was at its most vulnerable," Museveni said. "This was more than a disease; it was a national disaster. . . .Our only hope was to sound a loud alarm." For the past 10 years, Museveni and her husband have promoted "True Love Waits" in speeches and ad campaigns and have worked closely with faith-based organizations such as the Southern Baptist Convention's International Mission Board.

The second illustration takes place in Peru.

A Story of Cultural Transformation from Peru

The media have an important formative role given their great penetration and influence on the general public in Peru. In recent years, several television programs were considered unfit for the people, especially the younger population.

The companies belonging to the National Advertisers Association (ANDA) established a commission on ethics to promote the best practices in commercial communications. This commission has a twofold objective. The first objective is to ensure the maximum efficiency of the advertising investment. The second objective is to contribute to the development of the political, judicial, and social conditions that would transform Peru into a stable and prosperous country, where businesses create wealth through the marketplace to improve the living conditions of the people.

One Christian businessman found himself in a position where he could do something to introduce Kingdom values into the country through ANDA. Two of the most morally degrading programs are no longer shown on television in Peru as a result of the work of this commission. This is a brief account of how it happened.

Rodolfo Leon, a businessman with one of the major companies in Peru, was nominated to

the Comité de Ética (Ethics Committee) for the advertising companies of the country which have the mandate to "Promote the best practices in the Commercial Communications Industry." It is the advertisers that finance the media industry through their advertising investment. Rodolfo felt that they "must do whatever is within our reach that they be used to raise society to a higher level." He was asked to be the president of the committee.

After careful review, these were the conclusions:

- The low level of TV program content greatly limited the freedom of the advertisers to buy advertising time due to the conflict with their internal policies.
- We do not pretend to tell the media what to put in their programs nor at what times to transmit them. That is not our role. We are simply deciding very carefully where to put our commercial announcements in accordance with our associates' standards.
- Our main purpose is to protect Family Time.
- Regarding freedom of expression, it was recognized that all freedom brings responsibility, which is regulated not to limit this freedom but to protect the rights of others, based on Article 19 of the UN's International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights.

With these conclusions, the Ethics Committee moved to adopt a code of ethics based on Kingdom values such as truthfulness, the dignity of the human person, and social responsibility (see Appendix D).

Chapter 4

Carey, William: A Model for Mission as Transformation

by Vishal Mangalwadi[23]

It is fairly well known that William Carey (1761 – 1834) sparked the modern era of missions. Not many people, however, know that he also pioneered the globalization of "modernity." Carey's little book, *Inquiry,* became "the Magna Carta of the Protestant mission movement" (Winter 1997)[24]. It caused an explosion of mission agencies that were committed to glorifying God through an understanding of missions that was more biblical than some we see today. For example, in his mission Carey took the Lord's Prayer more seriously than many of us do. He wrote in *Inquiry*,

> As our blessed Lord has required us to pray that His kingdom may come, and His will be done on earth as it is in heaven, it becomes us not only to express our desires of that event by words, but to use every lawful method to spread the knowledge of His name. . . . Sin was introduced amongst the children of men by the fall of Adam, and has ever since been spreading. . . . Yet God repeatedly made known His intention to prevail finally over all the power of the Devil, and to destroy all his works, and set up His own kingdom and interest among men, and extend it as universally as Satan had extended his. It was for this purpose that the Messiah came and died, that God might be just and the justifier of all that should believe in Him. When He had laid down His life, and taken it up again, He sent forth His disciples to preach the good tidings to every creature, and to endeavour by all possible methods to bring over a lost world to God.

How did Carey's mission differ from much of what we see today? In a powerful little book, *The Legacy of William Carey – A Model for Cultural Transformation*, Indian authors Vishal and Ruth Mangalwadi show the enormous positive impact William Carey had in creating modern India.

This is how the Mangalwadis introduce Carey: "Imagine a quiz-master: he asks a group of the best-informed Indian students, "Who was William Carey?" All hands go up simultaneously.

1. "William Carey was the first man," asserts a medical student, "who led the campaign for a humane treatment for leprosy patients. Until his time they were sometimes buried or burned alive in India because of the belief that 'a violent end

purifies the body and ensures the transmigration into a healthy new existence. Carey believed that because Jesus in his love touched and healed leprosy patients, they should cared for humanely."

2. "William Carey was the first botanist," answers a Science student, "to specialize in the Indian flowers of the Amaryllidaceons family, one of which is named after him."
3. "William Carey was an economist," announces an Economics Major, "who first introduced the concept of a Savings Bank to India, to fight the all-pervasive social evil of usury and to make hidden wealth useful for entrepreneurs. Carey thought that lending at the interest of up to 72% made investment, industry, commerce, and the economic development of India impossible. He taught that the Bible commands us to multiply our wealth not hide it under our floors."
4. The student of Printing Technology-stands up next "Dr. William Carey is the father of printing technology in India. He brought to India and then taught and developed the modern technologies of printing and publishing. He believed that God wanted everyone to read the Bible, so he built what was then the largest press in India.
5. "William Carey was the founder of the Agri-Horticultural Society contends a post-graduate student of Agriculture. "Carey did a systematic survey of agriculture in India, wrote for agriculture reform in the journal Asiatic Researches, and exposed the evils of the indigo cultivation system two generations before it collapsed."
6. Though he himself only had some home schooling till age 14, Carey began dozens of schools for Indian children of all castes and launched the first vernacular college in Asia at Serampore, near Calcutta. Without any formal education, Carey taught himself six European languages. He and his assistants then translated and published parts or all of the Bible into more than 40 Indian languages. He wanted to develop the Indian mind and liberate it from the darkness of superstition because he believed the Bible which said, "You shall know the truth and the truth shall set your free."

William Carey serves as an excellent example of the seamlessness between evangelistic enterprise and social reform at the early stages of the modern missionary movement. In addition to preaching and planting churches in India, Carey also organized a boycott against sugar imports from West Indian plantations cultivated by slaves; he researched widow-burning (sati) in India and initiated the movement that led to its abolition. He protested against untouchability and the caste system in India. His reforms included teaching agriculture, building systems of education – primary as well as higher, developing Indian languages, and preparing grammars and dictionaries to ensure that the Bible could be translated and studied in these languages.

Three Presuppositions Of Carey's Reforms

Our mindset is so different from Carey's that it is easy to miss seeing, or to misunderstand, the following basic assumptions of Carey's work.

First, every champion of the poor or the downtrodden in today's India sees himself as a savior or a mini-messiah. If God does not come to save us then, indeed, man has to save himself. But Carey knew that God loved this world enough to have come to save us. Salvation was God's work. Therefore, a reformer's primary duty was to ***pray***. Carey wrote: "One of the first, and most important of those duties which are incumbent upon us, is fervent and united prayer."

Some Christians think that Jesus came *only* to take us to heaven. He did not die also to free us from the curse that came upon the world as a result of sin. Therefore, it sounds alien to them that Jesus came to transform the world, to make it a kingdom where God's will is done, not Satan's. Although our age does not understand Carey, his mission had such profound impact on India that for 150 years all Indian reformers – Christians as well as Hindus – prayed for national renewal and social transformation. That was true all the way from Raja Ram Mohun Roy at the beginning of the nineteenth century to Mahatma Gandhi, who was assassinated in 1948 while on his way to a prayer meeting.

Of course, many of the Indian reformers did not accept Carey's Trinitarian God. However, they rejected fatalism and joined the missionaries' call for reform because they accepted the belief that there is hope for this world because the Creator cares for his creation. He is active in history. He wants his will to prevail. And He is powerful enough to answer our prayers. Indian reformers who followed missionaries such as Carey recognized that neither the impersonal Deity of philosophic Hinduism, nor the finite gods of folk Hinduism were adequate for human needs. If "God" were an impersonal energy or principle, "It" could not respond to prayers. And the mythological gods could not save because they were subject to the same failings as humans. Carey believed that prayer makes a difference not just in our minds but also in our world, because that is the essence of the Gospel: In Jesus the Messiah, the Sovereign Lord has entered human history as the "Light of the world." The darkness has no right to rule. The light shall overcome darkness.

A ***second*** assumption that informed Carey's mission was that transformation requires ***renewing minds*** as well as hearts. This required that education be an integral element in missionary enterprise.

Why would Carey, one of the greatest Bible translators of all times, personally teach zoology, botany, astronomy, and theology in his college at Serampore? If science were dangerous to faith, why would a missionary introduce it to India? Carey introduced modern science to India because he knew that it was a product of the Bible. It was needed to

transform a superstitious, magical society into a rational civilization.

The missionary society Carey founded was called "*Particular* Baptist Society." The term "Particular" meant "Calvinistic". Among other things, Calvinism taught man's "Total Depravity". That was a rejection of the idea espoused by some Renaissance thinkers that Adam and Eve had fallen morally, but not intellectually. The doctrine of Total Depravity said that sin had corrupted the human mind as well as the heart. Suppose you've grown up in New York and the only language you know is English. You know New York well. But suddenly you are transplanted into New Delhi. Most of your previous knowledge becomes useless. That is what happened to Adam and Eve when they were driven out of the Garden of Eden.

Imagine further: in New Delhi you wake up one morning to find that you no longer remember a word of English – all the programs and files in your brain's "hard disk" have been erased. Now you have lost all your knowledge. That is what happened to the human race in Genesis 11, when the tower of Babel intensified the curse upon our sin. All the knowledge of truth that Adam and Eve had learned from God and gathered in the Garden of Eden was totally wiped off. To what degree does human mind resemble the Creator's mind without knowledge of truth?

Carey's generation believed that since salvation includes re-formation of God's image in us, therefore it has to include a recovery of all the knowledge that has been lost as a result of sin. That is why Carey began a study of India's stones, plants, and animals. Floods destroyed his gardens, but his collection of stones and rocks is still on display in Serampore. Jesus promised that the "meek shall inherit the earth" which is ruled by Satan at present. Salvation includes freeing human beings from the slavery of spirits, astrologers, and fortune-tellers. It involves re-establishment of human dominion on earth. And we cannot re-establish our dominion without recovering the knowledge of nature that Adam and Eve lost due to sin.

The people of India were precious to God. They did not lack ability. They were living in misery because humanity had lost the knowledge of basic facts of nature. They were enslaved by erroneous beliefs. For example, many women would die in childbirth simply because the midwives would not allow them to drink water during labor! Transforming India required replacing this culture of superstitions with a scientific temper of inquiry and knowledge of all truth. Carey spent enormous energy in translating and promoting the Bible, because as a modern man he believed that ultimately only God's revelation could remove superstition and inculcate a confidence in human rationality—a prerequisite for the modernization of India.

Our generation has also tried to banish Carey's ***third*** assumption that the key to lasting reforms is ***conversion***. Two factors need to be understood here:

More than a decade before Carey wrote his *Inquiry*, a British civil servant in India, Charles Grant, had begun to argue that it was wrong for Britain to leave India at the mercy of merchants and soldiers. God's revealed plan is to bless all the nations of the earth. Therefore, God must have given India to Britain to bless India, not so that Britain may milk India.

How can Britain bless India? By sending missionaries, said Grant, who will communicate truth that liberates. William Carey shared Grant's belief that humanity's rebellion against God, i.e. sin, was at the root of all human problems. Human misery was neither a result of avidhya (ignorance of our divinity), nor was it a product of kama (desire). It was a result of human refusal to live under the authority of our heavenly Father. Therefore, Carey believed that it was reformers' duty to share with everyone the blessings of "conversion", of renewed fellowship with God. In his *Inquiry* Carey built his case for missions, both on his study of the Bible as well as on history. He learnt from history, as much as from the Bible, that conversion, reform, and modernization were intimately related processes. Therefore, Carey believed that the Gospel would lay the foundation stone for India's modernization.

Carey believed that conversion was the only civilized method of reforming a society because the sanctity of religious liberty was a central lesson of Europe's brutal religious wars of the seventeenth century. Those wars taught that the state should not interfere with people's religious conscience. How then can we eradicate social evils such as untouchability or destructive superstitions such as astrology without interfering with people's liberty? Since such beliefs and practices are rooted in a religious worldview, they could not be erased by legislation or force. They have to be countered by true and better beliefs. The state needs to defend the right of the reformers to question whether true spirituality consists in treating our neighbors as untouchables in them loving as ourselves. Its role should be limited to defending the people's right to "convert" or change their religious beliefs. Religiously sanctioned social evils are best removed by better and truer beliefs. This implies that the state should not coerce. It should play the role of a referee, allowing all religious (or nonreligious) ideas to compete freely in the marketplace of ideas. The society will reform as people change their beliefs and practices.

During Carey's career the British East India Company ruled India. It did not want missionaries to come to India because they would endanger the Company's rule by challenging indigenous beliefs and practices. The Company had captured India from Muslim and Hindu rulers and those were deadly enough enemies. The missionary enterprise, the Company knew, would also turn Hindu and Muslim priests into enemies.

Keeping missionaries out of India meant refusing to recognize and defend every Indian's freedom to listen to all ideas and freely choose what he/she wanted to believe. Since missionary enterprise was illegal, Carey came to India as a fugitive and established his mission in Serampore, which was then a Danish territory. Soon, however, Carey's work became the case study that supported Grant's case for missions and freedom to convert.

The battle for religious liberty, missions, and conversion was fought and won in British Parliament by Grant's friend William Wilberforce. He argued forcefully that England must assume the responsibility of "uplifting" India and that this implied allowing missionaries to serve in British ruled India. Grant and Wilberforce succeeded in changing British attitudes in Parliament and the East India Company because of Carey's success in India. In 1800, Lord Wellesley had already invited Carey to teach Bengali to the administrators of the Company in Fort William College because the Company could not find a competent teacher of Bengali in Calcutta. Carey Mastered Bengali because as a missionary committed to communicating the Gospel to Bengal, he had a much greater motivation to identify with the people of Bengal than had either the learned Indian pundits or the British rulers. Carey's appointment in the Company's college gave him an opportunity to break down the anti-missionary prejudices of the Company's top brass.

Carey's Two Contributions To Reform

In initiating India's transformation Carey made two contributions which are of special significance today:

First Contribution: It Is Possible!

In order to reform a society, we have to admit that it is degenerate and believe that a fundamental change is possible—even if the majority is against the change. The opposition to Carey was phenomenal. It came from the British Parliament, from the Company, from the military, from the Oriental scholars, from his own mission board, and also from the very people he was seeking to serve—the Indians themselves.

For the 200 years since Carey's day—until fairly recently—it has been taken for granted, at least in theory, that reform is possible. But for two thousand years before Carey the Hindu/Buddhist leadership in India had taught, and the masses had believed, that this earth was a place where souls were sent to take the consequences of their previous karma (deeds). Therefore, the meaning of human life, by definition, was suffering. Thus, life without suffering was not possible. The only way to escape this prison of suffering was by escaping from life itself—which is the Indian concept of salvation or nirvana.

What, then, should an "untouchable", widow, or a leper do? The Hindu/Buddhist answer is that all have to live with their karma and dharma (duties of one's caste or station in life), as best they can, without seeking to change fate in any fundamental way.

If we add to this Hindu fatalism (produced by the doctrines of karma, reincarnation, and dharma) the all-pervasive belief that our life on earth is determined by the astrological deities above, or by the demons and demigods below, then we can begin to understand why scholars such as Sir Thomas Munro had ruled out the possibility of reform. This was not all; if karma, stars, and demons did leave some freedom for a person, it was severely limited by the Hindu scriptures, written, often, from Brahmanical self-interest.

The Brahmanical scriptural mandates behind India's social and intellectual evils worked powerfully against reforms. Even if an individual British officer believed some Hindu customs to be wicked, he was not allowed to use the power of the state against those customs. Is reform possible when religion defends evil and the state is committed not to interfere with religion? Carey's faith in a transcendent Ruler, the God of History who was above human rulers, sustained him against all odds.

Carey's success challenged India's fatalism. Since then most Indians (including even those who believe in karma, reincarnation, astrology, Brahmanical scriptures, etc.) now assume that reform is possible. Most Indians reject the fatalistic idea that reform is not possible. That premise had ruled Indian civilization and ruined India for two thousand years. Carey's belief that human suffering can be and should be resisted has dominated the last two hundred years of Indian history.

Today, however, it seems certain that we cannot take it for granted that this optimistic idea will continue to be the main stream belief. At a theoretical level postmodernism has already rejected the ideas of "progress" and "development" as mythical "meta-narratives." The stage is now set for the older Indian pessimism and fatalism to win over Carey's "modern" optimism. For example, in his popular book *The Degeneration of India*, the ex-chief election commissioner T. N. Seshan, argues that, "India is terminally sick." His pessimistic diagnosis is widely believed because few people have done as much as he has to try and cleanse our public life of its all-pervasive corruption. This growing pessimism makes it urgent for us to understand optimistic mind-set the Bible gave to William Carey. He believed in the possibility of reform because the Bible taught that the Creator did not intend life to be suffering. He created Adam and Eve to live in Eden—in bliss. Suffering came later, as a result of sin. Suffering is thus a historical fact, not a metaphysical inevitability. Therefore, evil and suffering can be and should be resisted.

Sin is not karma. The idea of karma is that an impersonal law rules our destiny and

automatically gives us the consequences of our actions. According to the Bible, sin is breaking the laws of a Person—our loving heavenly Father. Therefore, it is possible to find forgiveness and to be delivered from sin and its consequences. It was this nonhumanistic, transcendent faith that sustained Carey and helped him to liberate India from its two-millennia-long bondage to fatalism and religious escapism.

Second Contribution: The Language of Modernization

Carey's second great contribution to the cause of India's modernization is the development of India's vernacular languages. He followed the example of European Reformers such as Martin Luther who knew that, in order to transform His people, Christ used the language of the common man, Aramaic, rather than the Hebrew of the sacred Jewish Scriptures. Until the sixteenth century, Latin was the elitist language of learning in Europe. Ordinary people spoke German, French, or English. This allowed the privileged elite to exploit ignorance. The Reformers began to translate the Bible into the languages of the common people in order to liberate the masses, by making the knowledge of the truth available to all the people. Martin Luther himself translated the Bible into German. Obviously, to have the Scriptures translated into the spoken language of the people is of little value if they don't read and write the language they speak. Therefore, the Reformers followed Bible translation with a drive to give a basic education to the masses. Their mission to cultivate the vernacular had several lasting results including the growth of democracy and market economy. It is not possible to have a government of the people, by the people, and for the people that functions mainly in the language of the elite. Nor is a genuine market economy possible without the spoken language of the people becoming also the language of learning, science, industry, and the marketplace. The genius of the market economy is that it liberates the energies of the masses for making contributions to the economic life of the country. This is impossible if an elitist language becomes a barrier over which ordinary citizens cannot pass.

Thus, a key factor in modernization, which Carey tried to popularize, is that the spoken language of the people should also be the language of learning, the language of industry, of marketing, and of governing. India has not yet taken this lesson to heart. That is one reason it has been left way behind by countries such as Japan and South Korea, whose modernization began almost a century after India's.

A feature of a medieval society is its use of an elitist language (such as Latin, Persian, Sanskrit, or now, English) as a means of discriminating, and also as a method of granting unearned privileges to an aristocracy. It became possible for India to make the transition from Persian as the court language, to Urdu, and then to the regional languages (at least in the lower courts because of Carey's labor and leadership in turning the vernaculars into

literary languages through Bible translation.

This should help us to understand why a reformer such as William Carey was so obsessed with translating and/or publishing the Bible in almost forty different languages; and why he helped start more than one hundred vernacular schools; and why he launched the first college in Asia to teach in an Asian language—Bengali. Their passion for reforming India, by making the Bible available in the vernaculars, motivated the missionaries to develop the grammar for many Indian dialects, and, eventually, to develop Hindi as a literary language for the majority of the citizens of India.

Carey team decided not to have English as the medium of instruction in their college at Serampore because they were out to improve the Indian mind, not to prepare an army of mercenaries for the British Raj. The following excerpt from the Mission report in 1818 makes the point:

> [Missionaries] apprehended that such a step, [adoption of an English-medium education] in the first instance, would go towards frustrating the very design of the institution. The moment a youth found he had enough English to copy an English letter, a stop would have been put to his studies. . . . They imagined there was a prospect of them getting Rs. 16 or 20 monthly as English copyists in the metropolis. This course, therefore, instead of promoting the welfare of the country would have trans formed its finest youth into mercenary copyists, ignorant of their own language and even of English as to any purpose of mental improvement.

The missionary effort at developing Indian languages resulted in the development of Indian nationalism. Modern nationalism grew in Europe after the Protestant Reformation, along with the growth of national languages in Europe. Carey and the other missionaries knew that a tiny British army had been able to colonize a great country such as India because Hinduism had not been able to cultivate a spirit of patriotism in India.

While some later missionaries were undoubtedly racists and others prostituted themselves to the Raj, overall the missionaries came to India because they loved India, and they tried to cultivate, among their converts, patriotism or a love for India. Their efforts began to succeed after they persuaded Michael Madhusudan Dutt—an upper-caste convert—to write his poetry in Bengali and not only in English. It was Dutt's poetry that began what is often called the "Bengali Renaissance" or the Bengali Nationalism. It produced Bankim Chandra Chatterjee, Swami Vivekananda, Rabindranath Tagore, and finally Mahatma Gandhi.

Carey was well aware that the Indian languages were not developed enough to translate the European knowledge into them or to use them as media for higher education. Nor did they have the necessary literature. Therefore, he blessed Alexander Duff's plans to establish an English medium college in Calcutta. However, in order to meet India's long-term needs, he strove to develop both the vernacular languages and their literature. After a team of pundits would complete a translation of the Bible in a vernacular, he would encourage them to begin translating educational books in that same language. This work, unfortunately, was necessarily a slow process during his lifetime. Neither the Indian elite nor the East India Company provided Carey with either resources or work partners who shared his vision. The missionary societies who later, following Carey's initiative, did motivate thousands of men and women to give to India their lives and resources, at that time were just getting off the ground. Countries such as Japan and South Korea have made great advances over India, partly because they immediately translate almost every book that is worth anything.

The Bible and Carey's Ministry of Transformation

Carey's missionary enterprise began India's transformation because it involved infusing the Bible's worldview into India. This brief chapter can only mention a few examples:

God, Creation, And Science

Carey's deep and dogged interest in nature—in stones (geology), in insects (biology), in plants and flowers (botany and agriculture), in trees (forestry), and in the stars (astronomy)—was rooted in his understanding that this world was his Father's creation.

Obviously, the intellectual climate of England in which William Carey grew up was important in shaping his interest in studying natural science, in publishing scientific books, and in teaching science to his students. This scientific climate in England was a result of the biblical teaching that God had created the cosmos with His Logos. Logos is translated as "Word," "Wisdom," or "Reason." The Bible taught that human beings were created with minds similar to God own rationality, so that we may understand the laws of nature and manage the earth. Carey was interested in the physical universe around him because he believed that our heavenly Father had blessed mankind both with a rationality to understand the creation and with an authority to govern it.

Creation And The Inductive Method Of Knowledge

Even before Carey's time, the doctrine of creation as taught in Genesis 1 had already given birth to the inductive method of knowledge. Christian theological assumptions—that

(a) the universe is a stable system run by rational laws ordained by God, and that (b) the universe is a book of God's "natural revelation" which can be and ought to be read by us, so that we may both (c) learn about God's wisdom and power and also (d) govern the earth—implied that objective knowledge was possible through careful observation.

Carey's Enquiry reflects a mind that investigates the facts. His entire appeal for world mission was based on meticulously collected data, not on an appeal of emotions of the moment. One can say that the inductive method that John Calvin had applied to the Scriptures in his Institutes, and that served as the foundation for the scientific method articulated by Francis Bacon was, for the first time, applied by Carey to the field of missiology. The same methodology—finding objective facts (say, about sati) with the help of researchers—made Carey's writings powerful.

It should be obvious that this "religious" theory of how knowledge of truth (epistemology) is to be obtained was the exact opposite of mystical, magical, and esoteric ideas of knowledge then prevalent in India. Hindus did not translate their scriptures from Sanskrit into the languages of the people because truth was not something to be understood rationally. It was to be experienced by "killing" the intellect through various means of meditation and yoga.

Creation And Social Reform

Another implication of the belief that God is the Creator is that He is transcendent—apart from the physical and social realms, and above them. Our ability to change our physical, social, or political environment is directly proportional to our ability to grasp both the significance of God's transcendence and authority over creation and our own God-given authority over creation.

This ramification of the belief that God is the Creator also served as a decisive determinant in the modernization of India. In this basic tenet Carey found a moral basis for opposing evils such as sati. Many Indian reformers (e.g., Jotiba Phule) who succeeded Carey found this idea compelling. Today, ironically, the Western world, in a self-destructive mood, seems to be turning away from this second truth, namely, that, if God is the author of a universe that exists objectively (independent from our experience of it) then reality—whether natural, social, or moral—has a given meaning and definition. This meaning is independent from how we perceive the universe around us.

The significance of this principle for reform can be illustrated with Carey's battle against sati. The culture of idol worship assumes that we are free to decide if a stone is a god or not. It implies that God has not given mankind a revelation of objective truth; therefore we can define reality our selves and give to it whatever meaning we prefer. If this assumption

is true, then a woman is free to imagine that her husband is her god, and that she lives for him. Therefore, after he dies her own life has no meaning. This outrageous conclusion served as the underlying basis for a justification of sati.

For Carey, however, it was God who, as Creator, gave meaning and definition to His creation. God decides who we are, and what the true nature of the husband/wife relation ship ought to be. Therefore, neither one's society nor any individual within that society is finally free to define himself and/or his relationships.

This belief meant that Carey had no problem in judging whether or not sati was evil. For him the relevant question was not whether or not sati was the voluntary act of a particular woman, or whether or not she was forced to kill herself. The objective fact, as far as Carey was concerned, was that a woman's life was neither her own nor her husband's. It was God's. And the Creator had not given us the right to violate His gift of life. Suicide is sin because it considers a life valueless which is, in fact, precious to the Creator. Suicide sees a situation to be hopeless where God expects faith and patience.

The Gospel As The Power Of God For Wholistic Salvation

Conservative Christians have admired William Carey because he reawakened the church to its commission to evangelize the world. Theologically liberal Christians have admired him because he triggered India's social reform movement. Many historians have misunderstood Carey's social action as being incidental to his passion to "save souls."

The truth is clear from his Enquiry: Even before coming to India, Carey had understood that nothing but the Gospel could dispel the social darkness of India. Carey knew the Gospel to be the only effective antidote to social evils. This conviction sustained Carey's chief labor: to make the Bible available to the Indian masses in their own languages.

It is worth repeating that our mistake today is that some who believe the Gospel look upon it merely as a means of private salvation, for going to heaven. They do not seem to realize that the Gospel is the God-given "public truth"—the means of organizing a decent society. Therefore, their faith becomes privately engaging but publicly irrelevant. On the other hand, those "Christian" activists who do not believe the basic truth of the Gospel, that sin is humanity's fundamental problem and that Jesus Christ died and rose again for our sin, attach themselves to ideologies that are most popular in their day. For example, some of my friends, until recently, prided themselves on being Christian-Marxists or Socialists. In contrast to both the conservatives and the liberals, William Carey knew that Jesus is the "Light of the world"—not just the One who lights the way to heaven. Carey sought to reflect that Light in the world.

Many Christians have succumbed to the materialistic presupposition of our age that material reality is basic and that the moral/intellectual/spiritual aspects of reality are secondary, mere by-products of economic reality. Carey believed that the real battle is in the mind. False beliefs lead to wrong behavior and harmful culture. That is why Carey strove to fill the Indian mind with the truth of God's Word. That, he understood, was conversion—the cornerstone in the task of transforming or civilizing.

CONCLUSION

In A New History of Methodism, W. J. Townsend writes,

> Important eras of human progress and national salvation are generally inaugurated and moulded by a man who has understanding of the times, whose ear is open and attuned to respond sympathetically to the sighs and groans of humanity for redemption from the powers of evil, and who has the constructiveness and comprehensiveness of nature to become a builder of a nation and a hero of far reaching reformation.

A. H. Oussoren adds,

> These words may be applied to William Carey. Just like all great leaders of humanity, he not only understood his own time, but also had a clear conception of the times before him. He saw their corruption, their baseness, their frivolity, their deplorable state of affairs everyday.

But unlike most of us, Carey never gave up hope for India because he looked beyond man, beyond society, to God's saving act in human history. Carey put his confidence for our salvation in the power of the Gospel; that is, in the power of the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ to deliver us from our sin.

SECTION TWO: TRANSFORMATIONAL CONSIDERATIONS

Chapter 5

Creation and Transformation: Salvation Means Creation Healed

By Howard A. Snyder[25]

A missionary couple in São Paulo, Brazil, is working to plant churches among newly-arrived poor folks from the interior. But they and the people they work with are increasingly bothered by the worsening pall of air pollution over the city. The Good News they proclaim is transforming people's lives. Does it have anything to say also about transforming the air?

Christians in a North African country have to flee drought and famine caused largely by the destruction of forests and other ecological problems. They find strength and comfort in the Gospel of Christ. Will they also find Gospel answers to ecological disaster?

Scholars at a Christian university in Asia learn that certain species of birds are disappearing, but no one knows why. Is this of any concern to the Gospel? How far does Gospel transformation reach?

Mission as Transformation

Holistic mission, mission as transformation, is becoming a major theme of the global evangelical missions effort.[26] It is based on the affirmation that mission first of all is the mission of the Triune God who sends the Son into the world in the power of the Holy Spirit to bring redemption and the new creation that is the kingdom of God. The Church is in mission because God is in mission. God loved the world so much that he sent his only Son to give us eternal life through faith in him. Therefore the Church is to love the world and bring the Good News to people everywhere.

Biblically speaking, an essential part of holistic mission is Christian responsibility for the created order. Holistic mission encompasses not only issues of evangelism, compassion, and social justice; it includes God's intention for the whole creation.

Authentic Christian mission focuses on the transformation of creation for both theological and strategic reasons. Theological, because a biblically faithful view of mission necessarily includes what the Bible says about God's intent for the created order. But also strategic,

because mission that incorporates creation care is much more persuasive in today's world. Do we want people of all nations and cultures to come to faith in Jesus Christ as their Savior and Lord? Then we should proclaim and demonstrate that Jesus is the renewer of the whole creation, the whole face of the earth. Salvation is that big.

This grand portrayal of Christ both honors our Savior and makes the Good News more persuasive. This is a Gospel of total healing—the healing of creation; the restoration of all things. This is truly the whole Gospel for the whole world.

The Gospel of Jesus Christ is based on what the Bible teaches about creation, redemption and transformation through Jesus Christ. It envisions a transformed New Creation at the end of time. The new creation we now experience through Jesus Christ (2 Cor. 5:17) is the firstfruits not only of our own salvation, but of all creation healed.

The biblical vision of new creation presupposes what Scripture teaches about God's creating the world in the first place. Notice where the Bible itself starts, in the book of Genesis. Yes, all people are sinners in need of God's saving grace. But the Bible does not begin with sin; it begins with creation. Human beings—man and woman together—are created in the image of God and placed in a garden which also reflects the glory of God. Man and woman embody the image of God in a primary sense, while the created order images God in a secondary sense. The beauty, order, coherence, and intricate design of the universe reveal something true and essential about God himself (Rom. 1:20).
Scripture presents salvation as an immense divine plan for the redemption of all creation, "the restoration of all things" (Acts 3:21). We read in Ephesians 1:10 that God has a plan (*oikonomia*) for the fullness of time to bring everything in heaven and earth together in reconciliation under the headship of Jesus Christ—*all things,* things in heaven and things on earth; things visible and invisible. The plan of redemption is as broad as the scope of creation and the depth of sin, for "where sin abounded, grace [has] much more [abounded]" (Rom. 5:20 KJV).

Significantly, the Bible grounds God's glorious work in Jesus Christ in both creation and redemption. Jesus Christ is both "the firstborn of all creation" and "the firstborn from the dead"—affirmations that unite creation and redemption (Col. 1:15, 1:18; cf. John 1:1-14). In the book of Revelation, God is praised in hymns celebrating both creation (Rev. 4:11) and redemption through the blood of Christ (Rev. 5:9). In the Old Testament, the Sabbath, so full of eschatological portent, is grounded both in creation (Ex. 20:11) and redemption from Egyptian slavery (Deut. 5:15). In Genesis, God establishes covenants both for the preservation of creation (Gen. 9:8-15) and for redemption (e.g., Gen. 17:1-8). In multiple ways Scripture weds the themes of creation and transformation. Redemption can never be understood in a fully biblical way unless the full story of creation, and not just human

creation, is kept in view.

The Disease and the Cure

In the biblical picture, the redemption of human beings plays the central role in a story of transformation that begins with "substantial healing" (as Francis Schaeffer called it) now and leads to total restoration, a new heaven and earth, when God's kingdom comes in fullness. To fully understand the Gospel, therefore, we must explore the meaning of Jesus' death and resurrection for the healing and restoration of the whole created order.

The basic story is familiar: Creation, fall, and redemption. It is an amazingly comprehensive story.

God created man and woman in healthful harmony with himself, with each other, and with the created world. They were at peace (*shalom*) with God, with themselves and each other, and with the plants and animals God had made. As Sandy Richter writes, "This was the ideal plan—a world in which [humanity] would succeed in constructing the human civilization by directing and harnessing the amazing resources of the planet under the wise direction of their Creator. Here there would always be enough, progress would not necessitate pollution, expansion would not demand extinction."[27]

Sin, however, brought disruption in a fourfold sense. As Francis Schaeffer pointed out years ago, human disobedience brought alienation between humans and God and as a result an internal alienation within each person (alienation from oneself), alienation between humans, and alienation from nature.[28] These are the spiritual, psychological, sociocultural, and ecological alienations that afflict the whole human family. All derive from sin, and all distort God's good purpose in creation. Therefore they are all concerns of the Gospel of reconciliation which help clarify the Church's mission agenda. *Faithful Christian mission focuses on healing the four alienations or divisions that have resulted from the fall.* This means that working for reconciliation between humans and the created order is an indispensable element in Christian mission. It is part of the Gospel, an essential part of the Good News which Christians offer to the world.

God brings salvation through the work of Jesus Christ—his incarnation, life, death, resurrection, and ongoing reign. Jesus' redemptive work is pictured in broadest scope in John 1, Hebrews 1, Colossians 1, Ephesians 1 and similar passages. These texts are fundamental to a biblical understanding of mission as transformation. Ephesians 2:8-9 states, "For by grace you have been saved through faith, and this is not your own doing, it is the gift of God—not the result of works, so that no one may boast." This truth comes as

an elaboration of what Paul wrote in Ephesian 1:10, which proclaims God's "plan [*oikonomia*] for the fullness of time to gather up [literally, to join together under one head] all thing in [Jesus Christ], things in heaven and things on earth." This is God's "economy" (the literal translation of *oikonomia* and a key term in Pauline and early Christian theology). It is God's "plan" or "administration" that he is accomplishing through Jesus Christ.[29]

The plan of salvation as pictured in texts such as Ephesians 1, Colossians 1, and Hebrews 1 is this: *that God may glorify himself by reconciling all things in Christ*. The biblical vision is of all earth's peoples, and in fact of all creation, united in praising and serving God (Ps. 67:3-5; Rev. 7:9-12; 19:6).

The key idea and dynamic here is *reconciliation*. God's plan is for the restoration of his creation—for overcoming, in judgment and glorious fulfillment, the damage done to persons and nature through the fall. This plan includes not only the reconciliation of people to God, but the reconciliation of "all things in heaven and on earth." As Paul puts it in Colossians 1:20, it is God's intention through Christ "to reconcile to himself all things, whether things on earth or things in heaven, by making peace through his blood, shed on the cross." Jesus Christ brings peace, not only in the sense of forgiveness of sins but in the full biblical sense of *shalom.*

Central to this plan is the reconciliation of persons to God through the blood of Jesus Christ. But the reconciliation won by Christ reaches to all the alienations that resulted from our sin—within ourselves, between persons, between us and our physical environment. The biblical picture therefore is at once personal, ecological, and cosmic. As mind-boggling as the thought is, Scripture teaches that this reconciliation even includes the redemption of the physical universe from the effects of sin as everything is brought under its proper headship in Jesus: "The creation waits with eager longing for the revealing of the children of God. For the creation . . . itself will be set free from its bondage to decay and will obtain the freedom of the glory of the children of God" (Rom. 8:19-21).

In all these passages, Paul begins with the fact of individual and corporate personal salvation through Christ. But he places this personal salvation within a picture of cosmic transformation. We see that the redemption of persons is the *center* of God's plan, but it is not *the circumference* of that plan. Paul switches from a close-up shot to a long-distance view. He uses a zoom lens, for the most part taking a close-up of personal redemption, but periodically zooming to a long-distance, wide-angle view which takes in "all things"—things visible and invisible; things past, present and future; things in heaven and things on earth; all the principalities and powers—everything in the cosmic-historical scene. To God be the glory in heaven and on earth!

Although this comprehensive picture of salvation is most fully elaborated in Paul's writings, it is also the larger biblical view. All the promises of cosmic restoration in the Old Testament apply here, reaching their climax in Isaiah's sublime vision (Is. 11:6-9; 35:1-10; 65:17-25). The basic message of the book of Revelation is the harmonious uniting of all things under the lordship of Christ as all evil, all discord is destroyed (Rev. 1:5-7; 5:5-10; 11:15; 21:1-22:5). In a somewhat different context, this same "summing up" perspective is evident in Hebrews 1-2. Jesus' parables of the kingdom also point in this direction. And Isaiah, Peter and John speak of God creating a new heaven and a new earth (Is. 65:17; 66:22; 2 Pet. 3:13; Rev. 21:1).

The testimony of Scripture is consistent: The same God who created the universe perfect, and sustains it in its fallen condition (Heb. 1:3), will restore all things through the work of Jesus Christ in the power of the Holy Spirit.

Christians know, therefore, that the Gospel of Jesus Christ offers the essential necessary resources for facing all earth's problems, including issues of ecology and the environment. Here the bold claim of Scripture that in Jesus Christ all things cohere (Col. 1:17) takes on deeper and broader meaning. As Charles Colson writes, "Every part of creation came from God's hand, every part was drawn into the mutiny of humanity against God, and every part will someday be redeemed. This means caring about all of life—redeeming people and redeeming culture."[30]

According to the Gospel, the decisive act in history was the resurrection of Jesus Christ. This was the key triumph over death and despair, the reversal of discord and incoherence. Jesus' resurrection *in fact* makes everything new. As G. K. Chesterton wrote,

> On the third day the friends of Christ coming at daybreak to the place found the grave empty and the stone rolled away. In varying ways they realised that the world had died in the night. What they were looking at was the first day of a new creation, with a new heaven and a new earth; and in the semblance of the gardener God walked again in the garden, in the cool not of the evening, but the dawn.[31]

And yet the battle continues. There will yet be many casualties. But we are energized by the assurance that the one who won the decisive victory over evil in his resurrection at a particular point in history will bring the story to final, glorious fulfillment. The goal of history is final harmony and reconciliation, justice and moral symmetry—the ultimate triumph of justice, mercy, and truth. The Apostle Peter called it "the time of universal restoration" (Acts 3:21 NRSV).

The Gospel as the Story of Transformation

Salvation through Jesus Christ by the Holy Spirit is thus the story of how God is redeeming and transforming his creation. The main story and its implications for mission can be summarized in five points:

1. ***God created the universe.*** "By faith we understand that the worlds were prepared by the word of God, so that what is seen was made from things that are not visible" (Heb. 11:3). Therefore the world belongs to God, not to private individuals, economic enterprises, or national governments. Therefore we have no right individually or corporately to mistreat it or claim it solely for our own interests. Human beings are stewards of what God has made.

2. ***The created order is in some deep sense diseased because of sin.*** Although earth's nonhuman biosystems cannot sin, the created order suffers the "enmity" that human rebellion brought into the world (Gen. 3:14-19). "The creation was subjected to futility" and is in "bondage to decay" (Rom 8:20-21). This complex spiritual-physical-moral-ecological disorder is pictured graphically in Old Testament passages such as Hosea 4:1-3:

> There is no faithfulness or loyalty, and no knowledge of God in the land. Swearing, lying, and murder, and stealing and adultery break out; bloodshed follows bloodshed. Therefore the land mourns, and all who live in it languish; together with the wild animals and the birds of the air, even the fish of the sea are perishing.

Disorder, disease, disharmony crying out for healing through the Word of God.

3. ***God has acted in Jesus Christ to reconcile the creation to himself.*** God is bringing transformation and re-creation through the God-Man. In the biblical vision, God acts in Jesus Christ not to save men and women *out of* their environment, but *with* their environment.

The New Testament makes clear the tremendous cost of Jesus' reconciling work— his life of obedience and suffering, his death on the cross. Precisely because Jesus "humbled himself and became obedient to the point of death," God "highly exalted him and gave him a name that is above every name," and all creation will bow before him (Phil. 2:8-11). As both Savior and Model, Jesus calls all who believe in and follow him to a life of discipleship and stewardship, marked by the cross. True disciples of Jesus are to "walk as he walked" (1 Jn. 2:6). Jesus forms a community marked by the cross, participating in the birth pangs of the new creation.

4. ***God has given the Church a mission for this world and the world to come.*** The redemption God is bringing promises a new heaven and a new earth. But what does this

mean? Biblically, it *does not* mean two common but extreme views: It does not mean only saving the earth from oppression or ecological collapse. And it does not mean disembodied eternal life in heaven, with the total destruction of the material universe. Rather, it means a reconciliation between earth and heaven; the heavenly city descending to earth (Rev. 22); the reign of God that is in some way the reconstitution of the whole creation through God's work in Jesus Christ. The model for the new heaven and earth is the literal, physical resurrection of Jesus.

5. ***We are called to live our lives, churches, communities, and economies in harmony with biblical principles of justice, mercy, truth, and responsible interrelationship.*** We thus learn to think interdependently in all areas, including in our understanding of the Church and our relationship to the earth. Christians (and in fact all humanity) have a God-given responsibility to "care for the garden." Good news for the earth, for all God's "creatures great and small," is an integral part of redemption and new creation in Jesus Christ through the Holy Spirit.

Practical Implications for Holistic Mission

The Bible is rich in its teachings about the created order. It gives us not only the big picture of transformation but also practical principles by which this stewardship can be carried out as a part of Christian mission. Calvin DeWitt helpfully outlines four principles that are rooted in Scripture and are highly relevant for the practice of Christian mission globally today:

1. ***The Earthkeeping Principle***: Just as the creator keeps and sustains humanity, so humanity must keep and sustain the creator's creation.
2. ***The Sabbath Principle***: The creation must be allowed to recover from human use of its resources.
3. ***The Fruitfulness Principle***: The fecundity of the creation is to be enjoyed, not destroyed.
4. ***The Fulfillment and Limits Principle***: There are limits set to humanity's role within creation, with boundaries set in place that must be respected.[32]

When such principles are integrated into global mission practice, we will see the healing power of the Gospel as never before in history.

Conclusion

We have a great commission and a wonderful opportunity to make Jesus Christ known today—to proclaim the Gospel of the kingdom; to declare God's glory among the nations. We have a stewardship to fulfill—a stewardship of creation, and a stewardship of God's

many-colored grace (1 Pt. 4:10) which is the essential resource for transforming mission.

The picture traced here could be amplified in many ways. Multiple biblical themes ground the mandate for mission as transformation in this comprehensive sense. The biblical theology of land, from the Old Testament to the New, "grounds" (literally) salvation in God's plan for the whole earth. The theme of the earth as God's habitation implies human respect for and care of nature. The key biblical theme of justice and righteousness—the principal basis for a kingdom of God ethic—rules out harmful exploitation not only of people but of the land. The incarnation and servanthood of Jesus Christ show us what it means to live righteous and godly lives physically, on earth. The biblical doctrine of the Holy Spirit and of the Church as charismatic underscores the role of the Spirit in both creation and the renewal of creation (e.g., Ps. 104:30).[33] Finally, the doctrine of the Trinity itself is rich in ecological insights, as it implies mutual interdependence and self-giving in behalf of the other, rather than self-centered dominance or exploitation. The created order is the way it is because of the way God is. Its unity and diversity reflect in some deep sense the diversity-within-unity that is the Trinity.

The same God who is concerned with the renewal of the Church is concerned with the renewal of creation. The same Spirit who hovers over the Church hovers over the waters and wants to bring both into reconciliation under the headship of Jesus Christ. If we are concerned about mission in its truest sense, we will be concerned about every good thing God has made. Conversely, if we are genuinely concerned with God's world, we will want to see the Holy Spirit renew God's people, sending a revival of such depth that it not only stirs our hearts but also heals our land.

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Chapter 6
The Kingdom of God and the Process of Transformation

William R. O'Brien[34]

The Kingdom of God is real. It is fact, not fiction.

The Kingdom of God is both process and climax. Already, but not yet.

Emmanual, God-with-us in Jesus the Christ, announced the coming of the Kingdom. As a matter of fact, Jesus is the living presence of the Kingdom of God, the Kingdom of Heaven.

An unbelieving world says talk about the Kingdom of God is fantasy. An agnostic mind might acknowledge it is a kind of unrealizable idealism. What does the Bible reveal?

The Kingdom of God and the *missio Dei*

The Holy Tri-unity created a human community in God's image—on purpose, for a purpose. The economy and ecology of the Kingdom were entrusted to this stewarding community. The Creator of the cosmos chose a garden as a representative *location* for the imaged community. Shalom was its *status*—wholeness, harmony. Collective responsibility to rule over all living things was the assigned *task.*

D.T. Niles describes God's initiative: "The 'Imago Dei' is God's foundation covenant with man. Now, it is open to man to reap what God has sown. (Niles 1962:46)

Dallas Willard states that we were made to have dominion within an appropriate domain of reality. "In creating human beings God made them to rule, to reign, and to have dominion in a limited sphere." (Willard 1998:21)

The Tempter appeared. Cunningly, he appealed to the eye, to the taste, and to pride. Humans yielded to the temptation to live beyond and outside the limited sphere for which they were designed. Douglas John Hall reminds us, "In the Jewish sense, the trouble with human unrighteousness and sin is not that it takes away from my personal fulfillment, but that it introduces 'dividing walls of hostility' between myself and my neighbor, myself and God who is the source and ground of my life, and myself and creation."
(Hall 1990:55)

The Tempter's promise that "you will not die" rings hollow. Relationships die. Walls of

hostility become the grave markers.

The Biblical narrative then unfolds the drama of redemption and the transformative nature of the Kingdom of God.

The Abrahamic covenant identified the role of faith and obedience in bringing God's blessing *to panta ta ethne.*

The Mosaic covenant established the ground rules for the collective community chosen to be a bridge people between God and all peoples.

The prophets were God's megaphones articulating the concept of the Kingdom, even though the term itself is never used in Hebrew scripture. References to God as King of the earth and King of Israel occur often. The Prophets were constantly calling the Covenant Community back to shalom status and the principles of faithful bridging for which they were chosen.

Behind it all was the Word, always with God, always was God. The Word became flesh and dwelled among us. The Incarnation defined life. Jesus the Christ was life. Jesus announced the Kingdom. He was the Kingdom. That is fact. The Kingdom is here, already. Jesus lived it. Jesus set it in motion. Jesus empowered it.

Jesus held in counter-tension the reality of the Kingdom being present but not yet fully come. In Mark 1:15 and Matthew 4:25 Jesus preached the Kingdom as a present reality. In Matthew 25:31-46 he presents it in an eschatological future. In its present/future tense, the "message he gave was the Kingdom of God. It was the center and circumference of all he taught and did" (Jones 1940:53) The Kingdom always was. The Kingdom is coming. But, as E. Stanley Jones says so emphatically, "The essential thing to be burned into our thinking is the fact that the Kingdom *is*."[35]

Satan resisted the reality and presence of the Kingdom. He made high-sounding offers to Jesus in the wilderness. In an attempted replay of the first Eden, the Tempter approached Jesus through the eye, the taste and pride once again. As the Prince of the principalities and powers who have their own limited kingdoms, at the end of the day Satan could not get Jesus to exchange the real thing for a veneer. But the temptations were real, and a proto-type of all the approaches the Tempter makes to us.

Whether through false offers, subtle influence, or naked intimidation, Satan tries to steal our attention and derail our commitment. We live in the same counter-tension that Jesus did. Dallas Willard reminds us that our own kingdom is simply the range of our effective

will. We can choose to succumb to the lust of the eye, the lust of the flesh, and the pride of life. Or we can choose to follow the Christ in word and deed. Following Jesus calls for patience in the process.

Jesus vividly illustrated the process built into Kingdom growth: seed growing secretly (Mark 4:26-29); the wheat and the tares (Matthew 13:24-30); the mustard seed (Matthew 13:31-32); the leaven (Matthew 13:33). But John the Baptist had a major question for Jesus in the light of slow and even invisible growth of the Kingdom from a human perspective: "Are you the one who was to come, or should we expect someone else?" Jesus' response was, "The blind receive sight, the lame walk, those who have leprosy are cured, the deaf hear, the dead are raised, and the good news is preached to the poor. Blessed is the man who does not fall away on account of me." The wise person is like the one who sold all in order to buy the field in which was found a great treasure, or to buy the one pearl of greater value than all others.

"An all-important fact in Jesus' proclamation of the Kingdom was the recovery of the prophetic tension between history and eschatology in a new and even more dynamic form. In his person and mission, the Kingdom of God had come near in history in fulfillment of the prophetic hope; but it would yet come in eschatological consummation in the future at a time known only to God." (Mark 13:32)[36]

Aside from the book of Revelation, the rest of the New Testament does not use kingdom terms so much. Paul speaks passionately of the crucified and risen Lord. Those words are synonymous with the King and the Kingdom. The writer of Hebrews quotes Psalm 45 in describing the Son: "Your throne, O God, will last for ever and ever, and righteousness will be the scepter of your kingdom."

The Kingdom has come. The Kingdom is coming.

The Role of the Church

Bishop Lesslie Newbigin states that if you don't understand the Kingdom, it's because you are facing the wrong direction. Turn around! Do a U-turn![37] It is only in the turning, the *metanoia*, that we are given the mind to understand what it means to become a citizen of the Kingdom of God. Citizens of the Kingdom comprise a community of Christ-followers. The community, the Church, is not the Kingdom

Jesus relates to the Kingdom differently than he does to the Church. Jesus is the soul of the Church. Jesus is the Head of the Church, but he is not the Church. For those who have

done the U-turn and centered their lives on the Christ, they join in the community called to be stewards of the good news that the King and the Kingdom has come to redeem, to restore a relationship with God, and to set in motion a transformation process for all creation.

The Church is the body of Christ planted among those who are still facing the wrong direction. Citizens of the Kingdom will never withdraw from the 'pagani' among whom they have been placed. They will not retreat from the struggle against the principalities and powers, nor will they withdraw into an isolated fellowship that hides its light and hordes its salt.

Paul's appeal to the believers in Rome, and ultimately to all of us, was to offer

ourselves as living sacrifices, holy and pleasing to God—which is our spiritual worship. And do not conform any longer to the pattern of this world, but be transformed by the renewing of our mind. (Romans 12:1-2) The words "conform" and "transformed" in Greek are present imperative tenses, suggesting repetitive action. In other words, we are not to keep on keeping on conforming to this world's patterns, but we are to keep on keeping on being "metamorphed" into Christ's likeness by the continuing renewal of the mind.

The continuing transformation process is necessary because of who we are personally, and corporately as the Church. George Eldon Ladd states the reason candidly, "The empirical Church has a twofold character. It is the people of the Kingdom, and yet it is not the ideal people, for it includes some who are actually not sons of the Kingdom. Thus entrance into the Kingdom means participation in the Church; but entrance into the Church is not necessarily synonymous with entrance into the Kingdom."[38]

Paul urged the believers in Philipi to have the mind and attitude of Christ, "who being in very nature God, did not consider that equality something to be grasped, but made himself nothing, taking the very nature of a servant, being made in human likeness. And being found in appearance as a man, he humbled himself and became obedient to death—even death on a cross!" (Philippians 2:6-8)

Jesus taught his disciples to pray that the Kingdom would come and God's will be done on earth as it is in heaven. "The purpose of God with human history is nothing less than to bring out of it…an eternal community of those who were once thought to be just 'ordinary human beings.' Because of God's purposes for it, this community will, in its way, pervade the entire created realm and share in the government of it. God's precreation intention to have that community as a special dwelling place or home will be realized. He will be its prime sustainer and most glorious inhabitant."[39]

The Church, then, is both sign and agent of the Kingdom of God. In apprenticing itself to Christ, the faith community is able to demonstrate the foretaste of a shalom-kind of wholeness totally unnatural to a self-centered society. The sign is always pointing to the Indweller and Sustainer of the quality of life it enjoys. As an agent of the Kingdom, the Church understands its role of servant involvement with persons, communities, systems and structures.

The Church has no mission of its own. It is servant to the *missio Dei*. The Church is actually the hermeneutic of the Gospel. The Church in action is the live interpreter of the Gospel. As diversely gifted stewards, the Church in action is the corporate translator of the Bible. What an awesome opportunity is ours. The King has made us to be ambassadors of reconciliation. An ambassador represents one king in the court of another.

In the role we have, we represent a King who can never be overthrown, and one to whom all earthly kings will one day bow. Because of that, we cannot boast or embrace a triumphalistic attitude. We must represent our King in the disarming style that Jesus assumed while on earth among us—a servant.

Because the King we represent through the Church is about redeeming all of creation, we will be concerned about everything God is concerned about. How can we unleash the transforming qualities of the Kingdom to focus on the earth, the ocean worlds, the water tables, the air, local and global economies, healthy bodies, educated minds, justice, fairness, and humans created in the image of God?

What if an inquiring mind that was imprisoned in the cell of skepticism, doubt and lostness sent a representative to the Church to ask, "Do you represent the One who was to come, or should I look elsewhere?" Could we send back the same report that Jesus sent to John the Baptist? The blind receive their sight, the lame walk, those who have HIV/AIDS are cured, the deaf hear, the dead are raised, and the good news is preached to the poor, as well as to all those who have never even heard the Gospel for the first time?

Conclusion

The role of a transformer is to step down the massive amount of power flowing through a line so that it is usable for our needs. As servants of Jesus Christ, we are not only being transformed, but become servant transformers, channeling the mighty power of God for the appropriate application to the spiritual, emotional and physical needs of humankind.

To paraphrase Dallas Willard, as servants of God and the mission of God, we are in loving cooperation in a shared endeavor in which God's aims are our aims. Willard relates five dimensions of our eternal life in The Kingdom Among Us: Confidence and reliance upon Jesus as the Son of Man appointed to save us; this confidence leads to a desire to be his apprentice in living in and from the Kingdom of God; the abundance of life realized through apprenticeship to Jesus leads to total obedience; obedience leads to, and then issues from the pervasive inner transformation of the heart and soul; and finally there is power to work the works of the Kingdom.[40]

Who but God could ever think of such a partnership, much less dare to implement it through the likes of us? The rule of God in the realm of all creation chooses the Church as sign, agent, witness and custodian of the Kingdom!

"To him who loves us and has freed us from our sins by his blood, and has made us to be

a kingdom and priests to serve his God and Father—to him be glory and power for ever and ever! Amen." Revelation 1:6

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Chapter 7

Christology and Transformation—a focus on Genealogy and Transformational Roles

By Doug Pennoyer

While it can be debated how much the writers of the New Testament differed in their missiological perspectives and even methods, one should really focus on missiology from the Christological foundation. *missio Dei* after all is God's mission, and the Messiah, the Christ, is God's Son who is present as the central part of God's plan in the Old and New Testament to carry out the mission.

There are a variety of ways to accomplish the task of connecting the Old and New Testament *missio Dei* dots and many ways to show the consistency of the mission from the patriarchs to the apostles. We could start with the Christ's own statement that he was anointed to preach the good news to the poor, proclaim freedom for the prisoners and recovery of sight for the blind, to release the oppressed, and proclaim the year of the Lord's favor (Luke 4:18,19). We will keep that in mind as we take two other examples. Since mission is about transformation, the two examples selected here have two main purposes: the first (the Bethlehem Gene Pool), focuses on stories of transformation in the genealogy of Jesus to illustrate that those transformational narratives illustrate not only *missio Dei* principles close to the heart of God but can be in turn linked to the actions of Jesus as He carried out the mission amongst His earthly generation; and, the second (Sheep and Shepherds, Wolves, Lambs and Lions) highlights transformational roles and relationships which connect Christ to God's mission, and to us, and tie all of us together as participants in *missio Dei*.

Samuel and Sugden's Mission as Transformation has a number of articles that addresses this topic. Our intention with this presentation which focuses on Genealogy and Transformational Roles is not to duplicate those excellent discussions but to approach the topic with another Biblical lens.

The Bethlehem Gene Pool: Mission as Transformation in the Genealogy and Life of Jesus (Matt 1: 1-6)

> 1 A record of the genealogy of Jesus Christ the son of David, the son of Abraham: 2 Abraham was the father of Isaac, Isaac the father of Jacob, Jacob the father of Judah and his brothers, 3 Judah the father of Perez and Zerah,

> whose mother was Tamar, Perez the father of Hezron, Hezron the father of Ram, 4 Ram the father of Amminadab, Amminadab the father of Nahshon, Nahshon the father of Salmon, 5 Salmon the father of Boaz, whose mother was Rahab, Boaz the father of Obed, whose mother was Ruth, Obed the father of Jesse, 6 and Jesse the father of King David. David was the father of Solomon, whose mother had been Uriah's wife (Matthew 1:1-6, NIV).

Many people appear to be bored by the genealogy at the start of the New Testament. However, it provides us with a convenient way to a cross a bridge from the Old Testament ancestors of Christ to His New Testament transformational mission activities. The Bethlehem gene pool is the genetic and cultural background of the Messiah and this is an unusual genealogy for two readily apparent reasons. Women are normally excluded from Jewish genealogies yet in the first six verses we find four women: Tamar, Rahab, Ruth, and Uriah's wife (Bathsheba). Equally astounding is the fact that all four are Gentiles. Köstenberger and O'Brien believe "… is doubtful whether Matthew includes these women in his genealogy *because they are Gentiles* (italics original)," noting that the fifth woman in the later part of the genealogy is Mary and this would not fit the pattern. They suggest that "it is more likely that the women are featured to highlight the unusual circumstances that led to their incorporation in Jesus' ancestry: seduction, prostitution, kinsman-redemption, adultery—and a virgin birth! (2001: 88)." Others like R.E. Brown (1977: 71-74) and Hagner (1993: 10) relegate the foreign factor to a secondary level.

However, it seems natural that Mary, as the mother of Jesus, would receive a listing regardless, for the rest of Chapter 1 after the genealogy, and even Chapter 2, is the story of a couple, Joseph and Mary, and the virgin birth, the visit of the Magi, the escape to Egypt, and the return to Nazareth. In each of these four scenarios the mother Mary is mentioned (1:18, 24; 2:11; 2:14; 2:21). Viewed in this sequential way, the listing with Joseph and Mary as a couple in the genealogy is simply a prelude to the couple's joint activity in the two chapters.

Placing the foreign factor down to a secondary purpose level has further problems. Shouldn't we ask the question why three foreigners and another who was married to a foreigner are involved in these unusual circumstances and featured in the narrative of the Old Testament? If a sovereign God is infinitely capable of protecting the genealogical line of His Son, the Messiah, why did he allow these Gentile intrusions into the Hebrew ancestral line? No, I see the purposeful hand of God in ushering in, through human choice and activity, the foreign factor, and Matthew faithfully recorded it. As Seccombe has stated so eloquently: "The Old Testament strains forward to a greater king than David, a greater revelation than Moses', a better priesthood than Aaron's, a more effective atonement than the temple's, a better covenant than Sinai, and *a mission to embrace all the nations of the*

earth (2000: 115, italics added). The mission to embrace all nations is properly placed within the first six verses of the New Testament. It's highlighted by consecutive listings of women who were grafted by divine design into David's righteous Branch (Jer. 23:5). It is their stories of crisis and transformation that will provide us a look into missiological motifs that began in the Old Testament and are carried forward into Jesus' ministry. For the purposes of this discussion paper we will briefly walk through each narrative and end with transformational themes.

Tamar, a Canaanite from Chezib (Kezib) in the area of Adullam, southwest of Bethlehem, provides a story that seldom finds its way into the Sunday School curriculum but is the kind of raw true life drama that Hollywood loves to turn into movies (Genesis 38: 6-30). Since it is a less familiar life story than the other three women with foreign connections in Jesus' genealogy, a summary of the events are provided here. Judah selects Tamar as a wife for his first son, Er, who is so wicked God puts him to death. Judah then asks his second son Onan to fulfill his cultural duty as a brother-in law and provide children for his dead brother's line by helping Tamar conceive. Onan, however, is obstinate about the matter and because the children will not be his own, he only obeys half of Judah's instructions. Each time with Tamar he interrupts the process so that there is no chance for Tamar to become pregnant. God is again displeased with Judah's second son and puts him to death.

Judah fearful that his third son, Shelah will die just like his brothers, asks Tamar to go back and live with her father until Shelah grows up. Judah's wife dies, and Shelah is now grown but he is not sent to be Tamar. Tamar learns that Judah will be coming through a location to the shear the sheep so she dresses up as a veiled prostitute and waits on the road for him. He doesn't recognize her and solicits her business, leaving his seal, its cord and his staff as security for the future payment of a young goat. Tamar returns to her widow's clothes. Later Judah sends a goat with a friend to the prostitute's roadside place but he fails to find any record of her in that area.

Three months later, Judah is told that Tamar is guilty of prostitution and sends for her with the intention of burning her to death, the penalty of that day for widows who engaged in prostitution. She sends back his seal, its cord and his staff as the identification badge of the man who made her pregnant. A shocked Judah says: "She is more righteous than I, since I wouldn't give her to my son Shelah (Gen. 38: 26, NIV)." Tamar bears twins, Zerah, and Perez, who is in the Jesus genealogy. (Matt. 3:3).

Tamar, the first of foreign women in the Matthew genealogy, is not the first trickster in the Jesus line for she is preceded by Abraham who passed his wife off as his sister; Jacob, with Rebekah, who deceived his Issac and stole Esau's birthright; and Laban, with Leah,

who switched the bride at Jacob's wedding (see Engar 1990; Steinberg 1988). The story first of all demonstrates that God choose to insert a foreigner early on in the Messiah's line, but we are also introduced to a theme that three of the four women illustrate (Tamar, Rahab, and Batsheba)—that sinners, yes even public sinners, are not excluded. And, sin has its consequences for the Judah Tamar relationship produced illegitimate children and children of a "forbidden marriage" could not enter the assembly of the Lord, "down to the tenth generation" (Deut. 23:2). David became King ten generations later.

Rahab, a Canaanite prostitute, lived in the pagan city of Jericho and hid two of Joshua's spies on her roof top. She lies about their whereabouts and sends a group of pursuers on a wild goose chase. Rahab announces her faith in the Israelite God by saying: "the LORD your God is God in heaven above and on the earth below (Joshua 2:11)." She makes an agreement with the spies which later results in the protection of her house and household. Rahab is cited in Hebrews 11 as a woman of faith and in James 2: 25 for her good deeds. She's the second foreigner in the Matthew genealogy and the second one with a shady background thus accentuating the fact that our past does not prevent us from having a personal relationship with God; but our decision to follow Him or reject now does.

Ruth's story, while one of traumatic loss and extreme hardship, does not involve a sin like Tamar, Rahab, and Bathsheba. A Moabite widow, her vow to follow both her mother-in-law, Naomi, back to her hometown and her mother-in-law's God as her God, has become the most famous vow in the Bible:

> "Where you go I will go, and where you stay, I will stay. Your people will be my people and your God my God. Where you die, I will die and there I will be buried. May the Lord deal with me, be it ever so severely, if anything but death separates you and me (Ruth 1: 16,17 NIV)."

This third foreigner is unique for another reason, she returned to Bethlehem with Naomi and discovered the law of the kinsman-redeemer, a law to help widows survive. The kinsman was the widow's closest relative. He could marry the widow, if appropriate, and save her from the impoverishment and loneliness. Boaz, the man who owns the fields where she gleans every day becomes her kinsman-redeemer, marries her and together they have Obed, the grandfather of King David. Ruth teaches us that God looks at our commitment and faithfulness, not our wealth and status. If we are poor, the Lord will provide. If we are strangers, He will be our friend. If we are without a family, He will place us in His family.

Bathsheba, born in Giloh southwest of Hebron in Judah, is the granddaughter of Ahithopel (1Chron. 27:33,34; 2 Sam. 16:23) and the daughter of Eliam (2 Sam. 11: 3; 2 Sam. 23:4),

also known as Ammiel (1 Chron. 3:5). She married Uriah the Hittite (2 Sam.23:29). In a familiar Biblical love triangle, she becomes involved with King David, whose lust of seeing her bathe on a rooftop leads both of them into adultery and the king through a deeper cycle of deception and the murder of her husband. Eventually David acknowledges his sin and ends up as the "man after Gods own heart (2 Sam. 13 and Acts 13)." David and Bathsheba experience the loss of that first child (2 Sam.12:18) and David's family falls apart with the rape by David's son Ammon of his half sister Tamar (13:14); the murder of Ammom by Absolom, Tamar's full bother (13:29); the rebellion of Absolom (15:10) in which Bathsheba's grandfather Ahithopel a former trusted advisor to David switches sides then later commits suicide; David running for his life (15:14); and, the death of Absolom (18:14). Sin has terrible consequences and David and Bathsheba paid a high price. Psalm 51 is the record of David's repentance, restoration, and the rest of his life is a narrative of divine transformation.

Bathsheba holds a unique place in the genealogy of Jesus. Matthew does not mention her name but emphasizes that she is Uriah's wife (1:6). She is the ancestral grandmother of both Mary and Joseph for her two sons by David–Solomon and Nathan are the ancestors of Joseph and Mary respectively. The Matthew 1 genealogy is Joseph's line through Solomon (v.16) and Luke 3 is Mary's line through Nathan (v.31). We learn from this tragic case of an adulterous relationship between a King and a beautiful woman that sin can be forgiven and If we are repentant, we place ourselves and our family in a position to be blessed by God and included in His family. This is a clear and powerful narrative which is directly linked to mission as transformation.

Genealogical Order and Geographical Origins

An interesting thing happens when we shuffle the four women from the genealogical order in Matthew 1 to their geographical associations using Bethlehem as a central point. Figure 1 illustrates this process. In the genealogy, Tamar, from Chezib (Kezib) in the area of Adullam, southwest of Bethlehem, is first; Rahab from Jericho, northeast of Bethlehem is second; Ruth from Moab, southeast of Bethlehem is third; and, Bathsheba, fourth, is from Giloh in Judah southwest of Bethlehem but is listed as Uriah's wife, who is a Hittite from the northwest. Looking at the result, the circle diagram in the right hand side of Figure 1, we have a graphic illustration of the *mssio Dei* motif that the good news born that Christmas day in Bethlehem is for the east, the west, the north and the south. And in the genealogical record they all converged into the person of Jesus Christ, the Messiah with all-world genealogical connections. Could it be that God is saying to us today from the pages of His Son's genealogy: "I purposefully included the nations in my Son's line, your mandate is to help bring about their spiritual transformation so that they can take their place my family."

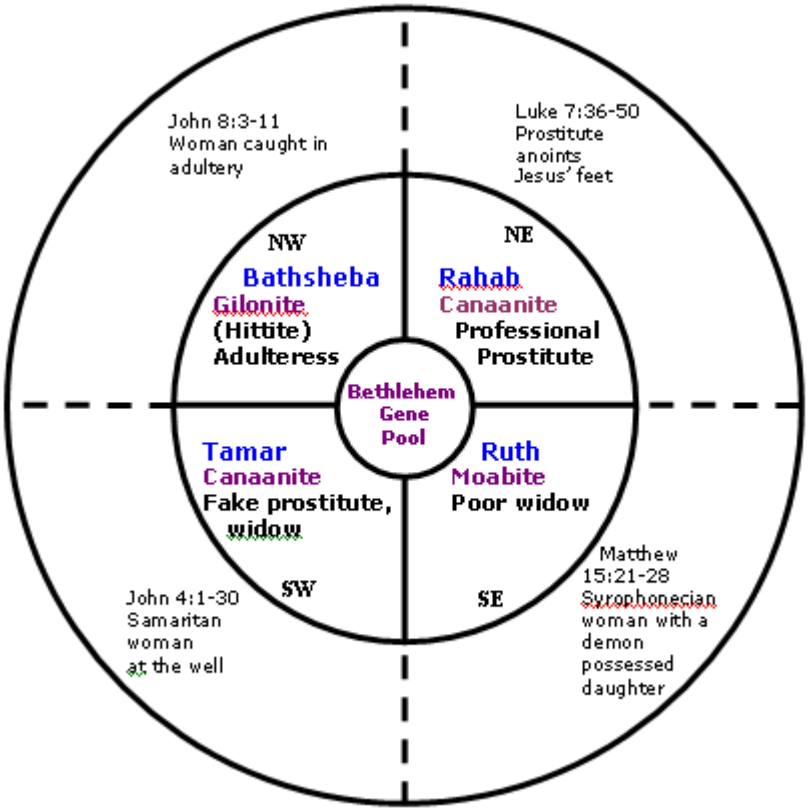


Figure 1
Jesus' Genealogy and Ministry Events
Which Link Parallel Mission Transformational Themes

Are their commonalities in Christ's encounters with people in the New Testament and the four women in Matthew's genealogy? Nathan's response to a repentant David: "The Lord has taken away your sin. You are not going to die" (2 Sam. 12:13b) is echoed by Christ in his statement to the women caught in adultery: "Neither do I condemn you….Go now and leave your life of sin" **(**John 8:11). David, and Bathsheba, by law both deserved the death penalty; yet just as mercy was shown to the woman caught in adultery, mercy and forgiveness flowed in their direction. Figure 1 also suggests common transformational themes between Rahab and the sinful woman who anointed Jesus' feet; Tamar and the Samaritan woman at the well; and Ruth and the Syrophonecian woman with a demon possessed daughter. In the case of Rahab and woman who anointed Jesus' feet both

were prostitutes; both entered into a costly relationship (hiding the spies, expending the perfume); and both exhibited characteristics of faith (faith in God of the spies, and loving, weeping faith in Jesus that resulted in Jesus' statement to the prostitute: "Your faith has saved you, go in peace (Luke 7: 50)." Rahab's acknowledgment that "the Lord your God is God in heaven and earth below" (Joshua 2:11) and her actions in preserving the lives of the spies because they were God's representatives earned her a special place throughout Biblical record as a righteous woman of faith (Heb. 11:31, James 2:25).

Tamar and the Samaritan women at the well share foreigner status, troubled marriage situations, and a secret. Tamar's case is culturally and Biblically complicated, but God apparently honored her efforts to receive the justice (an extended family line) that the culture initially denied but should have been extended to her. Both women experienced several changes in husbands, and both concealed facts. God places Tamar Canaanite in the Messiah's genealogy, and Christ makes an unusual revelation to a foreigner, a mixed blood, that he is the Messiah: "I who speak to you am he (John 4: 26)."

Ruth and the Syrophonesian Greek woman (Mark 7:26), referred to as a Canaanite by Matthew (15:22) share foreigner status and a persistent, clinging faith. Ruth experiences traumatic loss but stays with Naomi her mother-in-law, leaves her homeland for her and eventually is able to leave poverty widowhood through kinsman redemption. We don't know how long the Greek woman suffered with a demon-possessed daughter but her depth of persistence indicates an abnormal desperation possibly aggravated by time. Both clung to family members and refused to abandon them in the midst of crisis. Ruth believed that God loved her and would provide for her, and the Greek woman apparently believed in the healing power of Jesus because she shouted after the disciples, became somewhat of an irritation (Matt.15:23) and begged Jesus to heal her daughter. And it is the only time in the Gospels that Christ is addressed as "Lord" (See Matt.15:27, Mark 7:28). God rewards Ruth with a husband, a child, and family property. Jesus heals the Greek's daughter by dismissing the demons thus returning a life to a mother.

We do not know if the record of Christ's encounters with individuals in the Gospels were divine appointments designed to call our attention to important themes from the heart of God. Did a sovereign, all powerful God who has demonstrated that he can choose to communicate through symbolic systems, want us to discover that he implanted in the genealogy of Jesus, a number of important points about the mission and the Gospel? The discussion above and Figure 1 is a first attempt to investigate the parameters of that question.

Sheep and Shepherds, Wolves, Lambs and Lions: Transformational Roles (John 10:11-18, Rev. 20)

I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep. The hired hand is not the shepherd who owns the sheep. So when he sees the wolf coming, he abandons the sheep and runs away. Then the wolf attacks the flock and scatters it. The man runs away because he is a hired hand and cares nothing for the sheep. I am the good shepherd; I know my sheep and my sheep know me--just as the Father knows me and I know the Father--and I lay down my life for the sheep. I have other sheep that are not of this sheep pen. I must bring them also. They too will listen to my voice, and there shall be one flock and one shepherd. The reason my Father loves me is that I lay down my life--only to take it up again. No one takes it from me, but I lay it down of my own accord. I have authority to lay it down and authority to take it up again. This command I received from my Father.

John 10 is perhaps most used as a statement on the mission of Christ and applied to the task of the Church. Christ uses the Shepherd and the flock, figures of speech, to communicate His mission:

"I have other sheep, which are not of this fold; I must bring them also, and they will hear My voice; and they will become one flock with one shepherd (v. 16)."

This was preceded by a discussion of the duties of the Good Shepherd who calls the sheep (v.3,16); knows them because of a relationship with them (v. 14); willingly lays down His life for them (v.15, 17); defends them from wolves and thieves (v.1,8, 12); having sacrificed His life, He can return to life again(v.17,18); and finally, he gives His sheep eternal life (v. 28).

In His transformational roles, Christ is the Good Shepherd of the lost world and us, and the Lamb of God who follows the commands and authority of the Father. While Christ did not refer to himself as the Lamb of God in the John 10 passage, He was already identified as such in the first chapter of John: “The next day he (*John the Baptist*) saw Jesus coming to him and said, "Behold, the Lamb of God who takes away the sin of the world (1:29)!” It is this sacrificial lamb motif that runs like an unbroken thread through the Old Testament beginning with Genesis 12 when Issac asked the question. “Where is the lamb…?” (v. 8), and Abraham responded, “ God himself will provide the lamb…” (v.9). The threads are woven together in Isaiah 53 where the sheep who have gone astray meet with the one who was led like a lamb to the slaughter and a sheep taken to the shearers so God can lay on Him the iniquity of a sinful world. The duality of the Messianic transformational roles as both sheep and shepherd continues in Isaiah with the one who “…tends his flock like a shepherd. He gathers the lambs in his arms and carries them close to his heart. He gently

leads those who have young (40:11)." In a mission conference setting a speaker could challenge a gathering of the Christian sheep by saying: "We cannot always retire in the safety of the fold of John 10, or continue to feast and lie down in the green pastures of Psalm 100, when the Good Shepherd is calling us to shepherd His sheep (John 21:17) and find the lost lambs (John 10:16). We are His sheep, but we are also their shepherd just as Christ is the Lamb of God and the Good Shepherd of the World."

Peter's transformation from sheep to shepherd occurred after Christ followed through with His dual transformational role as the Lamb of God and the Good Shepherd. Christ opened up The Way by way of the cross and the empty tomb, and provided the Holy Spirit power for Peter to be transformed via personal repentance and reconciliation into his own dual mission roles of a following sheep with Christ as the calling Shepherd, and a shepherd who called lost sheep while training other shepherds (John 20, Acts 2, 1 Peter 5:1-4).

The John passage also introduces another element that requires transformational role activity in the mission of protecting the flock and finding the lost sheep—the wolf. There is a long tradition of identifying the wolf in this passage with the Devil, and other certainly scriptures portray the wolves as at least attackers on the spiritual flock for example in Matt. 7:15, and Acts 20:29-30. To identify the wolf as the Devil would clearly fit with the series of later passages in John (12:20-36; 14:30-31; 16:8-11) that do address the Evil One (see Neyrey 2001:16f). If the Devil is the wolf, and we will take this position, an earlier passage, John 8 gives a direct reference when Jesus called the unbelieving Jews children of the Devil (8:44) and they in turn suggested that he was demon possessed (8:48), a charge the Jews again delivered in John 10:20. Also the passage in Hebrews 2:14,15 contains the same John 10 wolf/death themes of defeating two things—the devil and death: "Since the children have flesh and blood, he too shared in their humanity so that by his death he might destroy him who holds the power of death--that is, the devil-- and free those who all their lives were held in slavery by their fear of death." On a lighter side, if after his charge to the overseers to be shepherds of the flock, and his statement on the Chief Shepherd who rewards the faithful (1Peter 5:2,4), Peter had used "wolf" instead of a "roaring lion" for the Devil in 5:8, it would have paralleled John 10 nicely and allowed us the joy of contextualizing the classic Russian folktale, Peter and the Wolf.

Figure 2 Sheep & Shepherds, Lions, Wolves, & Dragons presents a series of equational ("equals" **=**) and oppositional ("defeats" **X**) statements to illustrate the results of the transformational roles of the Lamb of God/the Good Shepherd. Mission as transformation then, involves not only a gathering of the lost sheep who should take their place as transformed shepherds, it is the realization of the continuing and eventual resounding defeat of the wolf who works to disperse the flock. Figure 3 shows seven historical contexts past, present, and future that are the setting for this engagement. In summary, the

Lamb/Shepherd transformational theme starts in Genesis and ends in Revelation. Along the way it consistently calls our attention to Christ's mission and His transformational roles. It challenges us be transformed in our dual role as His sheep and shepherd, bringing others to him for transformation.

The Lamb of God = The Good Shepherd
John 1: 29 John 10:11,14

The Wolf = The Devouring Lion
John 10:12 1 Peter 5:8

The Devouring Lion = The Red Dragon
I Peter 5:8 Rev. 12:9

The Lion of Judah = The Lamb of God
Rev. 5:5 Rev. 5:6

The Lamb of God **X** The Red Dragon
Rev. 5: 11 Rev. 20:10

The Lion of Judah **X** The Devouring Lion

The Lamb of God **X** The Devouring Lion

The Good Shepherd **X** The Wolf

Figure 2 Sheep & Shepherds, Lions, Wolves & Dragons

Score: Lamb of God 7 Devouring Lion 0

1. Thrown out of heaven (Luke 10, Rev.12)
2. Rebuked at Jesus' temptation (Matt. 4)
3. Demons cast out by Jesus (Gospels)
4. Defeated at the cross and resurrection (Heb. 2:14)
5. Demons cast out by disciples (N.T. to now)
6. Bound for 1,000 years (Rev. 20:1-3)
7. Cast into the Lake of Fire (Rev. 20:7-10)

Figure 3. The Lamb of God versus the Devouring Lion

Observations from the Bethlehem Gene Pool and Transformational Roles

1. God's mission is to the whole world. He included foreigners in the Messianic line making His Son an all-world Jesus who died for the sins of the whole world. He searches for the sheep who are in the other flock.

2. One's past, social standing, ethnic origin, or any human experience does not disqualify a person from entrance into a relationship with Him. Foreigners, prostitutes, impoverished and socially disconnected widows, rulers who misuse abuse their position of power, people who commit adultery and murder—all are found in the Jesus' genealogy.

3. He is concerned about personal, spiritual and social transformation and redemption. Ruth, a widowed, displaced, on welfare Moabite is transformed and redeemed in both spiritual and social settings.

4. Human response and acknowledgment of God's viewpoint followed by actions which confirm the divine-human alignment are transformational processes. Rahab stopped being a prostitute, Tamar lived out her life as an unmarried widow, Bathsheba (and David) did not commit further adultery after marriage, and David did not ever murder anyone again.

5. Persistent, passionate faith toward God which may appear risky from a human standpoint is often divinely rewarded. Tamar did not quit seeking social justice available to her under the cultural rules of the day, but her tricky problem solving approach opened the risk that she could be burned to death. In the end Jacob issued a statement about her actions before God and characterized her as "more righteous than I." Rahab hid the spies, lied to the authorities, and took the risk of death as a Jericho traitor. Ruth in a demonstration of total loyalty to her Israelite family (and God), invoked a non-abandonment clause, stayed with mother-in-law and risked peril on a long journey and a life of poverty in a foreign land. The Syrophonecian lady achieved an audience with Jesus through persistence; did not retreat when He initially gently rebuffed her with a reference to the primacy of His mission to the Jews, not the Gentiles (her social category); and, entered into His metaphorical retort which characterized the Jews as children and the Gentiles as little household pet dogs with a witty reply that carried the risk of further rebuff.

6. Repentance brings mercy, grace and forgiveness; a continuing relationship with God; and even future blessings. But there may be consequences, severe trauma in human relationships and everyday living. The resulting fallout from David and Bathsheba's sin superbly illustrate this point. In their case, however, it is as if God issued a future double blessing because generations later the descendents of their two sons, Nathan and Solomon are related respectively to Joseph and Mary.

7. The Gospel message is clearly encapsulated in the Messiah's dual transformational roles of Lamb and Shepherd and is a continuing theme that runs through the Old and New Testaments.

8. We live in a sinful, wicked world and the Devil (wolf, devouring lion, red dragon) is an operative right now promoting evil and disrupting the Shepherd's flock. The Lamb of God, however, defeats him in past, present, and future events.

9. While we have used the John 10 passage as a springboard back and forward in time to illustrate a particular dual transformational role of the Messiah, but there is also a King, there is a Kingdom, there is a reign, and these points as well are critical in understanding mission as transformation. It is not our purpose here to

highlight that particular important part of mission, but even staying within the Lamb/Shepherd transformational role, however, one can easily transition from Lamb to King and Kingdom. The book of Revelation announces that the Lamb has a Kingdom, operates by the Throne, executes critical judgment functions, and will reign forever and ever.

10. There are various ways to see the Church both universal and local in the John 10 passage and perhaps one way is keep in mind Peter's instructions to local church elders ring through the passage: "Be shepherds of God's flock…being examples to the flock (1 Pet. 5: 2.3).

Chapter 8

Reformation and Transformation

By George Otis, Jr.

In the fraternity of city changers, reformation and transformation are often mistaken for identical twins. And it is not difficult to see why. Along with their appealing "out with the old, in with the new" demeanor, both concepts sport solid biblical credentials. But as we all know, appearances can sometimes be deceiving. Beyond their surface similarities, transformation and reformation are actually quite different.

Canadian missionary Roger Armbruster understands this difference quite well. As he has rightly observed, reformation is an Old Covenant concept (see Exodus 18:19-24; Leviticus 18:3-5; Deuteronomy 6:17-21; Joshua 24:25) that seeks to improve the present regime by correcting errors and removing defects. It recognizes that change is necessary, but can only offer temporary fixes. It's method is to take an original design—this can be anything from a traditional practice to a popular concept or movement—and modify it incrementally into scores of variants (hence today's denominational hash.)[41]

Because reformation works at a surface level, resulting "changes" are often a repackaged version of old, familiar patterns. The Protestant Reformation, a 16th-century movement aimed at reforming certain doctrines and practices of the Roman Catholic Church, offers a good example of this. Frustrated with the Church's insistence that only company priests could rightly interpret and expound God's Word, the Reformers set out to liberate the believing masses. What they actually did, however, was exchange one form of dogmatic exclusion for another. While people could now read the Scriptures for themselves, interpretation of these words remained the province of an ecclesiastical elite. What had been the duty of the Roman Catholic religious hierarchy—itself descended from the Jewish Sanhedrin—was now in the hands of stern councils (including the infamous Geneva Consistory) led by the likes of John Calvin. But even this arrangement proved unsatisfactory, and as John Milton observed wryly, it was not long before men took on the task of reforming Reformation itself.[42] Soon the right to define orthodoxy was claimed by a new elite comprised of denominational leaders, seminary professors, and more recently, doctrinaire radio personalities.

This is how reformation works. One adaptation follows another, always with the promise of lasting change. Leaders tinker with concepts and structures as if they were aeronautical engineers trying to extend the service life of an old airframe. Even if they do manage to keep their programs and movements viable for a few more seasons, there is little likelihood

of a fundamental or lasting breakthrough. They are simply re-forming what is already there, and what is already there can only take people where they have already been.

Transformation, on the other hand, is a concept rooted in the New Covenant (see John 4:14; Romans 12:2; II Corinthians 3:18, 5:17; I John 3:9). The term itself derives from the Greek word "metamorphoo" which means to change from one degree of glory to another, with ever increasing glory. It is the spiritual equivalent of a caterpillar being metamorphosed into a butterfly. Unlike reformation, it does not merely tinker with society, it changes it from the inside out. It operates at the heart level.

Working to elect Christian legislators and lobbying for government reform are noble pursuits, but they will not yield a transformed society. They never have. Even in Calvin's Geneva, a 16th city-state where Protestant reformers had achieved extraordinary ecclesiastical and political power, social harmony was largely elusive. In an attempt to impose morality and faithfulness on the general public, church elders were appointed to serve as policemen of the Reformation. At the behest of by intolerant, austere, and power hungry leaders, they launched a moral "reign of terror" that swept up hundreds of alleged idolaters, adulterers, and heretics. As a consequence, societal behavior flowed out of external intimidation (the fear of man) rather than internal revelation (the love of God).

Several Christian leaders, the late Oswald Chambers among them, have worried publicly that this Reformation mindset is with us yet today. "If we are going to be ready for Jesus whenever He comes," warns Chambers, "we must stop.. .using religion as a kind of higher culture. [must] become spiritually real.. .', Society cannot be improved merely by applying political or ecclesiasti cal force. Long-lived change, if this is indeed what we seek, requires fresh spiritual technology. Social patches or refinements must be exchanged for a fundamentally new design. Good works must be replaced by living water.[43]

"The Church has been through the Reformation," Armbruster says. "Now it is time for transformation." Only transformation will yield the kind of maturity and oneness that will lead the world to believe we have something that they need, something that cannot be duplicated by man-made efforts in the kingdoms of this world.[44] As Brian Edwards wrote in *Revival, A People Saturated with God*

"…if reformation is the re-forming of an apostate Church to the doctrine of the New Testament, then revival [transformation is the reviving of a sleeping Church to the life of the New Testament (emphasis mine).[45]

Chapter 9

Transformation to, within and through the Marketplace

By C. Neal Johnson, PhD, JD

External transformation—improving one's standard of living—is the essence of the Marketplace (MP). Internal transformation—improving one's quality of life—is, to the secular MP participant, the hoped-for by-product of an improved standard of living.

The MP is the context in which people everywhere try to improve their circumstances, raise their living standards, educate their children, and find a better life. Individuals immersed in poverty turn to the MP to transform their personal and family situations, to bootstrap themselves out of poverty, to earn their daily bread, to have sufficient food, better housing, and nicer clothing. In short, through the MP they seek to have and enjoy the best of modern civilization and to participate in the "good life" they see around the world.

In a larger context, nations and regional groupings of nations continually form alliances to improve their MP-based economies in order to achieve greater prosperity and security for their people. Lesser political subdivisions such as cities and states uniformly seek to transform the economies in their areas, attract new industry, create new and better jobs, generate wealth, and ignite the modern engines of prosperity.

In today's globalizing world, transformation of the external, physical aspects of life through the MP is on virtually every personal and political agenda worldwide regardless of political structure or ideology. That is because the MP is perhaps the only human institution that touches, directly or indirectly, virtually every person on planet Earth. In one form or another, it is a pervasive part of every society, culture, and people group, and is found in the midst of every religion and every political system in every historic era. Everyone either earns a living or is supported by someone who does, whether it be through filial duty, charity, or taxes; and, since the dawn of humanity, when people came together to form social units, they have interacted to their mutual good within the context of the Marketplace. Their goal is simple: survival, sustenance, and success for their personal, familial, and societal transformation, both quantitatively and qualitatively, both externally and internally.

The Marketplace: A Definition

What is the MP? It is variously defined, but in its most basic sense, it is the forum through which human economic commerce is conducted.[46]

It is called various things in various regions of the world and in various historic eras, but today it is predominantly known as the private commercial business community. And yet, it is so much more than that. It also includes the workplace—the place where people earn their livings—whether that be in business, government, education, non-profit organizations, or churches.

It also includes those policy-making forums that impact the economy, the commercial business community, and the people in the workplace. Those policy-making forums can be governmental such as legislatures, central banks, and administrative, bureaucratic rule-making bodies, or they can be quasi-governmental, transnational, even global or regional institutions such as the World Trade Organization, World Bank, International Monetary Fund or European Bank for Reconstruction and Development.

In summary, the MP exists at both the micro (individual and company) and macro (nation state and global) levels. In this day of vast economic disparity, the MP is ubiquitous and, in the popular mind, synonymous with prosperity, transformation of external circumstances, and transformation to an improved quality of life.

The Gospel and the Marketplace

It follows that if the Gospel of Jesus Christ is needed by humanity, if it applies in any and all situations, if it is relevant to every aspect of human existence and activity, then it is needed by, applies in, and is relevant to the MP. It follows further that the MP, as a major center of human power, activity, and attention, cannot be ignored or neglected by God's people if the Church is to be obedient to its calling. Quite the contrary, the MP should receive major attention from the Church in both its institutional, ecclesiastical forms and in its broader para-church manifestations if it is to truly engage people contextually where they live. Historically, however, this has not happened.

Tension Between the Marketplace and the Church

Traditionally, the MP and its various venues—business, government, and education—have been off-limits to the Church. This is especially true in regard to the commercial business community. In fact, a great historic, cultural divide remains between the pulpit and the business community. This divide, in many instances, manifests itself not only in mutual antipathy, but often in outright hostility and suspicion. Recent Harvard-based research[47] found that there is a "new collision of [the] spiritual and business," that "many people's faith suffers a bifurcation when set in a business context" and that the church is "anticapitalist," and "antibusiness" (2001:xxvii, xxx, xxxi).[48]

Fortunately, these walls between the MP and the Church are beginning to crumble. The scriptures are being re-examined through MP eyes and we are beginning to see a sharp return to the doctrine of the Priesthood of All Believers, a critical reassessment of the role of the clergy as shepherds of their flocks, and the rise of a new laity-driven, pastor-supported mission paradigm. In the Marketplace, it is becoming universally recognized that one can be both a good, successful businessperson and a faithful, obedient follower of Jesus Christ.

The Marketplace Mission Movement

This resurgent movement of the laity is bringing about a new appreciation among God's people for the role of the MP in the holistic, Christ-centered transformation of all humanity—physical, emotional and spiritual. The dynamic of this movement are fast and fluid, but it is quickly turning into a massive MP movement among God's people within the business community. Not coincidentally, the movement is erupting spontaneously and independently all around the world and many keen observers are saying that the marketplace may well be the primary mission field of the 21st century.

Jesus said for us to study the signs of the times to know how God is moving among us. This seems to be one of those times. Often referred to as the "Marketplace Mission Movement" or simply as "The Movement," many MP Movement insiders consider it to be the leading edge of a God-driven tidal wave that may sweep the

planet and see the final realization of the Great Commission mandated by Jesus. It may well become one of the truly great Christian movements of history and it is emerging here and now, through us and in our time.

The Church and Marketplace Transformation

It is axiomatic to every believer that the MP and its participants need Jesus Christ and His life-saving Gospel. It is equally foundational that the Church, as the chosen manifestation of Christ's body and presence on Earth, needs 1) to recognize the signs of the times and the apparent importance of today's MP in God's *missio Dei*, and 2) to focus on the MP as a primary mission field in its own right, deserving of the Church's full attention and resources. And yet, thus far, this new mission movement is "below the radar screen" of the Church and even the foremost schools that are dedicated to studying Christian mission and missiology.

Given the Gospel of Christ Jesus, with its holy and wholly transformational message, and the MP with its secular transformational mission, it is not hard to see why God has perhaps chosen the MP as the forum through which He will seek the final realization of the Great Commission and the transforming redemption of humanity. The power of the Gospel, combined with the power of the MP, in the hands of the all-powerful I AM could effect the holistic transformation of this planet and its inhabitants in ways never possible before the advent of modern globalization and the global village.

The question then becomes, "How should the Church, with its transforming Gospel, engage the MP with its own transformational mission?"

I suggest that the quest of this "How"—framed broadly for present purposes—involves three very different approaches: Mission *to* the MP, Mission *within* the MP, and Mission *through* the MP.

Mission *to* the Marketplace

Mission *to* the MP refers to God's people who are outside of the MP seeing the MP as a legitimate mission field to be penetrated with and for the Gospel. It is MP outsiders (etic) going into the MP to evangelize and disciple MP insiders (emic). It may take many forms such as Bible studies, prayer walks, relationship evangelism, and even personal, loving confrontation. In its essence, however, it is crossing the barriers from the ecclesiastical world into the corporate world to plant the life-transforming seeds of the Gospel and to demonstrate the love of Jesus and the grace and forgiveness of God.

Mission *within* the Marketplace

Mission *within* the MP is quite different. It refers to Christians within the MP, that is, Christians who are already MP participants, championing the Gospel in the MP. In so doing, mission within the MP takes two fundamentally different, albeit complimentary, forms. First, ministry by Christian MP insiders to other Christian MP insiders; and second, ministry by Christian MP insiders to non-Christian MP insiders.

The first form exhibits itself in many ways: fellowshipping, motivating, encouraging, mentoring, and discipling each other, not only for personal transformation, but to understand the special call of God on those within the MP. It also involves learning how to be salt and light where God has planted them, how to deal with real business problems in Christ-honoring, Bible-based, Spirit-filled ways, and, for executives, how to lead their companies for Christ.

The second form of ministry within the MP is primarily focused on evangelism—leading the lost to Jesus. This is being done in a wide variety of ways and must be contextualized to the industry, gender, age, and circumstances of the seekers, as well as to the political and legal realities of the particular business environment.

In both cases, transformation of the individual is paramount. But, from this, flows a stream of living water that also transforms each workplace and each company and its culture. This allows the company to be used of the Holy Spirit to transform the lives of the company's employees and their families, its suppliers and vendors, clients and customers, creditors and investors, and even its competitors, trade unions, trade associations, and industry.

In this way, starting at the grass roots and empowered by the Holy Spirit, the Gospel becomes God's yeast in the MP, impacting and transforming cities, nations and, through international commerce and globalization, the entire world. The transforming power of the Gospel, carried by the MP and its modern global linkages, can now touch and potentially transform all of humanity in our time.

Today's MP is like an invisible spider web that encompasses the entire planet. It is no wonder that the internet is known as "the web," for its radiates outward in ever-growing, ever interconnected, tighter circles. Think what it could mean if Jesus Christ were at the center of the MP web, rather than Satan's black widow. So too, imagine what it could mean to humanity's holistic transformation and quality of life, if the MP were Christ's territory, part of the universal Church, dedicated to His glory and His purposes.

Mission *through* the Marketplace

The third MP mission avenue is mission *through* the MP. This is perhaps the most exciting arena. Currently operating under the rubric of "Business as Mission" (BAM) and Pauline tentmaking, mission *through* the MP basically seeks to leverage the resources, power, and networks of the MP for Kingdom purposes. It is Christians within the MP reaching beyond their own MP to address the holistic needs of hurting people who are in other, alien MPs or who are totally outside of all MPs. Through the power and guidance of the Holy Spirit, BAM seeks to harness the secular power of the MP to touch people's lives with the love of Christ and to help alleviate their pain.

This type of mission may take many different forms. It may involve businesses that reach into their local communities with holistic people projects—individual or group—such as social services,

educational support, employment training, health care, youth service, or family assistance. It may mean providing airplanes, money, and doctors to fly into neighboring nations—or motoring into the inner city—to conduct medical and dental clinics. It may be an auto repair business in Pasadena that supports a missionary in Armenia, or a Christian farm implement dealer in Tennessee who donates equipment and expertise to Kazakhstan farmers. It may be a Korean merchant who underwrites a Bolivian micro-loan program, or a German manufacturer who hires the mentally challenged to give them a chance in life, or a Swiss consortium that sets up a job factory to train unemployed youth. The possibilities are endless.

The point is that the business community, because of its enormous power base of influence, resources, and expertise is in a unique position to undertake mission for Christ: both worldwide and next door. This mission can be done effectively and efficiently by Christian believers in the business community. The heart of mission is helping hurting people holistically through the love of Christ. And what matters is not who *does* it, but who *receives* it; not *who* does it, but *how* and *why* it is done. In these instances, it is the business community itself that is replacing the traditional "sending agencies" of earlier Christian mission paradigms. It is the business community utilizing the resources God has placed in their hands to become a major part of *missio Dei*.

The Three Camps of Marketplace Mission

From a mission organizational perspective, God's mission to, within, and through the MP (which I call Marketplace Missiology[49]), has thus far divided into three distinct camps: Pauline tentmaking; Marketplace Ministries; and Business as Mission. The distinctions between and among these camps is far from clear even to the participants, and there is often a blurring of lines among them. Nonetheless, each camp is currently operating independently of the other two camps and all three are operating with only the loosest ties to the ecclesiastical Church. Each camp has its own associations, its own conferences, its own literature, and its own leadership. There is little, if any, communication among the camps and there is little awareness of what is transpiring within the rival camps.

A good example of this distinction is the 2004 Forum for World Evangelism, hosted by the Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization (LCWE) in Thailand. The Forum boasts a Marketplace Ministry Track, a BAM Track and a Tentmaking Stream. In addition, to seriously confuse the matter, there is a separate track on Globalization, which is a central issue within both the Tentmaking and the BAM tracks. As noted above, however, the Marketplace Mission Movement is a fast-moving, ever-changing, shape-shifting phenomenon that is in an exciting, embryonic stage. At this stage, confusion and competition are inevitable and, in all probability, exceptionally healthy to the long-range viability and sustainability of the Movement.

Summary

Transformation and the MP go hand-in-hand. Every human being is impacted directly or indirectly by the MP. It is a universal institution capable of being used by the Church to realize the Great Commission, especially given today's globalizing world. The parallels are pregnant with possibilities for mission, both next door and abroad: The Gospel seeks inner healing and spiritual transformation; the MP seeks outward healing through economic improvement and inner healing through improved quality of life; and Holistic Mission seeks inner and outward transformation, both spiritual and physical.

Given the omnipresence of the Lord and the ubiquitous nature of the MP, it only makes sense that God might see the MP as a useful instrument for His *missio Dei*. And, from all outward appearances, He seems to be doing just that—using the MP in a bold, fresh way to spread His word and to seek redemption and reconciliation with humanity through an aggressive Marketplace Mission Movement. While this Movement appears to be in its early stages, it holds the distinct potential of forming a great, global tidal wave for the Kingdom.

In the midst of God's mission to, within, and through the MP, God appears to be effecting transformation on several levels simultaneously. First, transformation at the personal level, of those who are within the MP, both through evangelism and discipleship; second, transformation at the company and workplace level, seeking to modify the business culture and environment, making it a healthy, Christ-honoring, joyful place to work; third, transformation through the company's sphere of influence at the local and regional levels, seeking to do business in such righteous, scripturally sound ways as to positively engage and impact the company's community and industry; fourth, transformation at the national and multi-national level through the interaction of the MP participants and government officials, seeking to have a Christian impact on public policy; and last, at the global level, seeking to harness Christian business resources to holistically touch and alleviate the pain of those lost, hurting souls worldwide, especially those who are living in poverty.

It behooves the Church, in its quest to be used of God to transform the world, to take special note of the MP and God's bold movement to, within, and through it. Clearly, the MP is a stream of global transformation that is high on God's agenda.

Chapter 10

The Transformed Person[50]

By Michael Cassidy, founder and International Team Leader of African Enterprise and co-patron of Transformation Africa.

Not ourselves, or our family, or our church, or our nation can be changed in an instant. It is a process. But in this Transformation movement we are making a start. We are each starting with ourselves, our family and social circle. We are taking some first new steps of pilgrimage and journey, remembering that every great journey begins with its first steps. Yes, this is what we are on about. And it is no small venture. Indeed, it is monumentally challenging. And exciting! Bigtime!

More than that, transformation is what God is calling us to as His children at this time and in this place. This must not frighten us. But it must challenge and launch us on the process of moving to a new place as we understand that:

- He is not calling us just to some large prayer rallies. Though prayer is where it all has to start, He is calling us to become changed people.
- He is not calling us just to sing and dance and clap. He is calling us to think and behave differently.
- He is not calling us just to get the family together for a public praise session. He is calling us to live out different family lifestyles back home, between Ma and Pa and between the kids and their parents.
- Nor is He calling young people just to celebrate the joys of Christian togetherness with a lot of other people in a stadium wing-ding. He is calling kids to stop cheating at school, quit sleeping around, cut out foul language, get into their Bibles, and start seeking His will for their future.
- He is not calling businesspeople just to send a cheque to help with stadium or publicity costs. He is calling for every business in every country to be different -- marked not by corner-cutting, shady deals and dog-eat-dog, but by decent, humane treatment of people, integrity, the rate for the job, proper societal responsibility, plus honesty with all, including the taxman and his laws.
- He is not calling politicians just to send polite, politically correct endorsements of spiritual happenings or moral regeneration movements. He is calling politicians to clean up their act, shed corruption, forsake ladder-climbing, embrace self-sacrifice and start becoming a frugal-living leadership led by God.
- God is not calling the media just to cover Transformation events on TV or radio or

in the press. He is calling our media to stop inflicting the garbage of violence, explicit sex, four-letter words and pornographic material on a gullible public, but rather produce and disseminate that which is wholesome and conducive to family values and a sound society.

- And God is not calling our local churches and Christian leaders to look good, but actually to be good and do good. He wants our churches transformed from inward-looking, maintenance-mode Christian clubs to living, loving, laughing, Spirit-led fellowships of outward-moving, caring, sharing people who move together in unity (see Eph 4:11—16) and who are salt arresting national decay, and light dispelling societal darkness.
- On the HIV/Aids issue – certainly the biggest Goliath in Africa and in most continents -- I don't think God is just calling for care for victims (vital as that is), plus so-called "safe-sex" education (a misnomer if ever there was one) plus anti-retroviral drugs for those suffering from HIV (please let's do give them), but God is calling for biblical change in sexual behaviour. That means: girls, don't flaunt yourselves; men, zip up. And everyone, get in line with God's ways on sex. That means sexual abstinence before marriage and sexual faithfulness within marriage.

You see, friends, God is not calling us to find a polite corner for Him amidst our other little idols and foreign gods of money, materialism, pleasure, power, sex, entertainment, status and so on. He is calling us to put Him first, forsake all idolatry, humble ourselves, pray, turn from our sinful ways and seek His face. Only then can He forgive our sin and heal our land (2 Chron 7:14).

We must pray: "Lord, help me take my first steps along this path. Let me do my bit in beginning to change myself, my family, my church, my nation and my continent."

"I appeal to you therefore, brothers and sisters, by the mercies of God, to present your bodies as a living sacrifice, holy and acceptable to God, which is your spiritual worship. Do not be conformed to this world but be transformed by the renewal of your mind, that you may prove what is the will of God, what is good and acceptable and perfect" (Rom 12:1-2).

You see, if we don't get it that God is really on about spiritual, moral and social transformation on all fronts and at all levels, we will perpetuate across the globe the current Christian tragedy of my continent, namely Africa, where we have

some 380 million professed Christians -- nearly 50 percent of the continent's population -- yet a continent in many ways going down the tube morally, socially, politically and economically. I believe Christians are to blame because we have preached only a salvation message—that is, how to be saved, born again, shout hallelujah and so on -- and not a Kingdom message where we learn how to bring all of life -- personal, marital, sexual, economic, political, etc -- under the kingship of Christ, so that wherever Christians are in any sector of society they are making a godly difference regarding how things actually function.

Now when the apostle Paul says very simply: "Be transformed" (Rom 12:2), he is basically asking us to think and live as Jesus thought and lived when He was on earth. We are to pray: "Lord, please help me to live today as you would live it if you were I." Quite a tall order! But that's what the Transformation movement and the Bible's idea of transformation is calling for. It is calling for us to decide and resolve to live in the Kingdom and make it come in my or our small corner on earth by resolving very deliberately to obey the example and teachings of Jesus Christ.

Hopefully, with the help of the Holy Spirit, we'll say: "Yes, yes, Lord, a thousand times yes. I want to follow You that way." Why? Because we know that the best, most sensible bargain on earth -- better, more productive and more eternally far-reaching than any other -- is to sell-out 110 percent to Jesus Christ.
Paul answers this in Romans 12:1-2 with a fourfold appeal:

1. *Present your bodies a living sacrifice.* This means offering him every part of our bodies from our feet, hands and sexual organs to our eyes, ears, tongue, intellect and gifts. Let Him have full control of each. Get somewhere quiet and pray systematically over each part of your body and think of the implications of giving each to Him fully and comprehensively.
2. *Do not be conformed to this world.* This means turning our back on the "world" (see John 15:18) in the sense of our global culture, which has organised itself, its thought life, its behaviour, its social systems, its entertainment and its media content around self and self-gratification and not around God. The "world" of which we now speak will make bad seem good and wrong seem right. So the disciple in the Transformation movement prays: "Lord, please help me not to be seduced by the world's ways, thinking, standards and behaviour."
3. *But be transformed by the renewal of your mind.* The first step here is that of filling our minds with Scripture -- even memorising it -- and also getting into good Christian reading. If this becomes the way we think, and the focus of our thought life, then our idea system will start to line up with that of Jesus. We won't think the world's way. We'll think His way. In this regard, I want to encourage you to become

systematic in the way you read the Bible -- get a system going and try to hang in with it.

4. *Then you will be able to test and approve what God's will is.* And this will, we note, is "good, pleasing and perfect." How wonderful! You have this mysterious opportunity of your life, this one chance to journey across Planet Earth, and you must find God's highest and best purpose for you. There will be no chance for another run at it. This is our time to live and journey here on Earth, and we must find God's highest and best will for us -- His Plan A.

This you and I can do, as we believe God wants to guide us (see Psalm 143:10, Proverbs 3:6), as we pray for His guidance and will and then make intelligent, godly, Bible-based decisions. The counsel of family or Christian friends will help, plus the way God opens and closes doors and gives each serious disciple His peace.

Conclusion

Something to note in conclusion is that fellowship and interaction with others who are seeking renewed minds and God's perfect will is equally vital. So be active in a good church, which truly preaches the Gospel, and participate in a fellowship group, Alpha course, or pray with Christian friends. All this is part of journeying with fellow pilgrims toward a renewed Christian mind and spiritual transformation into the likeness of Christ.

Related to this is the key dimension of the work of the Holy Spirit, as stressed by Paul in Romans 8:1-27 (please look it up). The Apostle also tells believers to be "filled with the Spirit" (Eph 5:18). This happens as we constantly give and re-give ourselves to Christ and surrender more and more of our bodies and beings to Him. In reality we are as full of the Holy Spirit as our surrender allows us to be.

As you walk this way with a transformed and renewed mind, in the power of the Spirit, in the will of God, and yielded fully to Him as a living sacrifice, I promise you God will use you as an instrument of His peace and as an agent of transformation, wherever you are and in whatever you do.

Chapter 11

Bethel To Peniel
A Biblical Paradigm Of Transformation

Edward K. Pousson[51]

Jacob doesn't fully understand the blessing that he seeks. Yet he pursues it with a passion that borders on obsession. God's interventions into Jacob's journey provide us with a dramatic biblical paradigm of transformation. *Personal* transformation: Jacob becomes Israel. *Community* transformation: pagan Luz becomes Bethel (God's house). *National* transformation: Israel becomes a great nation. And *world* transformation: all peoples will be blessed through God's transformed people.

Jacob@Bethel – Community Transformation

He came to a *certain place* (Gen. 28:11). No five star hotel. No internet cafe. No mobile phone. Just one lousy stone for a pillow. But the sun had set, and fugitives can't be choosy. Jacob's most recent quarrel with Esau had turned nasty. He barely escaped with his life. Now he's between a rock and a hard place. When you come to your certain place, your old bag of tricks is useless. It's just you and the rock. Good night! But well before daylight Jacob is wide awake declaring, *this is an awesome place, the house of God, and the gate of heaven* (v. 17). What happened? How did the *certain place* (v. 11) become the *awesome place* (v. 17)? How did Luz become Bethel (= *God's house*, v. 19)? How does a pagan town transform into a gateway to God? *In one night!* The question is important for us all. The world is full of certain places that need to become awesome places. What will it take to transform your mission context into a gateway to heaven?

Presence

First, there is *a revelation of God's presence* (Gen. 28:12-17). God's omnipresence was always at Luz. But nothing ever changed. Timeworn traditions and programmed piety will never transform our communities, cities, and nations into gateways to heaven. We need the *manifest presence* of God, and nothing less. A Sunday school teacher was explaining the *omnipresence* of God to his class. One anxious child asked, "Teacher, is God in my pocket?" "Yes, Son, God is in your pocket," answered the teacher. The boy grabbed his pocket, pleading, "Dear Lord, please don't eat my candy bar."

No need to worry. The omnipresence of God will not eat your candy bar. Nor will he tamper

with your bank account much. The omnipresence of God leaves us alone in our *certain place* with our stone pillow, broken relationships, compromised values, and secret vices. The pagan town remains pagan. The unreached peoples remain unreached. Darkness still prevails over the land.

But the *manifest* presence of God changes everything. When God arrives, nobody's candy bar is safe. But the change! Imagine your community a gateway to God, where every person gets a clear opportunity to hear and obey the Gospel of Jesus. Our well-tuned strategies, plans, and programs have their place. But above all these, we need a manifestation of God's powerful presence, an outpouring of his Holy Spirit upon all flesh. Many are hungering, thirsting, praying, and working for just this. Why don't you join them?

Purpose

Second, *a revelation of God's purpose* turns the certain place into the awesome place (Gen. 28:13-15). God's kingdom purpose is bigger than Jacob, bigger than Bethel, larger than Israel, and larger than your church or ministry organization. It includes the blessing and transformation of "all the peoples of the earth" through Jacob and his offspring (v. 14). We are included in that offspring through Christ (Gal. 3:29). We don't replace Israel, but we are grafted into Israel (Rom. 11:17). As such, we inherit Israel's covenant promise and responsibility to be a blessing to all peoples.

It seems that some have turned the 'presence of God' into a trend. Presence for presence's sake. But are we equally interested in God's purpose? In this story and throughout the Bible, when God reveals his presence he also reveals his purpose. He doesn't drop in to gossip over tea and cake – fellowship for fellowship's sake. When he shows up, he brings a kingdom-wide agenda that will cost us everything. There's little point seeking God's presence if we are not prepared to embrace his kingdom purpose.

Others have so reduced ministry to a focus on personal needs that people fail to grasp God's bigger plan for the world and their part in it. But look at Jacob. A fugitive, ravaged by relational conflict, stripped of all comforts and securities of home and family. A sensitive ear and a shoulder to cry on wouldn't be asking too much, would it? But all he gets is one hard rock. Not a word about his personal crisis. Instead God gives him a dream. A dream that's bigger than life. That's it, of course. That's how God ministers to Jacob in his hour of need. The dark night of the soul lights up with hope. The pain of the past is overcome. And Jacob says, *I'll take that dream.*

A revelation of purpose is what we need, personally, corporately, nationally and globally. If we can't see the big picture of what God is doing in our world, we are clueless about our

part in his work. We are lost without a purpose to live and die for.

Purpose is not up for grabs. Of course, we all have different gifts and unique callings. But everything must serve that one overriding, unchangeable covenant with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob to bless all the peoples of the earth with the life-giving, world-changing Gospel (Gen. 28:14; Gal. 3:8; Heb. 6:13-18). A revelation of God's purpose turns our certain place into an awesome place.

Passion

A third factor helps turn Luz into Bethel. There is *passionate response* for the presence and purpose of God (Gen. 28:18-22). Luz was Luz and it always was until Jacob arrived. But when this son of the covenant arrived, God arrived and changed everything. God takes the initiative by revealing his presence and purpose. Then it's our move. We must respond. Without human partnership the transformation will not occur (1 Cor. 1:21). Consider Jacob's proactive response: *awakening, announcing,* and *anointing* (Gen. 28:16-19).

First, he *awakes*. Today some are fast asleep in their certain place with no sense of God's presence or purpose. No wonder people sleep in church! *Pleasant dreams.* But when God arrives and speaks it's time to wake up and respond.

Second, Jacob *announces* the transformation with a prophetic declaration: *This is God's house! This is the gate of heaven!* (v. 17). He's not a passive spectator, but a proactive participant in the transformative process.

And third, he takes that cold stone pillow and *anoints* it as a pillar in God's house. His faith-filled response turned a stumbling stone into a building block. What will you do with the stone God gives you in your certain place? You can kick it, curse it, can it, or *transform it!*

Remember our question. What will it take to turn our Luz into Bethel, a gateway to God for so many persons and peoples? Do you feel passionately, like Jacob, about your mission and destiny in God's great purpose to transform our world? Or can you just take it or leave it? Scripture makes a frightful contrast between Jacob and Esau. Esau despised his inheritance (Gen. 25:34; Heb. 12:16). But from the womb to the tomb, Jacob was always passionate for the covenant blessing (Gen. 25:22). He was never a nominal patriarch. Look at his response here in Gen. 28:18-22. He is not neutral or mediocre about what God promised. He spends the rest of his life in pursuit of God's dream.

God is ready to manifest his presence and glory among the broken peoples of this world.

But he's waiting for men and women, sons and daughters of the covenant, to arise with a passion that would make Jacob jealous. Popular language has compromised the word "passion." Mel Gibson has helped redeem it with the movie, *The Passion of the Christ.* Jesus gave his all, suffered and died *passionately*, for the joy that was awaiting him – thy kingdom come, thy world transformed (2 Cor. 5:19).

An aspiring preacher once asked the riveting speaker, D.L. Moody, what was the secret of his success. Moody said, "Young man I suggest you go out and set yourself on fire, and people will come just to watch you burn." Until we awaken with renewed zeal and fire and lay claim to the promise of God concerning lost, the certain place remains the certain place. The unreached peoples remain unreached. The poor and needy remain poor and needy. Pray that, like Jacob, we will be responsive and obedient to God's call upon our lives and our churches. Ask God to make us people of passion for his presence, purpose, and promise of personal, community, national, and global transformation.

Jacob@Peniel – Personal Transformation

Jacob's encounter at Bethel was just a beginning. Luz's metamorphosis had already occurred in God's order of things, but not in history. When Jacob moved on, it was still Luz as far as the Canaanites were concerned. They didn't change the sign board. And Jacob was still a fugitive with a broken family. Now he goes into exile from the Promised Land – never a good thing for the patriarchs. But some 20 or 30 years on, two wives and 11 sons later, God called Jacob back to Bethel, the place of Presence, purpose, and promise (Gen. 31:3, 13).

But there is a problem. Between Jacob and the Promised Land stands a brother deeply offended. On hearing that Jacob was homeward-bound, Esau marched out to intercept him with 400 men. Not a welcoming party (Gen. 32:6-11). Cornered between a rock and a hard place again, Jacob is unaware that the *pressure* is a set-up for another encounter with the *presence* of God – round two in the transformation process. This time, however, the object of transformation is not the *place* but the *person*. The promise of community, national, and global transformation at Bethel is contingent upon the transformation of the patriarch at Peniel. Personal transformation is the gateway to community transformation. This is the biblical paradigm.

And so we come to Peniel, the place of personal transformation (Gen. 32:21-34). If you think Bethel was strange, wait till you see this. As at Bethel, Jacob is *alone again, naturally.* Deprived of the security of family and possessions, he faces another dark night. And guess who shows up? A *Stranger in the night* (and it's not Frank Sinatra). He's wearing boxing

gloves! This is going to be a frightful, painful night. At Bethel, we meet the God who *comforts* us. At Peniel, we meet the God who *confronts* us. Why? Because the greatest obstacle on the way home, and the greatest threat to the covenant of transformation, is not Esau but Jacob. The natural man Jacob must give way to the spiritual man Israel. That's why God confronts us. It happens at Peniel, in the *face of God*. (Peniel means *face of God*.)

It was a close match. Just before dawn Jacob brought the Stranger to a draw and imposed on him a demand: "I won't let you go unless you bless me." From the womb to the tomb, Jacob orients his entire around this covenant *blessing.* He doesn't fully understand it. But he clings to it (and now to the Giver) with all his might. "I won't let you go unless you bless me." And God blessed him in the strangest of ways: a dislocated hip (*a new walk*, Gen. 32:25, 31); a changed name (*a new identity*, v. 28); and a beautiful sunrise (*a new day*, v. 31). The blessing is transformation.

A New Walk

"He struck him on the hip socket; and Jacob's hip was put out of joint as he wrestled with him" (Gen. 32:25). For the rest of his life the patriarch limps along with a staff. The point is subtle but striking. God wounds Jacob – *to heal him.* It's the wound of God that heals the heart. When he finally returns to Bethel to realize the promise of transformation, he doesn't strut in like Sylvester Stallone. He lumbers in with a limp. Like Moses after 40 years in the desert. Like Naomi after exile and bereavement. Like Joseph after the pit and the prison. Like Jesus on the cross. Like Saul blind in Damascus. Like so many others in the Bible and history. Blessed are the broken for they shall inherit the blessing. Nobody struts into the kingdom. We limp. Is it time to change our walk?

A New Name

Like many today, Jacob goes about 'the ministry' in a way that offends others. He manhandles the blessing like a 'heel' –as his name suggests. He fought with Esau in the womb (Gen. 25:22). He bartered for the birthright with a bowl of beans. He deceived his aged father for the blessing. He offended his father-in-law Laban. And now it all comes back to haunt him. But God confronts him to change him: "You shall no longer be called Jacob, but Israel" (Gen. 32:28). The point is again subtle but striking. *Jacob* cannot return to the awesome place. Only *Israel* can. *Jacob* cannot reconcile with Esau, only *Israel* can. *Jacob* cannot become a great nation and a blessing to all peoples. Only *Israel* can. *Jacob the heel* must become *God's Israel* in order to *heal* God's broken world. And so must we. Flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God. Is it time to change your name

(identity)?

A New Day

"The sun rose upon him as he passed Peniel, limping because of his hip" (Gen. 32:31). When Jacob arrived at Bethel, "the sun had set" (Gen. 28:11). But after Peniel, "the sun rose upon him." It was long dark night of exile and alienation from the awesome place of presence, purpose, promise, and power. But after Peniel the night is ended. Arise and shine for your light has come! It's a new day, a new beginning, a new season. It's time to change your calendar.

After Peniel, a most amazing thing happens. The first person Jacob sees is Esau. Perfect timing. Before Peniel, Esau was Jacob's worst enemy. After Peniel, Jacob looks into his face and says, "To see your face is like seeing the face of God" (Gen. 33:10). This is the miracle of transformation. When we can look into our enemy's eyes and see God's face, we know we have been to Peniel. It's not Esau who has changed, but Jacob. With "Jacob" pinned to the ground and "Israel" learning to walk – not <u>on</u> people but <u>with</u> people – the patriarch can now return to the Land to catalyze the promised transformation. He comes back to Bethel and finds God waiting:

> God said to him, "I am God Almighty: be fruitful and multiply; a nation and a company of nations shall come from you, and kings shall spring from you. The land that I gave to Abraham and Isaac I will give to you, and I will give the land to your offspring after you." Then God went up from him at the place where he had spoken with him. Jacob set up a pillar in the place where he had spoken with him, a pillar of stone; and he poured out a drink offering on it, and poured oil on it. So Jacob called the place where God had spoken with him Bethel (Gen. 35:11-15).

Personal transformation, community transformation, national transformation, global transformation. This is the big story of the Bible. From fallen Adam to the Second Adam to the new heaven and the new earth. It's God's story. It's our story. Like Jacob, we all have a part in it. Where is your Luz-to-become-Bethel? What stone will you anoint as a pillar in God's house? Have you been to Peniel to secure that blessing personally and directly from God?

This is the legacy of Bethel (*house of God*) and Peniel (*face of God*): *spiritual blessing can only be obtained by spiritual means.* Neither Esau, nor Isaac, nor Laban, nor Rachael, nor Leah can give Jacob what he needs. All these play a part. But God alone gives the ultimate blessing – transformation. It took Jacob many years and a disjointed hip to learn this.

When will we learn? When will we learn that “the things of men” cannot bring in the kingdom of God? Our degrees and titles, institutions and traditions, flowcharts and committees, timelines and strategies, goals and objectives all play a key part. But until we touch God personally and directly, until he touches us deeply and painfully, we can never realize the transformation that he has willed for our community, nation, and world. “Israel” strives with man and with God and prevails, because God prevails over him and transforms him into a blessing to all peoples.

Chapter 12

A Theology of Transformation[52]

By: Vinay Samuel and Chris Sugden

Introduction

For two weeks during June 1983, we have come together from local churches, Christian mission and aid agencies at Wheaton College in the USA from 30 nations to pray about and reflect upon the Church's task in response to human need. Some of us belong to churches which are situated among marginalized peoples who live in situations of poverty, powerlessness and oppression. Others come from churches situated in affluent areas of the world. We are deeply grateful to our Heavenly Father for allowing us the privilege of sharing our lives with one another, studying the Scriptures in small groups, considering papers on aspects of human development and transformation and looking closely at the implications of case studies and histories which describe different responses to human need. Because God hears the cries of the poor, we have sought each other's help to respond (Ex. 3:7-9; Js. 5:1-6). We rejoice at what we believe the Holy Spirit has been teaching us concerning God's specific purpose and plans for his distressed world and the part the Church has to play in them.

As we have faced the enormous challenge before God's people everywhere to alleviate suffering and, in partnership together, eliminate its causes, we are more than ever aware of the liberating and healing power of the Good News of Jesus. We gladly reaffirm, therefore, our conviction that Jesus Christ alone is the world's peace, for He alone can reconcile people to God and bring all hostilities to an end (Eph. 2:14-17).

We acknowledge, furthermore, that only by spreading the Gospel can the most basic need of human beings be met: to have fellowship with God. In what follows we do not emphasize evangelism as a separate theme, because we see it as an integral part of our total Christian response to human need (Mt. 28:18-21). In addition, it is not necessary simply to repeat what the Lausanne Covenant and the Report on the Consultation on the Relationship between Evangelism and Social Responsibility (CRESR, Grand Rapids, 1982) have already expressed.

What we have discovered we would like to share with our brothers and sisters throughout the world. We offer this statement, not as an attempt to produce a final word, but as a summary of our reflections.

Both Scripture and experience, informed by the Spirit, emphasize that God's people are dependent upon His wisdom in confronting human need. Local churches and mission agencies, then, should act wisely, if they are to be both pastoral and prophetic. Indeed the whole human family with its illusions and divisions needs Christ to be its Wisdom as well as its Saviour and King.

Conscious of our struggle to find a biblical view of transformation that relates its working in the heart of believers to its multiplying effects in society, we pray that the Spirit will give us the discernment we need. We believe that the wisdom the Spirit inspires is practical rather than academic, and the possession of the faithful rather than the preserve of the élite. Because we write as part of a world full of conflict and a Church easily torn by strife we desire that the convictions expressed in this document be further refined by God's pure and peaceable wisdom.

Some may find our words hard. We pray, however, that many will find them a help to their own thinking and an encouragement to 'continue steadfast, immovable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, knowing that in the Lord your labour is not in vain' (1 Cor. 15:58).

I. Christian Social Involvement

1. As Christians reflect on God's intention for the world they are often tempted to be either naively optimistic or darkly pessimistic. Some, inspired by a utopian vision, seem to suggest that God's Kingdom, in all its fulness, can be built on earth. We do not subscribe to this view, since Scripture informs us of the reality and pervasiveness of both personal and societal sin (Is. 1: 10-26; Am. 2:6-8; Mi. 2: 1- 10; Rom. 1: 28-32). Thus we recognize that utopianism is nothing but a false dream.

2. Other Christians become pessimistic, because they are faced with the reality of increasing poverty and misery, of rampant oppression and exploitation by powers of the right and the left, of spiralling violence coupled with the threat of nuclear warfare. They are concerned, too, about the increasing possibility that Planet Earth will not be able to sustain its population for long, because of the wanton squandering of its resources. As a result, they are tempted to turn their eyes away from this world and fix them so exclusively on the return of Christ that their involvement in the here and now is paralyzed. We do not wish to disregard or minimize the extensive contribution made by a succession of Christians who have held this view of eschatology, through more than one hundred years, to medical and educational work in many countries up to the present day. Nevertheless, some of us feel that these men and women have tended to see the task of the Church as merely picking up survivors from a shipwreck in a hostile sea. We do not endorse this view either, since it

denies the biblical injunctions to defend the cause of the weak, maintain the rights of the poor and oppressed (Ps. 82:3) and practice

justice and love (Micah 6:8).

3. We affirm, moreover, that, even though we may believe that our calling is only to proclaim the Gospel and not get involved in political and other actions, our very non-involvement lends tacit support to the existing order. There is no escape: either we challenge the evil structures of society or we support them.

4. There have been many occasions in the history of the Church-and some exist today-where Christians, faced with persecution and oppression, have appeared to be disengaged from society and thus to support the status quo. We suggest, however, that even under conditions of the most severe repression, such Christians may in fact be challenging society and even be transforming it, through their lifestyle, their selfless love, their quiet joy, their inner peace and their patient suffering (1 Pet. 2:21-25).

5. Christ's followers, therefore, are called, in one way or another, not to conform to the values of society but to transform them (Ro 12:1-2; Eph. 5:8-14). This calling flows from our confession that God loves the world and that the earth belongs to Him. It is true that Satan is active in this world, even claiming it to be his (Lk. 4:5-7). He is, however, a usurper, having no property rights here. All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to Christ Jesus (Mt. 28:18; Col. 1: 15-20). Although His Lordship is not yet acknowledged by all (Heb. 2:8) He is the ruler of the kings of the earth (Rev. 1:5), King of kings and Lord of lords (Rev. 19:16). In faith we confess that the old order is passing away; the new order has already begun (2 Co. 5:17; Eph. 2:7-10; Mt. 12:18; Lk. 7:21-23).

II. Not only Development, but Transformation

1. The participants at this conference have entered into the current discussions concerning development. For many Western political and business leaders development describes the process by which nations and peoples become part of the existing international economic order. For many people of the Two Thirds World it is identified with an ideologically motivated process of change, called 'developmentalism'. This process is intrinsically related to a mechanistic pursuit of economic growth that tends to ignore the structural context of poverty and injustice and which increases dependency and inequality.

2. Some of us still believe, however, that 'development', when reinterpreted in the light of the whole message of the Bible, is a concept that should be retained by Christians. Part of the reason for this choice is that the word is so widely used. A change of term, therefore, would cause unnecessary confusion.

3. Others in our Consultation, because of difficulty in relating it to biblical categories of thought and its negative overtones, would like to replace 'development' by another word. An alternative we suggest is 'transformation', as it can be applied in different ways to every situation. Western nations, for example, who have generally assumed that development does not apply to them, are, nevertheless, in need of transformation in many areas. In particular, the unspoken assumption that societies operate best when individuals are most free to pursue their own self-interests needs to be challenged on the basis of the biblical teaching on stewardship (Lk. 12:12-21; 16:13-15; Phil. 2:1-4).

Transformation is the change from a condition of human existence contrary to God's purposes to one in which people are able to enjoy fulness of life in harmony with God.

People living in groups based on community solidarity may help these kinds of societies see the poverty of their existence.

4. Moreover, the term 'transformation', unlike 'development', does not have a suspect past. It points to a number of changes that have to take place in many societies, if poor people are to enjoy their rightful heritage in creation.

5. We are concerned, however, that both the goals and the process of transformation should be seen in the light of the good news about Jesus, the Messiah. We commit ourselves and urge other Christian believers to reject the cultural and social forces of secularism which so often shape our idea of a good society. We believe that notions alien to God's plan for human living are often more powerful in forming our opinions about what is right for a nation than the message of Scripture itself.

6. According to the biblical view of human life, then, transformation is the change from a condition of human existence contrary to God's purposes to one in which people are able to enjoy fulness of life in harmony with God (Jn. 10: lo; Col. 3:8-15; Eph. 4:13). This transformation can only take place through the obedience of individuals and communities to the Gospel of Jesus Christ, whose power changes the lives of men and women by releasing them from the guilt, power and consequences of sin, enabling them to respond with love toward God and towards others (ROM 5:5), and making them 'new creatures in Christ' (2 Co. 5:17).

7. There are a number of themes in the Bible which help us focus on the way we understand transformation. The doctrine of creation speaks of the worth of every man, woman and child, of the responsibility of human beings to look after the resources of nature (Gen. 1:26-30) and to share them equitably with their neighbours. The doctrine of

the fall highlights the innate tendency of human beings to serve their own interests, with the consequences of greed, insecurity, violence and the lust for power. 'God's judgement rightly falls upon those who do such things' (ROM 2:2). The doctrine of redemption proclaims God's forgiveness of sins and the freedom Christ gives for a way of life dedicated to serving others by telling them about the Good News of Salvation, bringing reconciliation between enemies and losing one's life to see justice established for all exploited people.

8. We have come to see that the goal of transformation is best described by the biblical vision of the Kingdom of God. This new way of being human in submission to the Lord of all has many facets. In particular, it means striving to bring peace among individuals, races and nations by overcoming prejudices, fears and preconceived ideas about others. It means sharing basic resources like food, water, the means of healing and knowledge. It also means working for a greater participation of people in the decisions which affect their lives, making possible an equal receiving from others and giving of themselves. Finally, it means growing up into Christ in all things as a body of people dependent upon the work of the Holy Spirit and upon each other.

III. The Stewardship of Creation

1. 'The earth is the Lord's and all that is in it' (Ps. 24: 1); 'The land is mine' (Lev. 25:23). All human beings are God's creatures. As made in His image they are His representatives, given the responsibility of caring wisely for His creation. We have to confess, however, that God's people have been slow to recognize the full implications of their responsibility. As His stewards, we do not own the earth but we manage and enhance it in anticipation of Christ's return. Too often, however, we have assumed a right to use His natural resources indiscriminately. We have frequently been indifferent, or even hostile, to those committed to the conservation of non-renewable sources of energy and minerals, of animal life in danger of extinction and of the precarious ecological balance of many natural habitats. The earth is God's gift to all generations. An African proverb says that parents have borrowed the present from their children. Both our present life and our children's future depends upon our wise and peaceful treatment of the whole earth.

2. We have also assumed that only a small portion of our income and wealth, the 'tithe', belongs to the Lord, the rest being ours to dispose of as we like. This impoverishes other people and denies our identity and role as stewards. We believe that Christians everywhere, but especially those who are enjoying in abundance 'the good things of life' (Lk. 16:25) must faithfully obey the command to ensure that others have their basic needs met (Mt. 24:25). In this way those who are poor now will also be able to enjoy the blessing

of giving to others.

3. Through salvation, Jesus lifts us out of our isolation from God and other people and establishes us within the world-wide community of the Body of Christ. Belonging to one Body involves sharing all

God's gifts to us, so that there might be equality among all members (2 Co. 8:14-15). To the extent that this standard is obeyed, dire poverty will be eliminated (Acts 2:42-47).

4. When either individuals or states claim an absolute right of ownership, that is rebellion against God. The meaning of stewardship is that the poor have equal rights to God's resources (Dt. 15:8-9). The meaning of transformation is that, as stewards of God's bountiful gifts, we do justice, striving together through prayer, example, representation and protest to have resources redistributed and the consequences of greed limited (Acts 4:32-5:11).

5. We are perturbed by the perverse misuse of huge amounts of resources in the present arms race. While millions starve to death, resources are wasted on the research and production of increasingly sophisticated nuclear weapon systems. Moreover, the constantly escalating global trade in conventional arms accompanies the proliferation of oppressive governments which disregard peoples' elementary needs. As Christians we condemn these new expressions of injustice and aggression, affirming our commitment to seek peace with justice. In the light of the issues of the stewardship of creation we have discussed here, we call on the worldwide evangelical community to make the nuclear and arms trade questions a matter of prayerful concern and place it on their agenda for study and action.

IV. Culture and Transformation

1. Culture includes world-views, beliefs, values, art forms, customs, laws, socioeconomic structures, social relationships, and material things shared by a population over time in a specific area or context.

2. Culture is God's gift to human beings. God has made people everywhere in His image. As Creator, He has made us creative. This creativity produces cultures. Furthermore, God has commissioned us to be stewards of His creation (Ps. 8; Heb. 2:5-11). Since every good gift is from above and since all wisdom and knowledge comes from Jesus Christ, whatever is good and beautiful in cultures may be seen as gifts of God (Js. 1: 16-18). Moreover, where the Gospel has been heard and obeyed, cultures have become further ennobled and enriched.

3. However, people have sinned by rebelling against God. Therefore the cultures we produce are infected with evil. Different aspects of our culture show plainly our separation from God. Social structures and relationships, art forms and laws often reflect our violence, our sense of lostness and our loss of coherent moral values. Scripture challenges us not to be 'conformed to this world' (Ro. 12:2), in so far as it is alienated from its Creator. We need to be transformed so that cultures may display again what is 'good

and acceptable and perfect' (Ro. 12:2).

4. Cultures, then, bear the marks of God's common grace, demonic influences and mechanisms of human exploitation. In our cultural creativity, God and Satan clash. The Lord used Greek culture to give us the New Testament, while at the same time he subjected that culture to the judgement of the Gospel. We too should make thankful use of cultures and yet, at the same time, examine them in the light of the, Gospel to expose the evil in them (1 Co. 9:19-23).

5. Social structures that exploit and dehumanize constitute a pervasive sin which is not confronted adequately by the Church. Many churches, mission societies and Christian relief and development agencies support the sociopolitical status quo, and by silence give their tacit support.

6. Through application of the Scriptures, in the power of the Spirit, we seek to discern the true reality of all sociocultural situations. We need to learn critically from both functionalist and conflict approaches to human culture. The 'functionalist socio-anthropology' approach emphasizes the harmonious aspects of different cultures and champions a tolerant attitude to the existing structures. This position is often adopted in the name of 'scientific objectivity'. By contrast, the 'conflict' approach exposes the contradictory nature of social structures and makes us aware of the underlying conflicts of interests. We must remember that both approaches come under the judgement of God.

7. Given the conflicting ethical tendencies in our nature, which find expression in our cultural systems, we must be neither naively optimistic nor wrongly judgemental. We are called to be a new community, that seeks to work with God in the transformation of our societies; men and women of God in society, salt of the earth and light of the world (Mt. 5:13-16). We seek to bring people and their cultures under the Lordship of Christ. In spite of our failures, we move toward that freedom and wholeness in a more just community which persons will enjoy when our Lord returns to consummate His Kingdom (Rev. 21:1-22:6).

V. Social Justice and Mercy

1. Our time together enabled us to see that poverty is not a necessary evil but often the result of social, economic, political and religious systems marked by injustice, exploitation and oppression. Approximately eight hundred million people in the world are destitute, and their plight is often maintained by the rich and the powerful. Evil is not only in the human heart but also in the social structures. Because God is just and merciful, hating evil and loving righteousness, there is an urgent need for Christians in the present circumstances to

commit ourselves to acting in mercy and seeking for justice. The mission of the Church includes both the proclamation of the Gospel and its demonstration. We must therefore evangelize, respond to immediate human needs and press for social transformation. The means we use, however, must be consistent with the end we desire.

2. As we thought of the task before us, we considered Jesus' attitude toward the power structures of His time. He was neither a Zealot nor a passive spectator of the oppression of His people. Rather, moved by compassion, He identified Himself with the poor, whom He saw as 'harassed and helpless, like sheep without a shepherd' (Mt. 9:36). Through His acts of mercy, teaching and lifestyle, He exposed the injustices in society and condemned the self-righteousness of its leaders (Mt. 23:25; Lk. 6:37-42). His was a prophetic compassion and it resulted in the formation of a community which accepted the values of the Kingdom of God and stood in contrast to the Roman and Jewish establishment. We were challenged to follow Jesus' footsteps, remembering that His compassion led Him to death (Jn. 13:12-17; Phil. 2:6-8; 1 Jn. 3:11-18).

3. We are aware that a Christ-like identification with the poor whether at home or abroad, in the North, South, East or West, is always costly and may lead us also to persecution and even death. Therefore, we humbly ask God to make us willing to risk our comfort, even our lives, for the sake of the Gospel, knowing that 'everyone who wants to live a godly life in Christ Jesus will be persecuted' (2 Tim. 3:12).

4. Sometimes in our ministry among the poor we face a serious dilemma: to limit ourselves to acts of mercy to improve their lot, or to go beyond that and seek to rectify the injustice that makes such acts of mercy necessary. This step in turn may put at risk the freedom we need to continue our ministry. No rule of thumb can be given, but from a biblical perspective it is clear that justice and mercy belong together (Is. 11: 1-5; Ps. 113:5-9). We must therefore make every possible effort to combine both in our ministry and be willing to suffer the consequences. We must also remember that acts of mercy highlight the injustices of the social, economic, and political structures and relationships; whether we like it or not, they may therefore lead us into confrontation with those who hold power (Acts 4:5-22). For the same reason, we must stand together with those who suffer for the sake of justice (Heb. 13:3).

5. Our ministry of justice and healing is not limited to fellow Christians. Our love and commitment must extend to the stranger (Mt. 5:43-48). Our involvement with strangers is not only through charity, but also through economic and political action. Justice must characterize the government's laws and policies toward the poor. Our economic and political action is inseparable from evangelism.

6. Injustice in the modern world has reached global proportions. Many of us come from countries dominated by international business corporations and some from those whose political systems are not accountable to the people. We witness to the damaging effects that these economic and political institutions are having on people, especially on the poorest of the poor. We call on our brothers and sisters in Jesus Christ to study seriously this situation and to seek ways to bring about change in favour of the oppressed. 'The righteous care about justice for the poor, but the wicked have no such concern' (Prov. 29:7).

VI. The Local Church and Transformation

1. The local church is the basic unit of Christian society.

The churches in the New Testament were made up of men and women who had experienced transformation through receiving Jesus Christ as Saviour, acknowledging Him as Lord and incarnating His servant ministry by demonstrating the values of the Kingdom both personally and in community (Mk. 10:35-45; 1 Pet. 2:5; 4:10). Today similar examples of transformed lives abound in churches worldwide.

2. We recognize that across the generations local churches have been the vehicle for the transmission of the Gospel of Jesus Christ, and that their primary, though not their only, role is a threefold ministry: the worship and praise of God, the proclamation in word and deed of the Gospel of the grace of God, and the nurture, instruction and discipleship of those who have received Jesus Christ into their lives. In this way transformation takes place in the lives of Christians as individuals, families and communities; through their words and deeds they demonstrate both the need and reality of ethical, moral and social transformation.

3. All churches are faced at times with the choice between speaking openly against social evils and not speaking out publicly. The purpose for the particular choice should be obedience to the Lord of the Church to fulfill its ministry. Wisdom will be needed so that the Church will neither speak rashly and make its witness ineffective nor remain silent when to do so would deny its prophetic calling (1 Pet. 3:13- 17). If we are sensitive to the Holy Spirit and are socially aware, we will always be ready to reassess our attitude toward social issues (Lk. 18:24-30).

4. Integrity, leadership and information are essential for the transformation of attitudes and lifestyles of members of local churches. Churches are made up of people whose lives are pressured by the way their neighbours spend their money. They are often more aware of this than of the suffering and human need in their own and other countries. Often, too,

they are reluctant to expose themselves to the traumas of global need and to information which would challenge their comfort. If Church leadership fails adequately to stress the social dimensions of the Gospel, Church members may often overlook these issues (1 Tim. 3:1-7; Heb. 13:17).

5. We should be sensitive and responsive to need within the local church. Widows, prisoners, the poor and the strangers are people who are particularly the responsibility of the local church (Gal. 6: 10). We should attempt to be well informed about local human need and to seek God's will for us in meeting those needs. We should seek to minister to the poor in our local area who are not members of the church (Js. 1:27; Rom 12:17).

6. Our churches must also address issues of evil and of social injustice in the local community and the wider society. Our methodology should involve study, earnest prayer and action within the normative, ethical guidelines for Christian conduct set out in Scripture. Within these guidelines there are times, no matter the political system, when protest can be effective. Christians should carefully consider the issues and the manner in which they protest so that the identity and message of the Church is neither blurred nor drowned.

7. The local church has however to be understood as being a part of the universal Church. There is therefore a genuine need for help and sharing (diakonia) built on fellowship (koinonia) between churches of different localities and contexts. In this connection we considered a model for relating churches in different areas of the world. In such 'church twinnings' the relationship should be genuinely reciprocal with giving and receiving at both ends, free from paternalism of any kind (Rom. 15:1-7).

8. Such reciprocal relationships in a spirit of true mutuality are particularly needed in view of the fact that every local church always lives on the edge of compromise with its context (Rom. 12:3-18). Some churches are immersed in the problems of materialism and racism, others in those of oppression and the option of violence. We may help each other by seeking to see the world through the eyes of our brothers and sisters.

9. With regard to the wider world community, Christian churches should identify and exchange people who are equipped through their personal characteristics, training and Christian maturity to work across cultures in the name of Christ and of the sending church. These men and women would go as servants and stewards characterized by humility and meekness; and they would work together with members of the Body of Christ in the countries to which they go.

VII. Christian Aid Agencies and Transformation

1. In reflecting upon the Christian response to human need, we have recognized the central place of the local church as the vehicle for communicating the Gospel of Jesus Christ both in word and deed. Churches around the world have throughout history displayed active concern for the needs around them and continue to serve the needy. We call upon the aid agencies to see their role as one of facilitating the churches in the fulfilment of their mission.

2. We recognize the progress which in recent years has been made in our understanding of the Gospel and its social and political implications. We also recognize, however, the deficiencies in our witness and affirm our desire for a fuller understanding of the biblical basis for our ministry.

3. We acknowledge that the constituency of the aid agencies is generally concerned with human suffering, hunger and need. However, we recognize that this concern is not consistently expressed with integrity. In efforts to raise funds, the plight of the poor is often exploited in order to meet donor needs and expectations. Fund-raising activities must be in accordance with the Gospel. A stewardship responsibility of agencies is to reduce significantly their overheads in order to maximize the resources for the ministry.

4. We are challenged to implement in our organizations a positive transformation demonstrating the values of Christ and His Kingdom which we wish to share with others. We must, for example, avoid competition with others involved in the same ministry and a success mentality that forgets God's special concern for the weak and, unsuccessful' (Gal. 2:10; Ps. 147:6). We should continually review our actions to ensure biblical integrity and genuine partnership with churches and other agencies. Decisions on ministry policy, including how resources are to be used, need to be made in consultation with the people to be served.

5. We need to ensure that our promotional efforts describe what we are actually doing. We accept the responsibility of educating our donors in the full implications of the way Christian transformation is experienced in the field. The Holy Spirit has led us to this ministry. In accepting the responsibility of education we recognize the process may cause some to question our approach. We will strive to educate with a sense of humility, patience and courage.

6. In all of our programmes and actions we should remember that God in His sovereignty and love is already active in the communities we seek to serve (Acts 14:17; 17:23; Rom. 2:9-15). Agencies, therefore, should give adequate priority to listening sensitively to the

concerns of these communities, facilitating a two-way process in communication and local ownership of programmes. The guiding principle is equitable partnership in which local people and Western agencies co-operate together. Many models for development have originated in the Two-Thirds World. Christian aid agencies should in every way encourage these local initiatives to succeed. In this way the redeemed community of the Kingdom will be able to experiment with a number of models of transformation.

7. The agencies' legitimate need for accountability to donors often results in the imposition of Western management systems on local communities. This assumes that Western planning and control systems are the only ones which can ensure accountability. Since the communities these agencies seek to serve are often part of a different culture, this imposition can restrict and inhibit the sensitive processes of social transformation. We call on development agencies to establish a dialogue with those they serve in order to permit the creation of systems of accountability with respect to both cultures. Our ministry must always reflect our mutual inter-dependence in the Kingdom (Ro. 4:17-18; 1 Co. 12).

8. In focusing on the apparently conflicting requirements of our action as Christian agencies, we are conscious of our sin and compromise. In a call to repentance we include a renunciation of inconsistency and extravagance in our personal and institutional lifestyle. We ask the Spirit of truth to lead us and make us true agents of transformation (Acts 1:8).

VIII. The Coming of the Kingdom and the Church's Mission

1. We affirm that the Kingdom of God is both present and future, both societal and individual, both physical and spiritual. If others have over-emphasized the present, the societal and the physical, we ought to confess that we have tended to neglect those dimensions of the biblical message. We therefore joyfully proclaim that the Kingdom has broken into human history in the Resurrection of Christ. It grows like a mustard seed, both judging and transforming the present age.

2. Even if God's activity in history is focused on the Church, it is not confined to the Church. God's particular focus on the Church - as on Israel in the Old Testament has as its purpose the blessing of the nations (Gen. 12:1-3; 15; 17; Is. 42:6). Thus the Church is called to exist for the sake of its Lord and for the sake of humankind (Mt. 22:32-40).

3. The Church is called to infuse the world with hope, for both this age and the next. Our hope does not flow from despair: it is not because the present is empty that we hope for a new future (Rom. 5: 1- 11). Rather, we hope for that future because of what God has already done and because of what He has promised yet to do. We have already been

given the Holy Spirit as the guarantee of our full redemption and of the coming of the day when God will be all in all (1 Co. 15:28). As we witness to the Gospel of present salvation and future hope, we identify with the awesome birth-pangs of God's new creation (Rom. 8:22). As the community of the end-time anticipating the End, we prepare for the ultimate by getting involved in the penultimate (Mt. 24:36-25:46).

4. For this reason we are challenged to commit ourselves to a truly vigorous and full-orbed mission in the world, combining explosive creativity with painstaking faithfulness in small things. Our mission and vision are to be nurtured by the whole counsel of God (2 Tim. 3:16). A repentant, revived and vigorous Church will call people to true repentance and faith and at the same time equip them to challenge the forces of evil and injustice (2 Tim. 3:17). We thus move forward, without either

relegating salvation merely to an eternal future or making it synonymous with a political or social dispensation to be achieved in the here and now. The Holy Spirit empowers us to serve and proclaim Him who has been raised from the dead, seated at the right hand of the Father, and given to the Church as Head over all things in heaven and on earth (Eph. 1: 10, 20-22).

5. Finally, we confess our utter dependence on God. We affirm that transformation is, in the final analysis, His work, but work in which He engages us. To this end He has given us His Spirit, the Transformer par *excellence,* to enlighten us and be our Counsellor (Jn. 16:7), to impart His many gifts to us (Ro. 12; 1 Co. 12), to equip us to face and conquer the enemy (2 Co. 10:3-5; Gal. 5:22-23). We are reminded that our unconfessed sins and lack of love for others grieve the Spirit (Eph. 4:30; Gal. 5:13-16). We therefore fervently pray for our sins to be pardoned, for our spirit to be renewed, and for the privilege of being enlisted in the joyous task of enabling God's Kingdom to come: the Kingdom'. . . of justice, peace and joy in the Holy Spirit' (Ro. 14:17).

SECTION THREE: TRANSFORMATIONAL CONTEXT

Chapter 13

Toward a Missiology of Transformation

By: Chuck Van Engen

Introduction

When my son, Andrew, was four and five years old, he had several toys called "transformers." They were large plastic figures of a soldier or a samurai warrior. When one began turning the various components around and re-fashioning the object, it would turn out to be a jet airplane or an armored vehicle: it would "transform." It was still the same toy, but its various shapes were quite different.

When I think of mission today I think of my son's transformers. Mission praxis and missiological analysis in the Twenty-first Century must undergo a similar radical transformation. It needs to be always the same mission, God's mission, *missio Dei*. Yet we are today in a very different mission situation than we were, say, 100 years ago.

My thesis is that an evangelical missiology of transformation

(1) builds on classical concepts of mission developed over the last 100 years;
(2) overcomes the dichotomies between evangelism and social action that arose 50 years ago; and
(3) re-creates itself in a trinitarian praxis of mission appropriate to the global/local challenges, and opportunities of Church and world in this new century.

Historical Location: Setting the Stage

For us to understand where we are going in the future in articulating a missiology of TRANSFORMATION, it is important to remind ourselves of our past. Let me briefly summarize where we have been in our missiological reflection 100 years ago and 50 years ago. Such a summary may offer us lenses with which to see the future. In Post-Capitalist Society, Peter Drucker said this:

Every few hundred years in (human) history there occurs a sharp transformation.

> We cross what...I have called a "divide." Within a few short decades, (a) society rearranges itself -- its worldview, its basic values; its social and political structures; its arts; its key institutions. Fifty years later, there is a new world. And the people born then cannot even imagine the world in which their grandparents lived and into which their own parents were born. We are currently living through just such a transformation."[53]

A hundred years ago global mission was Western mission, a mostly one-way street from the West and North to everywhere else on the globe. At that time the dominant perspectives had to do with how Western missions could cooperate among themselves, how pioneer areas and peoples could be reached for the first time with the Gospel, and how the fledgling churches in Africa, Asia and Latin America could be helped to become self-governing, self-propagating and self-supporting.

At the beginning of the Twentieth Century there was great optimism about Western culture of modernity and Western civilization. It was assumed that other religions would soon decrease in influence or die out altogether. Mission was predominantly directed to rural areas and medicine, education and agriculture were often seen as means to the evangelization of those who were not yet Christians.

Missions activities were carried out predominantly by denominational mission organizations, with some notable exceptions like the China Inland Mission, the London Missionary Society, the Bible Societies, and others. There was a common understanding of the Bible, and missiologists shared a common definition of mission, articulated and popularized by the Student Volunteer Movement's (SVM) watchword, "The evangelization of the world in this generation.

In a video lecture series in 1984 on "How My Mind has Changed about Mission," Stephen Neill observed that at the time of the great mission congress of Edinburgh, 1910, there were "nine grounds for sober optimism". I summarize them below.

1. The geographical exploration of the planet was nearly complete.
2. There was increased safety of human life in the world – wars had ceased.
3. The health of missionaries was much better.
4. Conduits had been won to every major religion, everywhere; every social system had yielded some converts.
5. Major languages had been learned.
6. The Bible was available in the most widely spoken languages.
7. The churches themselves had become engaged in missionary work overseas.
8. The gigantic Student Christian Movement was in place.

9. Third-World churches were already becoming missionary churches in their own right.

Neill concluded that lecture by observing that there were "three great changes of which we were unaware" in mission at the beginning of the Twentieth Century.

a. That many lands would soon be closed to foreign missionary endeavor.
b. That there would be a recovery and rise of the great non-Christian religions.
c. That the decline of the Church would be mainly in the West, and in the most firmly established churches.

Yet through it all, in the midst of all the changes, Neill affirmed that, "The aim of all our preaching is that our hearers get a clear picture of Jesus Christ. We really want people to become Christians. If we have seen Christ and life in Him, we desire that all should see Him – this is mission." (Neil 1984, end of video, Part I)

A century ago Christian missions generally shared a consensus around a classical view of mission that did not split evangelism and social action. Missiologists generally saw the Gospel as impacting all of life. They had a common definition of mission, articulated and popularized by the watchword of the Student Volunteer Movement (SVM): "The evangelization of the world in this generation." That "watchword" was later used by John R. Mott as the title of his most famous book and was also adopted as the motto of the great World Missionary Conference of Edinburgh, 1910. The SVM's watchword assumed a somewhat wholistic view of mission, even though we must recognize that such a view was too often encased in a Euro-centric goal of Christianization and civilization. Yet even that goal assumed a conversion component. That view of mission also involved a great deal of tension. We must recognize that the Venn-Anderson 3-self formula that dominated the scene was heavily ecclesiocentric (mostly introverted and rather static), and lacked a commitment to transform the culture or change the political and socio-economic realities of the day.[54] The emphasis on social service of a hundred years ago in terms of agriculture, medicine and education were not seen as activities over-against verbal proclamation and personal faith conversion. They were seen as integral aspects of proclamation of a Gospel that called for conversion. After the Second World War this changed in North American thinking about mission and a great gulf was created between those who advocated socio-economic and political change over against those who affirmed verbal proclamation as being central to mission.

Mid-century Reactions: Overcoming Dichotomies

Then came the world wars, the French, Mexican, Bolshevik and Maoist revolutions, the Korean War, the birth of the World Council of Churches, and the search to reconstruct Europe and Japan among other events. The globe began to shrink due to the rise of airplane travel, radio, telephones, and television. And the churches in Asia, Africa and Latin America began to grow, mature, and rise in global influence. The perspectives of mission changed radically, producing profound dichotomies.

Fifty years ago new nations arose around the globe. The "moratorium" debate[55] brought to the foreground of mission consciousness the development, growth and mission role of those who were first called "younger" and later "national" churches in Africa, Asia and Latin America.[56] Some Western Protestant churches and missions were talking about the end of the so-called "missionary era," and advocating it be replaced by an "ecumenical era" of church-to-church cooperation and the global sharing of resources. [57] Global ecumenicity became a major agenda for some, coupled with a strong emphasis on socio-political changes in Africa, Asia and Latin America.

> Reacting to this direction in ecumenical mission theology, the Evangelical Protestants formed new coalitions to emphasize verbal proclamation and personal conversion over-against socio-political, economic and humanitarian goals in mission. Seemingly, Evangelical Protestants were no longer bothered by an "Uneasy Conscience"[58] with regard to the social dimensions of the Gospel. New cooperative ventures for world evangelization arose in Wheaton, 1966 and Berlin, 1966 that eventuated in the Church Growth Movement, the Lausanne Movement, the AD2000 Movement and other Western-based initiatives that saw mission in more traditional terms of finding missiologically effective means whereby "men and women may become disciples of Jesus Christ and responsible members of Christ's Church"[59]

We might summarize the mission perspective of the 1950's and 1960's as follows.

1. National churches began to mature throughout Asia, Africa, Latin America and Oceania.
2. New nations were born, particularly throughout Africa, and a strong anti-colonial critique of mission arose among older churches.
3. Sodality faith missions increased in number and significance, particularly in North America.
4. The moratorium debate grew.
5. A two-way traffic of conversation regarding world mission arose with an increasingly strident critique coming from the younger national churches.
6. The Commission on World Mission and Evangelism (CWME) met in Mexico

City in 1962, with the theme: "Mission in Six Continents"
7. The Vatican Council II transformed the Roman Catholic Church.
8. The Protestant split between evangelism and social action worsened.
9. Evangelical/Ecumenical debates arose and became more heated, paralleling two different readings of the Bible (a traditional view and a more socio-politically- and economically-oriented view). [60]
10. A strong Ecumenical Movement took shape in the WCC.
11. Global Evangelical coalitions and cooperative structures were created – must notably the Lausanne Movement
12. Two-Thirds World theologians began to raise their voices offering new perspectives on the mission of the Church.

After World War II there was a rather severe split between differing views of Christian mission. Heavily impacted by a guilty conscience about the Holocaust and the Third Reich, and following the lead of J. C. Hoekendijk, the World Council of Churches folks stressed a theology of relevance with heavy socio-political agendas, over-against personal faith.

In reaction to that, and especially disillusioned by the integration of the IMC into the WCC,[61] evangelically-minded folks in Europe and North America stressed verbal proclamation that would seek personal conversion to Jesus Christ, over-against socio-political agendas.[62] The Civil Rights movement in the U.S. and liberation theology movements in Latin America, the Philippines, South Korea, India and elsewhere simply exacerbated the split. Donald McGavran's writings, as polemical as they were, though pointing in the right direction, too often encouraged a widening of the gap between these opposing views of mission.

Forty years later, we find ourselves still challenged by Harold Lindsell's words offered in 1962.

> It is regrettable that fifty years after Edinburgh (1910) there cannot be a world congress for mission that transcends some of the unimportant differences dividing those of similar missionary aims….Perhaps the faith missions may be able to enlarge this vision and provide a creative and dynamic leadership for a new age of missionary advance"[63]

Alas, it would seem that Evangelical sodality missions have not yet met this challenge.

The historical development of theology of mission I have outlined above should give Evangelicals pause in the way we use certain phrases. For example, "The Whole Church taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole World" was not the creation of the Lausanne

movement at the Lausanne II meeting in Manila in 1989. It was first used by the Central Committee of the World Council of Churches meeting in Rolle, Switzerland in 1951.[64]

"Mission on Six Continents" or some such phraseology that emphasizes the multiple directions of global mission from everywhere to everywhere was first used at the Commission on World Mission and Evangelism gathering in Mexico City in 1963.[65]

The concept of *missio Dei* that appears to be used with regularity among Evangelicals today was first articulated by Karl Barth in 1932[66] and, following Barth, by Karl Hartenstein in 1952. It was associated with a trinitarian view of mission at the IMC conference in Willingen, 1952. The concept was popularized by Georg Vicedom in 1958, became rather common currency in the ecumenical movement after Mexico City, 1963.[67] It was used as the conceptual foundation for the WCC and NCC discussion about "the missionary structures of the congregation" in 1963.[68] In conciliar theology of mission the ship of *missio Dei* was eventually loaded with so much baggage it nearly sank.[69]

As I sought to demonstrate in *Mission on the Way*, when Church and Mission are confused and fused, and when the *missio Dei* is made to stand for any and all activities that the Church may want to carry out in the world – then Stephen Neill's dictum seems to prove out: "When everything is mission, nothing is mission."[70] In the World Council of Churches the term eventually referred to a change of order in the concept of mission. The classical mission perspective begins with God who works primarily through the Church to reach and transform the world (God-Church-world). But J.C. Hoekendijk's deep pessimism about the Church motivated him to suggest in *The Church Inside Out* (1966) that a new order was called for, an order that became an essential part of the WCC's understanding of *missio Dei* after its Fourth Assembly in Uppsala in 1968. After 1968, following Hoekendijk's lead, *missio Dei* was used in WCC circles to emphasize that God was at work in the world and the best the Church could do was to join the movements of what God was doing in the world (God-world-Church). This change of order had profound and far-reaching effect on the mission theology of the folks associated with the World Council of Churches. Given the three examples summarized above, I believe Evangelical missiologists must be very careful to articulate clearly what they mean – and what they don't mean – by using such terms.

I don't believe anyone was really satisfied with the dichotomy I have outlined above. The 1970's and 1980's involved multiple attempts to narrow the gap between social action and verbal evangelism. The Lausanne Movement birthed a number of consultations, papers, and gatherings seeking to re-think the matter of the "priority of evangelism" as it had been articulated in the Lausanne Covenant. In the 1970's Arthur Glasser, though still using the language of the "evangelistic mandate" and the "cultural mandate," began to draw from the

works of Oscar Cullmann (1951), Hermann Ridderbos (1962) and George Ladd (1974) to develop the notion of the Kingdom of God as a way of bringing evangelism and social action closer together. There is today a very substantial global consensus around the Kingdom-of-God theme as a way of building a more wholistic view of mission.[71] This motif has been prominent in the theology of mission of Rene Padilla and his associates in the Latin American Theological Fraternity (LATF). Drawing from the Kingdom-of-God theme they have developed the idea of "integral mission" as a conceptual framework that might bridge the gap between verbal proclamation and social action.[72]

The Evangelical Association of Third-World Theologians (EATWOT) wrestled with the problem at the early stages of their conversations. [73] Members of the Asia Theological Association also sought to articulate a more wholistic understanding of mission that would bridge the old dichotomies, as evidenced in the writings of, for example, Ken Gnanakan (1989, 1992). In the World Council there arose a greater interest in matters of spirituality and spiritual formation. And Latin American Liberation Theologians like Gustavo Gutierrez began to explore matters of spirituality and spiritual formation as integral to liberation.

So in the 1980's and 1990's we see Evangelical perspectives of mission beginning to be interested in a "wholistic" approach to mission. I believe an impetus for this may have been the fact that the predominantly North American-based sodality mission agencies, active for more than 50 years, now have second- and third-generation converts and maturing churches in Africa, Asia and Latin America. These converts, fruit of the early evangelization of these Western Evangelical mission sodalities, have begun to search for ways in which the Gospel they accepted may impact the socio-economic, cultural and political realities in which they find themselves. These new generations of converts are now living in circumstances of oppression, persecution, disease, hunger, and abject poverty. And they are beginning to ask their brothers and sisters in the West what should be the impact of the Gospel upon the reality they are now experiencing.

With the decline of the Church in the West, and the center of gravity shifting so that two-thirds of all world Christianity is now in Asia, Africa, Latin America and Oceania, the Church of Jesus Christ is increasingly a Church of the poor and oppressed. So at the beginning of this new century, Christians around the globe suffer all the same oppression, want, and need as the non-Christians in their contexts in the so-called two-thirds world. David Barrett signaled this development already in an article published in the October, 1983, issue of the *International Bulletin of Missionary Research*, "Silver and Gold Have I None: Church of the Poor and Church of the Rich?" (7:4, Oct 1983, 146-151).

Thus the global "Enquiry" movement that Luis Bush has spearheaded is very important. It has the potential of spawning a re-conceptualization of the nature of mission that flows

from the fountainhead of the majority church in the majority world, articulated by majority Christians spread now on all six continents. One might say that for the first time since Constantine, over 1600 years ago, the world church has the potential of constructing its understanding of mission with the building blocks drawn from the experience, life, vitality, and vision of churches and missions in the south and east of the globe as well as the north and the west. All this leads to a desire to re-think and re-conceptualize the nature of mission at the beginning of this new century.

The Present Situation: Recovering Believability

When I was small, growing up in San Cristobal de Las Casas, Chiapas, in southern Mexico, the word "transformer" referred to those large round containers hanging on electrical poles that transformed high-voltage electricity into a form usable in a domestic home. With some regularity they would blow up, leaving us all in the dark. The genius of those transformers was that they converted the energy from the high-tension power lines -- energy that was not useful and was in fact harmful for our homes – and transformed it into voltage, wattage, and cycles that were appropriate for use in our homes. It adapted the electricity to the context of our homes.

At the beginning of this new century, I believe we are in just such a situation in our re-conceptualization of global/local mission of the Church. With two-thirds of world Christianity located now in the South and East, I believe that one of the most significant issues of global/local mission on, from, and to six continents in today's world will involve the *believability* of the Church and its mission. From the perspective of those who are not yet Christians, amidst the marketplace of competing religious affiliations, in a global climate of profound spiritual hunger and curiosity, is the Church and its mission believable? It would appear that earlier attempts to articulate a relevant theology of mission have fallen short.

- The 3-self formula is not good enough: it is too ecclesiocentric and introverted. It looks at the Church through a predominantly institutional lens and is easily blinded to the issues facing those living in the contexts outside the Church.
- The "priority of evangelism" language is not contextually appropriate enough for most situations. It seems more concerned with forming *a-priori* propositionally-framed definitions of evangelism than it is to respond to the needs, aspirations, concerns and dreams of the persons in the surrounding context who yet do not know Jesus Christ. The balance of word and deed in our evangelism should be receptor-oriented and contextually-informed.
- The Kingdom-of-God language is helpful, but has taken on a host of different meanings and forms in actual practice – and it seems to be too easily narrowed to predominantly vertical perceptions of the Gospel, with a loss of the horizontal

issues at hand. I am beginning to see that, to be true to the Bible's picture of God and God's mission, I must permeate the Kingdom language with language about relationship, about covenant, about love of God and neighbor. Though such a framework may be assumed by those who speak about the "Kingdom of God," it is not always apparent nor often emphasized.

- As mentioned in the discussion above, the *missio Dei* language, though potentially useful, needs major clarification today because of the multiple, confusing, and sometimes-contradictory baggage the term carries. How are we to distinguish that which is part of the *missio Dei* and that which is not? We must be careful not to make everything mission – and lose mission in the process.[74]
- The language of "wholistic mission" or "incarnational mission" may also have something to offer, but at times these terms seem to draw from perspectives that continue to labor with a dichotomy between mission as verbal and personal proclamation and mission that seeks socio-cultural and structural change. At other times "incarnational mission" seems so culture-affirming that the prophetic scandal of the cross and the challenge of the Gospel to transform all of life may be eclipsed by the desire to identify with the receptors.

All-in-all, it is as if we as Evangelicals have begun to realize that if mission were looked at as a coin, we must take seriously both the "heads" and the "tails" side of the coin. But we seem to continue our quest to keep the "heads" and "tails" separate-yet-together, rather than recognize that the coin, for example, is a "quarter." I would suggest that a missiology of TRANSFORMATION might help us to speak of mission as the "quarter" rather than as "heads" and "tails."

David Bosch gave his *magnum opus* the title, "Transforming Mission." And in doing so, he meant to offer a play on three meanings:

1. In the New Testament and over time, the concept of mission was transformed in such a way that a variety of "paradigms" of self-understanding took shape related to the Church's conceptualization of mission
2. Over time, the activities of mission transform the Church as it participates in God's mission.
3. Bosch's readers –and the Church at large -- need to allow the Holy Spirit to transform their idea of mission to include at least the thirteen "elements of an emerging ecumenical mission paradigm" that Bosch outlines in the last chapter of his book.

I would suggest that Bosch's use of the concept of "transformation" did not go far enough. In Romans 12: 2, the Apostle Paul admonishes his hearers, "Do not be conformed to this

world but be TRANSFORMED by the renewal of your mind, that you may prove what is the will of God, what is good and acceptable and perfect." (NIV) Paul here uses the Greek form, μεταμορφουσθε He calls for *metamorphosis*![75] A missiology of metamorphosis would entail the kind of mission that we see in the transformation of the woman of Sychar – and of the village of Sychar -- in John 4.

Metamorphosis is the word used to describe the phenomenal transformation that happens when a chrysalis becomes a butterfly! I believe a biblical missiology of transformation envisions just such a change in persons, social structures and nations of our world because of the Gospel of the Kingdom and the work of the Holy Spirit.

Such a missiology of metamorphosis would involve the kind of radical change we see in Paul after meeting Jesus on the Damascus road. This is God's mission that seeks to "rescue (people) from the dominion of darkness and (bring them) into the kingdom of the Son (God) loves, in whom we have redemption, the forgiveness of sins." (Col. 1:13-14 NIV. This is such a profound, all-pervasive transformation that Paul would end up saying, "I have been crucified with Christ and I no longer live, but Christ lives in me. The life I live in the body, I live by faith in the Son of God, who loved me and gave himself for me." (Gal. 2:20 NIV)

This is a missiology that seeks to turn the world upside down. Because the Church's mission is to participate in Jesus' mission – and Jesus' mission sets the parameters of the Church's mission, the Christian Church-in-mission intends to "preach good news to the poor…to proclaim freedom from the prisoners and recovery of sight for the blind, to release the oppressed, to proclaim the year of the Lord's favor." (Lk 4:18-19 NIV) At the end of a chapter discussing "The goal and purpose of mission," Johannes Verkuyl pointed to a missiology of metamorphosis by emphasizing "the Kingdom of God as the Goal of the *missio Dei."* Here are some excerpts of his thought.

> The kingdom to which the Bible testifies involves a proclamation and a realization of a total salvation, on which covers the whole range of human needs and destroys every pocket of evil and grief affecting [hu]mankind. Kingdom in the New Testament has a breadth and a scope which is unsurpassed; it embraces heaven as well as earth, world history as well as the whole cosmos.
>
> The kingdom of God is that new order of affairs begun in Christ which, when finally completed by him, will involve a proper restoration not only of [hu]man's relationship to God but also of those between sexes, generations, races, and even between [humans] and nature….

When we inquire into the practical consequences of viewing mission from the perspective of the kingdom and its structures, one of the first things to mention is our God-given call to invite human beings to come to know Jesus as the Messiah of the kingdom…. Two things are necessary in order to lead people to the Messiah and to invite them to confess him in word and deed. In the first place, they must come to know what the New Testament says about him…. The second thing necessary as we lead people to the Messiah is for each of us to recall that the living Lord is actually present…. Therefore every generation discovers fresh aspects about him and confesses him in a new manner….

Precisely because we have accepted the kingdom as the frame of reference and point of orientation for our missionary task, we must go on to claim that a call to conversion must necessarily follow our proclamation…. Within the framework of the kingdom, conversion has been viewed properly as one of the inclusive goals of mission….

According to the New Testament, proclaiming the messianic message must always be accompanied by gathering, preserving and adding to the people of God…. Missiology must always save a spot for ecclesiology and for the study of churches in their own environments….

Viewing our missionary task within the wider perspective of the kingdom will lead us to still another insight: participation in the fight against every vestige of evil plaguing [hu]mankind is an intrinsic part of our calling. According to the Bible the kingdom does not belong to the future. It is a present reality which, though not yet fully revealed, does nevertheless show definite signs of being underway….

It is gratifying to be able to note at the end of this study of the goal of the *missio Dei* and our concomitant mission that missiology is more and more coming to see the kingdom of God as the hub around which all of mission work revolves…. The churches on all six continents need to be alert to changing needs and set their priorities accordingly. But even so they must present the entire message of the kingdom and not reduce it to just one point. We would be most inhuman if we should treat only the most acute and pressing needs of a people and deprive them of the full range of God's promises by failing to mention the Messiah himself…. At the same time, it would be a sign of sinful sloth and indolence if we were not to attempt in faith, together with the children of the kingdom throughout the world, to erect in the midst of the wide range of human burdens and evils signs and signals of that which is coming. He who prays, 'Thy kingdom come, thy

will be done' is thereby called to aid in spreading the kingdom of God over the length and breadth of the earth."[76]

Verkuyl's trinitarian, kingdom-oriented emphasis echoed Lesslie Newbigin's view expressed in *The Open Secret*. "The Christian mission," he affirmed, "is an acting out of a fundamental belief and, at the same time, a process in which this belief is being constantly reconsidered in the light of the experience of acting it out in every sector of human affairs and in dialogue with every other pattern of thought by which men and women seek to make sense of their lives. [This] fundamental belief is embodied in the affirmation that God has revealed himself as Father, Son, and Spirit. I shall therefore [look]…at the Christian mission in three ways – as the proclaiming of the kingdom of the Father, as sharing in the life of the Son, and as bearing the witness of the Spirit."[77]

Recreation in a Century: Seeking a Missiology of Transformation

How, then, may we go about constructing a trinitarian, Kingdom-based missiology of transformation? It seems to me that a first step would be to affirm that mission is not fundamentally ours: it does not belong to the Church, it is not the property of mission agencies, it is not owned by the Christian NGO's (non-governmental organizations). It is not for us to determine the content or parameters of our mission. Rather, following the emphasis first articulated by Vicedom, mission is most fundamentally God's mission: it is *missio* Dei. This being true, it is essential that we construct a theological foundation on which to build the rest of the superstructure of a missiology of transformation. Such a foundation cannot be essentially anthropological or strategic, demographic or linguistic, political or economic, sociological, psychological or political. It is also not determined by the needs, demands or aspirations of our target audiences. The pilings driven into the soft earth of our various contexts, pilings that will support the structure of a missiology of transformation must be theological truths drawn from Scripture and from the Church's understanding of God learned throughout twenty centuries of the Church's experience and reflection of God. This is a tall order, a is far beyond the limits of this chapter. However, in the final section of this paper I want to describe in broad strokes, in the form of a set of summary statements, what I believe could be the content of a trinitarian, kingdom-based missiology of transformation. We begin, then, as does the Bible (e.g., Gen 1-3, Psalm 8, John 1, Eph. 1, Col. 1) with affirmations about God the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

God the Father

- Christians care for creation not because it is "mother earth" (New Age paganism), nor because its care guarantees the survival of the human race (secular humanism), but

rather because it is the creation of, and is cared for and supported by our heavenly Father in Jesus Christ (Psalm 8, John 1, Col 1, and Eph. 1). We know that there is a link between the salvation of humans and the salvation of the earth. For "the creation waits in eager expectation for the [children] of God to be revealed...in hope that the creation itself will be liberated from its bondage to decay and brought into the glorious freedom of the children of God" (Rom 8:19-22).And we know that the status of creation is intimately connected with the relationship of humans with God. When humans rebelled against God in the Garden of Eden, creation itself fell. And now "we know that the whole creation has been groaning as in the pains of childbirth right up to the present time…(because) the creation waits in eager expectation for the (children) of God to be revealed" (Rom. 8:22,19). God is always, at all times, actively involved in the preservation and re-creation of all that is. Thus a missiology of transformation that participates in the *missio Dei* involves Christians in the care, preservation, and re-creation of all the created order.

- All humans are members of the same human family (We are all cousins, as it were.), created by the same God (Gen 1-3, John 1). And all human life is intrinsically valuable because, though fallen, it is created by God, in God's image. Thus, as children of the Creator God, Christians are inherently against all that de-humanizes and destroys life. A missiology of transformation will involve a profound commitment to affirming all that values, cares for, and enhances human life. The God of the Bible loves all humans equally (the Tables of Nations of Gen 10 and Acts 2). "For God so loved the world" (Jn. 3:16) includes all humanity, including all those who are not yet Christian. So a missiology of transformation will seek by all legitimate means to call all peoples to a living faith relationship with their Creator in Jesus Christ by grace through faith granted us by the Holy Spirit.
- Because God the Creator of all has placed humans as stewards over God's creation, a missiology of transformation is a missiology of stewardship. This stewardship is not merely the careful and wise use of what you and I have. Rather, it is the careful, purposeful and loving care of all that belongs to God. And all that we have belongs to God. Christians understand that it is their God-given responsibility and calling to be STEWARDS of all that God has created (Gen 1-3, Psalm 8, Hebrews 2:6-9)
- The God of the Bible is a compassionate God, slow to anger and abounding and mercy (See, e.g., Ex 34:6; 2Chr 30:9; Ps 86:15) who would not have any to perish but that desires that everyone should come to repentance (II Peter 3:9). Thus we as Christians love all other human beings because God first loved them and gave his life for them – in that while we all were yet sinners, Christ died for us and for them (Rom. 5:8) Our motivation for mission derives from God's creation, God's love, God's mission, and God's desire. To be "children of God" (John 1:12) entails participating in God's mission. We are, therefore eager to preach the Gospel to all peoples because

we are in fact “debtors to both Greeks and non-Greeks, both to the wise and foolish” (Rom. 1:14). We participate in our Father’s calling all people to himself, for “anyone who trusts in him will never be put to shame. For there is no difference between Jew and Gentile – the same Lord is Lord of all and richly blesses all who call on him, for ‘Everyone who calls on the name of the Lord will be saved.’” (Rom 10:11-13)

God the Son: Jesus the Christ

- Christians in conversation with people of other faiths confess that there is salvation in no one else: only through faith in Jesus Christ (Acts 4:12). A missiology of transformation will acknowledge the general revelation or prevenient grace that God has shone in the midst of other faiths, but will affirm as well that only in Jesus Christ is God's revelation complete – and only in Jesus Christ is there salvation.
- The Incarnation shows us that salvation involves the creation of a completely new person, for "if anyone is in Christ [that person] is a new creation; the old has gone, the new has come" (II Cor 5:17). Thus a missiology of transformation will be involved in the creation and re-creation of persons, seeking for them to become fully complete, fully human in Jesus Christ.
- Incarnational contextuality points us to receptor-oriented communication and contextualization. Jesus adapted his mission not only to humans, but also to specific humans: e.g., compare his mission with Nicodemus to his mission with the woman of Sychar (Jn. 3 and 4).
- The content of the Church's mission is defined and circumscribed by Jesus' mission. In Luke 4, Jesus describes and declares the essence of his mission. Drawing from the way the New Testament describes Jesus'

messianic mission, as the Body of Christ, the Church's mission involves at least *Koinonia, Kerygma*, *Diakonia,* and *Marturia* by being for the world a community of Prophets, Priests, Kings, Healers, Liberators and Sages as the loving Community of the King[78]

- A christological foundation of a missiology of transformation will also involve discipleship in two senses. First, our Great Commission calling is to make disciples – to call, invite, and gather those who will become disciples of Jesus Christ. Secondly, Christ's disciples are to "offer their bodies as living sacrifices" with a view to being continually transformed in order to "test and approve what [is] God's…good, pleasing, and perfect will" (Rom. 12:2). As disciples of Jesus we are by nature missionary disciples and "Christ's love compels us to be ambassadors of reconciliation in a hurting, troubled and conflicted world (II Cor 5:11-21).
- Christ's lordship is lordship over all humans. One day, "every knee will bow" to his lordship (Phil. 2). Our privilege, right, and duty are to proclaim the Gospel of the Kingdom that "Jesus is Lord" in every corner of the globe, among every people group, to every person. Christ's lordship is also over the principalities and powers of this world, including global economic, political, social, and structural centers of power.

God the Holy Spirit

- The Holy Spirit transforms all of life – every aspect and all facets of one's life. Thus a pneumatologically-grounded missiology of transformation will seek the creation and re-creation of the whole person, permeating all relationships and human structures relative to that person's life.
- The Holy Spirit convicts "the world of guilt in regard to sin and righteousness and judgment" (Jn. 16:8). The Holy Spirit converts (transforms) persons, giving them grace and faith to believe in Jesus Christ. The Holy Spirit is the agent of transformation of persons from inside out. Conversion is not possible except by the work of the Holy Spirit. Thus a missiology of transformation can only happen through the work of the Holy Spirit. A missiology of transformation will seek, in the power of the Holy Spirit, to create and re-create the spiritual life of persons along with the physical, social, emotional and intellectual aspects of their being. A corollary of this is to recognize that a pneumatological missiology of transformation will by its very nature involve a variety of forms of spiritual warfare.
- A pneumatologically-grounded missiology of transformation entails the realization that only the Holy Spirit creates the Church – and only the Holy Spirit empowers and directs the Church's mission.[79] The Holy Spirit

forms, transforms and re-forms the Church to be, know, do, serve, and relate in ways depicted by a host of biblical metaphors of the Church-in-mission like "salt of the earth," "light of the world," earthen vessels filled with the pearls of the Gospel, Body of Christ, a new humanity, ambassadors of reconciliation, the Family of God, among many others. The spirituality of Christians, of churches, and of mission agencies must be transformed through the ministry of the Holy Spirit and directed in mission to a lost and hurting world so loved by God.

- The gifts of the Holy Spirit are given to the Church for mission in the world. And the fruits of the Holy Spirit are the Spirit's gift to the world through the presence of the community of faith that embodies that fruit. Our world is in desperate need of the fruit of the Holy Spirit: love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control (Gal 5:22). And this fruit is based on people living out the Decalogue in love of God and neighbor. Such fruit, in the power of the Holy Spirit will radically transform – it will fundamentally alter -- the realities in which we live today.
- Jesus Christ rules in the Kingdom through the ministry of the Holy Spirit. We cannot have a kingdom missiology unless we have an equally broad, deep, high and wide pneumatological conception and praxis in mission.
- As the down payment of eternal life (Eph. 1:14), the Holy Spirit creates hope for the coming of the Kingdom in Jesus Christ.[80] A pneumatologically-grounded missiology of transformation will eagerly await the final day when Christ returns and the final, full transformation will occur in a new heaven and a new earth. Then transformed Christians in a transformed reality will gather around the throne of the Lamb and sing, "Worthy is the Lamb who was slain to receive power and wealth and wisdom and strength and honor and glory and praise!" (Rev. 5:12 NIV).

The summary statements offered above are but an outline of what I believe is involved in articulating the theological underpinnings of a missiology of transformation. At the heart of this vision is a commitment to radical change.

Conclusion

During the 1970's and 1980's I served as a missionary in Tapachula, a tropical city on the Mexican border with Guatemala. There, a "transformer" was a small box into which we plugged our appliances to regulate the electricity coming to them through the house. That "transformer" would raise the voltage to acceptable levels and would cushion electrical surges. These devices were invaluable for the extended life of our electrical appliances.

In like fashion, global/local mission in the Twenty-first Century must be contextually and culturally appropriate to the needs, aspirations, worldviews and agendas of the persons in

each context. In order to meet such demands, a Missiology of Transformation will need to be based on a trinitarian view of mission that is in continuity with what we have learned about mission during the past one hundred years and also in rather significant discontinuity with mission praxis as that has been carried out during the past one hundred years. Continuity and discontinuity. That would seem to be the essence of the concept of

"TRANS--FORM--ATION." A missiology of transformation involves TRANS-- and --FORMATION, discontinuity and change coupled with continuity and re-creation.

TRANS-- (discontinuity)

A missiology of transformation calls for movement, for metamorphosis, for change, for conversion, for a change of heart. Without a change of heart, a change of self, of being, nothing will change. Merely a change of religious affiliation, merely an individual, vertical conversion will not change the persons, structures, systems and cultures of this world. To be believable the Church and Christians must ***be good for something*** – they must be able to demonstrate to the people of their contexts and nations that they have something concrete, measurable, visible, positive, constructive and helpful to offer their contexts and nations. This calls for radical conversion as much of the Church and of Christians to their mission of being Christ's transforming presence in the world – just as much as conversion of non-Christians to faith in Jesus Christ.

-- FORMATION (continuity)

A missiology of transformation also calls for incarnational contextuality, for wrestling with the relationship of Gospel and culture in thousands of different contexts worldwide. This transformation is not merely a change of religious affiliation, not merely a matter of new church membership. This is not merely civilization or education, or a change of ethical behavior; it is not merely socio-economic and political betterment. Rather, a missiology of transformation entails the *new formation*, the *re-creation* of whole persons – of all and every aspect of their lives, each in their particular context in terms of knowing, being, doing, serving, and relating to one other: It has simultaneously personal, social, structural and national implications. It involves reconciliation with God, self, creation, others, and the socio-cultural structures. (Cf. I Cor 5; see also C. Van Engen's definition of mission in footnote 14 above.)

John ends his Gospel by saying, "Jesus did many other miraculous signs which are not recorded in this book. But these are written that you may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and that by believing you may have life in his name" (Jn. 20:30-31). That you may have life. Like a sponge is permeated with water, so our mission is to offer new

life to the women and men of our world of the Twenty-First Century in which all of their life, every aspect of life, all arenas of life are permeated with the presence of God the Father, Son and Holy Spirit. And the rich and powerful of this world need to be transformed, they need to be converted, just as much as the poor and the weak.

This is a time of massive social change in Africa, Asia, Eastern Europe and Latin America – as well as the cities of Western Europe, Australia, and North America. And the Church of Jesus Christ is there to proclaim the Gospel and contribute to the building of new nations and the re-building of old ones. The Church of Jesus Christ stands for love, joy, peace, reconciliation and the value of human life.

Our mission is a mission of transformation. I think Gisbertus Voetius (1589-1676) had it right -- but, because of his Christendom perspective, he was incomplete in his view of the goal of the God's mission. Voetius stated that the goal of mission is three-fold: the conversion of people to Jesus Christ, the planting and development of the Church, and the glory of God.[81]

I believe that in the Twenty-first Century we must add a fourth goal, inserted between "planting and development of the Church" and "the glory of God," as seen below. We know that today about one quarter of the earth's population in some fashion profess their faith in Jesus Christ. Those Christians are spread now around the globe in every nation on earth, speak more languages and have more ease of communication and travel than ever before in the history of the Church. For the first time in human history the Church of Jesus Christ can present the Gospel in an understandable form to every human being on the face of the planet. But that also means that the Church also has the opportunity, duty and calling to be a transforming presence in every corner of the globe. Thus, I believe we should add a fourth goal of mission, as follows.

- the conversion of people to Jesus Christ,
- the planting and development of the Church,
- **the TRANSFORMATION of the Church and, through the Church's ministries, the transformation of the contexts and nations in which the churches are to be found, and**
- the glory of God.

Orlando Costas was right when he affirmed that the Church can only be a penultimate goal of mission, not the final goal. Socio-economic and political change is also merely a penultimate goal of mission. A trinitarian, kingdom-oriented missiology of transformation will hold to only one goal: the glory of God (See, e.g., Eph 1:6, 12, 14). One day we will all

stand together with all those from every tribe, family, tribe and nation who have washed their robes in the blood of the Lamb. We will all stand around the throne of the Lamb and sing, "Worthy is the Lamb who was slain…" (Rev. 5:12).

Our mission is to participate in Jesus' mission whose mission it was to do God's mission in the power of the Holy Spirit: no more, no less. This is a mission of radical transformation – a mission of metamorphosis. What shape must this take in the interim between the "already" and the "not yet" of the coming of the Kingdom of God? I believe Lesslie Newbigin captured it well when he challenged us all to give concrete presence, life and expression to our mission (our mission-as-transformation) in and through the life of local congregations spread around the globe. He said it this way.

> "The primary reality of which we have to take account in seeking for a Christian impact on public life is the Christian congregation....The only hermeneutic of the Gospel is a congregation of men and women who believe it and live by it....This community will have, I think, the following six characteristics:
>
> - It will be a community of praise.
> - It will be a community of truth.
> - It will be a community that does not live for itself.
> - It will be a community...sustained in the exercise of the priesthood in the world.
> - It will be a community of mutual responsibility.
> - It will be a community of hope."[82]
>
> Whether it is a toy in the hands of my son, Andrew, a large container hanging from a pole, or a small electrical box in southern Mexico, the three images tell us one thing: they were meant to be always the same yet always changing into something different. So it is with our mission in this new century. Our mission is to proclaim in word and deed always the same Gospel that is always taking on new forms – it is always transformed and always transforming.

My thesis has been that an evangelical missiology of transformation

(1) builds on classical concepts of mission developed over the last 100 years;
(2) overcomes the dichotomies between evangelism and social action that arose 50 years ago; and
(3) re-creates itself in a trinitarian praxis of mission appropriate to the global/local challenges, and opportunities of Church and world in this new century.

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SECTION FIVE: TRANSFORMATIONAL CONCLUSIONS

Chapter 14

Several concluding observations can be made related to transformation as a unifying mission for the Church at the beginning of the twenty-first century. A three-year World Inquiry related to the mission of God has shown that "the patterns of the past are showing 'wear' and are in need of repair." A new paradigm that helps us interpret and organize our approach to mission for the future has emerged. God is on a mission of transformation and is ***calling out servants to act as catalysts in mobilizing the whole body of Christ to bless the nations through the transformation of people, churches and culture.***

As revealed by this final presentation of the World Inquiry and its findings at the World Evangelization Issues Forum in Pattaya September 29 to October 5, 2004, there are several transformational conclusions that have emerged. In assessing the importance of the process and the resulting conclusions, missiologist Chuck Van Engen, suggests that

> . . . It has the potential of spawning a re-conceptualization of the nature of mission that flows from the fountainhead of the majority church in the majority world, articulated by majority Christians spread now on all six continents. One might say that for the first time since Constantine, over 1600 years ago, the world church has the potential of constructing its understanding of mission with the building blocks drawn from the experience, life, vitality, and vision of churches and missions in the south and east of the globe as well as the north and the west. All this leads to a desire to re-think and re-conceptualize the nature of mission at the beginning of this new century.

The proper conditions are in place for the missiological seed of "mission as transformation" to bud and grow in the years to come. Sang-Bok David Kim writes about the transformation vision on the hearts of the servants of God in places like Southern Africa. Viggo Sogaard summarizes the findings of the World Inquiry quantitative and qualitative survey as a wholistic mission embraced by the whole Church for the whole world. Rene Padilla writes on the transforming Church and mission that will cultivate the growth of the "transformation seed." Richard Howell describes the transformation already taking place in India, where a transformation alliance in North India has already begun to connect separate transformation initiatives. Paul Pierson, in writing on transformation from "the periphery, emerging streams of Church and mission," concludes that there is one word that synthesizes his perception of what is taking place; that word is *transformation*.

After linking the various perceptions from the work of these respected Christians, who have reflected upon the findings of the world Inquiry from different perspectives, we can now draw together some final conclusions. Ten observations emerging out of the three-year global inquiry are as follows:

1. The winds of change are swirling with great intensity around the Christian missionary enterprise at the beginning of the twenty-first century. Our world is changing radically: demographically, economically, politically and religiously. We are in the midst of a time of change in global missions represented by many emerging streams and converging movements of mission.
2. Mission movements are springing from renewal on the historic fields of mission. Renewal movements of the present provide important clues to mission movements of the future. Major new mission initiatives are emerging around the world on the fringes of the larger ecclesiastical structures and missions.
3. Fresh ideas, concepts and their expressions related to God's mission are occurring where there exists a vigorous engagement by the emerging mission initiatives with culture on the mission field. The cutting edge of learning from the encounter with non-believers is happening where oppression and injustices are the most evident. Innovation appears to takes place most often where opposition is the greatest.
4. God leads His people through the Word of God and the burdens, visions and dreams of His servants who are submitted to His will and engaged in His mission. These represent "the new things" of the mission of God. By listening to these burdens and visions we have an indication of what God wants to do in the future.
5. A new epoch of mission is unfolding before our eyes at the beginning of the twenty-first century. We appear to be at a new stage in the worldwide evangelical movement that deserves to be considered carefully.
6. New relationships, alignments and movements are emerging out of new mission realities. There exists a growing need to reinvent missions' structures to accommodate the emerging paradigms of mission.
7. The word *transformation* and its cognates have emerged as an expression of mission throughout the Christian world today. Different transformation streams, each with its own approach, are flowing into a river of transformation. As the river of transformation moves across the earth, individuals, churches, communities, cities and nations are being transformed by the power of God through the people of God for the glory of God.
8. A transformed world is a place where the power, the presence and the peace of God are experienced by all. The power of God is unleashed. The peace of God rules. Shalom-Salaam embrace. The presence of God fills the earth.
9. God is calling for servant-catalysts to bless the nations together with the whole

body of Christ through personal and cultural transformation.

10. Christians are being raised up to motivate and network servant-catalysts worldwide for personal and cultural transformation--both in the churches and in the world--in and through the whole Body of Christ in the name of our Lord Jesus by the power of the Holy Spirit to the glory of God the Father, together blessing the nations.

Arnold Toynbee warned that nineteen of the past twenty-one civilizations have collapsed from within. He asked that "all citizens heed the lessons of history and insist upon the development of a constructive, consistent, and compelling system of values around which personal and social life can be organized, and our educational leaders at all levels provide the active leadership to organize the concerted action required to meet our society's greatest need." Should not God's worldwide Kingdom community lead the way?

After reflecting on reviewing the past one hundred years and especially the last fifty years Van Engen offers the following conclusion:

> An evangelical missiology of transformation builds on classical concepts of mission developed over the last 100 years; overcomes the dichotomies between evangelism and social action that arose 50 years ago; and re-creates itself in a trinitarian praxis of mission appropriate to the global/local challenges, and opportunities of Church and world in this new century.

The good news is that God wants to visit our communities and fill the earth with His presence. Indeed He desires to make them His habitation. But He will not be comfortable in our midst until we remove offending spiritual roots and cultivate an appetite for holiness, unity, faith, humility and prayer. In the end, divine visitation is as much our opportunity and responsibility as it is God's.

God is calling out servants to act as catalysts in the transformation of His Church and in mobilizing the whole body of Christ to bless the nations through the transformation of people, cultures and nations.

Appendix A

If Jesus Were Mayor[83]

By Bob Moffitt

If Jesus were mayor, how would our community change?

We do not want just any vision - God's vision for the people and world He created and loves. Jesus always carried out the will of His Father.[84]

Knowing that, let's imagine: What would Jesus do if He were Mayor?

- What would He do about street children and the homeless?
- What would He do about alcoholism, drug abuse, and other addictions?
- How would He strengthen families?
- How would He promote safe drinking water, adequate housing and food, services, garbage and sewer systems, and decent roads?
- What would He do about fair wages and adequate employment?
- What would He do about unwanted children and care for the sick and elderly?
- What would He do to bring beauty—clean streets, trees, flowers, and public.
- What changes would He make in the education of children and adults?
- What new public policy decisions would He institute?
- How would He help people evaluate problems and make just decisions?
- What would He do to change the way local government works?
- Would His teachings be televised? Would He hold "town meetings" in which agenda and Kingdom principles would be set forth?
- What would He do about crime and civil unrest? What guidelines would for police and community relations?
- What changes would He make in the courts? In the prison systems?
- What would He do about the gap between the rich and the poor?
- How would the "little people" be treated in the community? How would powerful people feel about Him?
- What would He do about corruption and bribery?
- What regulations would He establish for business?
- What would He do about depression, loneliness, and mental illness?
- How would He deal with pornography, sexual immorality, and prostitution?
- What would He do about child and spousal abuse?
- How would He improve social relationships among the citizens?

- What would He do about recreation and entertainment?
- What role would the Church play in the community?
- How would He encourage unity among the churches?
- What would I do about other religions?
- Would His teachings and actions put His life in jeopardy?
- How would the community be changed to reflect the administration's priorities?

We are working in the realm of our imaginations, and there is a caution. Before speculations go off course, I should say what I do and do not mean. Let's use the ground rules to imagine His governance in ways that are compatible with the realities Jesus and the world.

- Jesus' mayoral actions would match the character of God, revealed in Scripture. He would carry out God's will.
- Jesus would not be literally returning in the flesh as a community leader. Instead, we are imagining what would happen if Jesus' character, values, laws, and teachings were the governing basis for our communities.
- Jesus would not establish a theocracy. People would still have free choice, as Scripture indicates.
- Jesus would not create a welfare state. For example, His government would not instantly provide free housing for everyone. He would not instantly and miraculously make everything perfect for all of the citizens. As He did in Scripture, He would involve the citizens in healing the brokenness around them.

We cannot know exactly what Jesus would do as Mayor, but we can study Scriptures and ask the Holy Spirit to reveal what they mean for our communities. We need to know God's character, His Word, and His voice. The things Jesus would do as Mayor would reflect the Father's will for the community. Jesus taught us to pray to our Father: "Your kingdom come, your will be done on earth as it is in heaven." God wants His will done on earth—now—as it is in heaven. He desires this because He loves us and the world He created. He wants the very best for us. As we will learn, He wants to restore everything back to Himself.

Appendix B

A Model of a Group of Believers Prayer for National Transformation: Wales

Origins of this Group

This document is the product of a group of believers meeting together in a number of extended retreats to seek the Lord for miraculous change in the spiritual landscape of Wales. The group is made up of those who could give the time commitments that extended retreats demand. We are not an exclusive "better than others" group; our intent is rather to serve the Body of Christ in Wales. We began meeting in August 1999 and continue to do so three times a year. Out of this we have formed a smaller group who meet every month to give practical shape o some of the insights that we have gained from the retreats.

This group will continue to meet, although it has now probably achieved its ritual task of discerning strategies and principles for our nation. We find the: council to be an effective place of further accountability for each of us. In addition, we sense an intercessory responsibility toward the transformation of our country, and a need to seek God continually as more of his plans and actions for Wales are revealed. We have so benefited from these retreats hat we would like to encourage others to follow our example. During these times we have found the Holy Spirit has been building us into a team and this as resulted in genuine personal accountability and support within a context of friendship and commitment. We are convinced that such retreats, which were surely modelled by Christ himself, would benefit local, regional and national expressions of the Body of Christ.

Origin of this Document.

What follows is essentially a "working document" rather than a polished report. It is a synopsis of what we have gleaned in these retreats over a period of almost two years. We have sought to consider the whole picture, both the established and the new, in regard to Wales. The document includes principles, vision, and strategies. These are being presented here in the hope that they will act as an encouragement to continue or a catalyst to initiate actions leading to the transformation of Wales. The list of strategies includes many items which other groups are already working on, and much in the vision statements that you will recognise as already growing in your own heart. Our efforts have been to consider new possibilities for action, rather than duplicating the valuable work of established ministries.

It is tempting to devote attention to the strategies and their applications and to give less time and consideration to the principles. But we feel strongly that the principles are of primary importance, and are to be ignored at our peril. We have to remember the two different approaches David had when he decided to bring the ark unto Jerusalem. In the first instance the strategy or action was good but the lack of adherence to principles meant the death of Uzzah, one of God's servants. The principles we have listed are old ones, which are familiar to most of us. But the challenge is to so alter our ways of operating that we actually do live out these principles.

Much of what is outlined in this document will be undertaken by a variety of Christian groups already actively in place. But there are, we believe, still serious gaps, and there is a passion in us to ensure that these gaps are filled. A major part of the solution comes as those in leadership begin to inspire and release others to start new things, to encourage and support people who have vision in their hearts but who might not dare to do something until they sense they have 'permission. In addition there are some things that we could implement.

The Challenge

There are approximately 3 million people in Wales and only a maximum of 5% (estimate) of these are Christians in the real sense of the term. Something as to be done about the other 95%. We depend on the will and work of God through the Holy Spirit for a change in this. But we are the labourers and we should prepare for work. This inevitably means the forming of some radically different ways of reaching the lost in our land. It also means that our existing ministries need to change if we are to become effective. Both the established expressions of the Church (traditional and contemporary) and the radical movements that are in various embryonic forms presently need to come together. God has increasingly drawn His people into a complex network of new relationships. A common concern for the spiritual needs of our nation as resulted in people being given grace to cross the traditional, denominational and theological dividing lines to co-operate together. In doing o there has been the rich discovery of the integrity of, and respect for, one anothers lives in Christ.

There are two aspects that we all have to consider. Firstly, we need to discover how and when to put the net on the other side of the boat, how to is under God's direction and how to do this skillfully. Secondly, we need to prepare for processing the harvest. There is an urgent need to develop disciples who depend on God rather than depending on the strength of their leaders or churches. These disciples need from the beginning to realise that heir calling is to mission rather than to comfort. Each group of Christians will have a different and unique task, but we can all share the overall vision for the transformation of Wales and of Wales becoming an apostolic nation to other nations.

One of the principles we have identified below is the need for us to be releasers' rather than 'controllers'. As the Holy Spirit initiates new ministries hat may challenge our preconceptions, we need to pray for true discernment order that we do not stand in the way but rather actively promote His work. his requires a deeper maturity in order that we may affirm and bless one another in our callings and tasks and pray accordingly. The principles may seem obvious and familiar, but we need to revisit them and begin to practice them under God's grace.

The sections which follow are very much in note form, and it should be appreciated that they need considerable explanation. We have tried to limit the occurrence of jargon, but inevitably some will have slipped through.

PRINCIPLES

1. *Passion for His Presence*

Passion for Jesus and for his manifest Presence will become a consuming desire. Alongside intimacy is the need for a clearer revelation of the fear of God. "One thing is needful" continues to act as a constant check in the midst of our activism.

a) Worship is our central calling. In Spirit and Truth, from the heart.
b) Praising God.
c) "One thing only is needful" (Martha and Mary). The banqueting table (Psalm 23).
d) Seeking the Lord's will, listening to God's voice, doing only what we see the Father doing. Obedience to Jesus at all times. Seek and you will find.
e) Holiness.
f) 'Father-heart' of God. Living in the grace and love of God.

2. *Word and Spirit*

A belief that the two prevailing emphases on the authority of the Word of God and the fullness of the Holy Spirit ore meant to be married, and that this happens when we keep Jesus Christ at the centre of all approaches to Scripture and doctrine.

a) Clear holding to the good confession. Apostles' Creed.
b) Taking care to wait for one another to learn from the Lord what is his will.
c) Encouraging and praying for each other to be filled continually with the Holy Spirit.

3. *Non-Religious Christianity*

Living faith versus dead works. Relationship not religion. We get religious when we spiritualise what are merely preferences of our own culture, and when we keep our distance from real relationship with God.

a) Honesty. Creating a culture of transparency, honesty and accountability. Beware of pressures to conform. Know what we believe and why.
b) Generosity of heart. Time, effort, money. Everything belongs to the Lord, not only a 10% share of our money. Such a heart condition makes room for compassion.
c) Church with no walls.
d) Centrality of the Cross in our lives. 2 Kings 7 - lepers at gate with nothing to lose were the ones to discover God's changed situations.
e) Hospitality. Our homes as places Jesus can minister in.
f) Marriages and families must have a proper space, and yet be allowed in the "practice" of revival.

4. *Humility*

Particularly in our relationship with other Christians, any sense of destiny needs to be tempered by a sure knowledge of our human frailty.

a) Knowing and requiring a brokenness and a laying down of our partisan agendas.
b) We will need the help of the Holy Spirit and each other to recognise the "signs of the times", particularly in times of transition.

5. *Relational Unity*

We are called to encourage relational unity centred on Jesus. We are called to encourage healing between the different parts of the Body of Christ out of a deep recognition of our need for one another –

Unity in diversity

a) Recognising the Body of Christ rather than individual denominations in each locality, region and nation. Emphasis on the true identity of the Body of Christ helps people to attach properly into fellowship.
b) Unity via unconditional love rather than through shared vision. Unity for

territory's sake is a useful stepping off point, but not the destination.

c) Good "teams" are a practical expression of such unity, and these can create a platform of spiritual authority in a locality, region, or nation.
d) Praying for one another should be an integral part of meeting together and our commitment to one another.
e) Accountability at every level, via relationships and agreed commitment. Transparency with one or two others for "unshareable" weaknesses and failings.
f) Priesthood of all believers (I Peter 2:9). But also the recognition that authority and anointing are from the Lord and distributed particularly rather than generally, and so we must be careful to live within our callings (cf. Korah's rebellion).
g) 1 for one another's roots and traditions.
h) I to others in the Body of Christ who are not so engaged in the corporate.
i) Networking is part of God's work today, to be honoured and treasured.
j) Reconciliation, and healing of the past. Making restitution if necessary.

6. *Leadership*

Leadership's calling is "to prepare God's people for works of service, so that the body of Christ may be built up..."

a) Releasers not controllers in leadership. Jesus not counting equality with God a thing to be grasped.
b) The apostolic, within team context rather than as solo performers.
c) Authority? Need to reconsider what it really means. The way of the cross. Doing what the Father is doing.
d) Spend real time with the Lord -- to know him and be known by him, fully appreciating the Father's love.
e) Service. Called to serve, not to be served. I Peter 5: 1-4; Mark 10: 42. We are not to Lord it over others, but to be servants.
f) Recognizing times and seasons, flexibility and mobility. Cleared desks. God wants our time - a radical demand. This to work alongside structures that release and provide stability to build from. Ephesians 4:12.
g) Taking a lead; going in front into battle (as captains on the ground, not as generals observing from a distance). Strategic people fully engaged in the battle.
h) Being approachable and dependable. Faithfulness to people as well as to God.

7. *Team Ministry*

Teams are key to the transformation of this land. Teams are built by praying together and spending time together, and by sharing and actively pursuing a vision. The best team builder is the Holy Spirit if we are willing. Choose a team prayerfully because not everyone is sufficiently committed. The actual dynamics of teams press for a revision of our understanding of authority and leadership. They require anointing. servant-hood, meekness and a relationship with God in which revelation is sustained.

a) Wisdom in many counselors
b) Waiting for one another to understand something.
c) True accountability provides a safer environment from which to exercise authority and giftings and for apostolic anointings to emerge and be nurtured.
d) Enjoying diversity.

8. *Priority of the Lost*

Jesus' central purpose on the Earth was to rescue and deliver the lost. This purpose is ours too. Undo the insider mentality by focusing on Jesus' central purpose to reach and save the lost. We need to be a "Church without walls".

a) Go out there.
b) Finance for mission made a priority.
c) Encourage mission as a lifestyle.
d) Holy Spirit's equipping of the Church is to facilitate

effective harvesting and making disciples who reap the harvest.

9. *Discipleship*

Follow Jesus' model for training. Personal time with one another. Less emphasis on 'school' approach and more on seeing and doing. Discipleship is the DNA of our calling rather than merely an appended activity (the Great Commission in Matt 28:18). A process often begun even before conversion by those who need to 'belong before they believe'. There are understandings to be gained of the process of conviction and conversion: of what it means to see people born in strength, released to be what they were always meant to be.

a) Full conversions under the convicting grace of the Holy Spirit. Allow God time to complete the process.
b) Releasing rather than controlling.
c) Fast-track foundational teaching and lifestyle.
d) Fast-track liberation.
e) Holiness. A turning aside from idolatry. Gen 35: 1-8.
f) Taking an ongoing personal responsibility to develop in gift and character and calling, and also helping others to do this.
g) An expectation of all to discover their gifts and take their place in the Kingdom.

10. *Be a Prophetic People*

a) Honouring the prophetic.
b) Encouraging the practice of the prophetic by allowing it to take its rightful place.
c) Effectively discerning what is genuinely of the Spirit. Leaders actively promoting the correct response.
d) Effectively dealing with what is not of the Spirit with sensitivity and wisdom.
e) A good working relationship of unity and trust between leaders and the interceding Body of Christ.
f) Developing schools of prophets.

11. *Creativity*

a) Creativity reflects the worshipping heart of the Nation. The transformation of Wales will include the phenomenon of the arts and crafts of this nation being redirected to the worship and glory of God.
b) Generous and secure contexts need to be given to the arts and artists. Their vulnerabilities resemble those of prophets.

c) Excellence of craftsmanship and performance, an abounding imagination and composition, and works to delight God.

VISION

1. *Wales — A Nation Transformed for the Transforming of other Nations.*

We understand that revival is not the end goal. We can see that revival in 'ales could result in not just an enlivened Church but even the transformation an entire nation. Could such a little nation then become a tool in God's purpose to transform other notions in the world?

2. *Wales to the World- - Wildfire Revival'.*

A concept born out of Martin Scott's prophecy, which carries an element of the "wildness" of our Celtic inheritance. It also carries the "And Suddenly" of resurrection needed in what could be seen as a Lazarus nation. Wildfire revival challenges our preconceptions of what happens when God moves. What II look like in the workplace? In the media? Will we recognise it when it breaks? What will it mean for the shape of Church? Will it be real for families, youth and children, not simply "special" adults?

3. Wales Holding a New Net for a New Harvest.

God is developing networks amongst the variety of Christians, a drawing together of the more traditional churches, the newer ministries, and the embryonic and radical strands into a shared enjoyment of worship and a shored: knowledgement that a different approach is needed to see this nation changed. This is a preparation for the saving of a whole nation. The statement reflects a clear mandate to "cast the net on the other side", a commitment to seek the least, the last and the lost, to catch the uncaught, the any (about 95% of the population) not yet within the kingdom of God in Wales. It means the establishing of cells, congregations, and communities, and building up a group of people who can make this real locally, regionally and nationally. For all of Wales to be transformed, 200,000 "shepherds" need to e raised up, not just in church contexts but also in the workplace, politics, business, media, medicine, arts, and education. This ratio of 1 to 15 of the population would need to increase if Wales were to release mission workers to e nations, which will happen if we work together in expectation toward a snowball effect in discipleship and release.

4. *Wales - A National Church.*

Recognition that God is looking for a genuine unity within the Body of Christ, through reconciliation, networking, shared occasions of worship, and joining together in prayer. The view that the whole nation is a parish, the pastoral responsibility of the Body of Christ in Wales. There is a need for a shared national vision.

5. Wales - A House of Prayer for the Nations.

There seems to be a growing conviction that part of the inheritance of Wales as a Nation is actually to be a “House of Prayer for the Nations”. Can what is possible for a church or even a group of churches be possible for a nation?

6. Wales - - An Apostolic Nation for the Nations.

A nation with authority in the world to bring change and establish new emphases and projects in the Kingdom of God. The gap between where we are and where this statement points to is enormous. It means too that we must become interested in other nations beyond Wales, particularly in an era of globalisation. The most immediate application of this could be in our relationship with Europe, to see a break through in the continent’s resistance to the Gospel.

7. Wales - - Releasing Apostolic Teams.

This is the time for the releasing of new models of the apostolic in Wales, models that will be less hierarchical, more peer-led, with a passion to release and empower others. The idea of the apostolic as expressed in teams rather more than located in individuals. These teams will be flexible and mobile in

nature. Some will be based around the taking of either territory or people groups, others will be part of ministries that break new ground, or they will be there to take and hold "gateways", or as a part of churches that provide resources to others in the nation.

STRATEGIES

Theoretical foundations:

1. God wants to save the entire nation.
2. Take the battle into the enemy's camp (Jonathan and the armour- bearer).
3. The land is 'takeable' under Christ. 'WE', the Body of Christ, can take it together.
4. God is the general, we can only lead as captains under him. Generals watch and consider the battlefield, while captains lead troops into the battle.
5. Prepare the troops for war, but build for the future.
6. Persistence and faith to take the land. Perez (Hebrew for "breakthrough", but also Czech word meaning "wash"). A holy pushing through. "It will fall".
7. Hold what you have taken. No empty spaces. People it with God's people - advance and consolidate, advance and consolidate.

Practical applications:

1. Inspire Christians, particularly leaders, to work and pray together.

   Inspire leaders to work with the Body in prayer and intercession. Create gatherings for specific reason or for specific prayer -- occasional and only as the Lord calls. Encouraging desire for God, and sensitively allowing space and time for the Lord to move His people. Be aware that God may suddenly ambush us, and we need to be willing to put aside our scheduling when this happens. This may mean larger meetings of worship, celebration, teaching, preaching and prayer together. It can create opportunities for fellowship to link established and new nets.

2. Nurture Prayer Movement with its variety of directions and Emphases.

   a) Establish houses of prayer and 24 hour prayer and praise projects.
   b) Prayer and care responsibilities for our neighbours.
   c) Prayer audit, to ensure full cover over Wales, via existing prayer initiatives.

d) Prayer walls and prayer shields.
e) Prayer assault teams.
f) Build capacity through training and releasing of leaders to mobilise prayer teams.
g) Local prayer teams - emerging from local structures, rather than imported or imposed, long-term rather than short-term. Always with idea that Christians need to pray together for their locality.
h) Teams to form for Regional strategies.
i) Provide retreat places and encourage the practice of retreats.
j) Use websites to facilitate prayer.

3. Heal the Land. (There is an overlap with section 2).

a) Reconciliation ministry.
b) Issues of language.
c) Identify and deal with historic wounds and strongholds, in regions, localities, and between Wales and other nations (including England).
d) Spiritual research, both nationally and locally or regionally.
e) First the prophetic intercessors, and then the Body of Christ as a whole.
f) Strategic reclamation of territory as necessary.
g) Need for a stronger and wider team to represent and understand all parts of Wales.
h) Importance of timing and coordination in the taking of key strongholds.

4. 'Gateway' locations and ministries.

What is a gateway? It is a key place or person (or people) that God can use as an 'opening' for His purposes. It is apparent that certain people, locations and events are particularly strategic. There is the thought that a gate can be opened or shut. Identify, encourage and network - these will include key individuals, territories, and break-through / pioneering ministries. Apostolic teams need to play a part in this, by identifying, encouraging and helping these to connect with others. There are key areas of national life and culture, and occupations and professions that need to be taken. Be aware of the need to nurture and develop relationships between established and new nets.

a) Need to provide resources in finances, time, prayer, and personnel in key areas.
b) Stand with those who are already functioning as 'gateways' for God.

5. Nurturing and honoring the Prophetic. Recognizing its importance.

   a) Develop 'schools for prophets'.
   b) Encourage the practice of the prophetic - desiring that all should prophesy (Moses and Paul).
   c) Develop relational unity between leaders and those interceding.
   d) Learn from those nations/people who have a greater understanding of these things.

6. Mobilize to reap the harvest.

   Time to call forth the mobilizers to reach the children, youth, the poor, and the broken, to call up a radical army for today. Time to raise up 200,000 shepherd-releasers. 'Rural requisition' - The need for an effective strategy for the rural parts of Wales.

7. Discipleship.

   Before conversion. Awareness that many need to 'belong' before they 'believe'. Recognition of the need for God to do a complete work of conviction before conversion and for an individual to be 'born in strength'.

   There is a need to provide an initial injection of concentrated teaching of good, clear and full instruction on essential Christian doctrine and an introduction to the Bible. In addition there would be a 'liberation' package, to get people thoroughly cleaned up from the past at the start of their lives as Christians, and to help them learn how to walk in righteousness.

   The active disciple. Use an adaptable 'portfolio' package that can be used within a congregation, group, team, or as a personally-tailored programme. The disciple would be given a list of principles/teachings that need to become a genuine part in his or her life. The areas can be tackled in any order and in a variety of ways, according to the personality of the disciple and his or her lifestyle constraints. It is Important that the emphasis is on both understanding and living out what is learned. The disciple needs to be mission-minded from the start.

   The importance of developing Increasing numbers of shepherd/releasers - those who understand and live out the principles and teach and release new believers rather than control them. The need for the disciple to become more strongly attached to Jesus, than to the person who is serving as mentor. Relational

mentoring to continue in one form or another throughout the life of the believer.

The expectation that new disciples will actively take up their new role within an ever-expanding Body of believers. A recognition that only true obedience to the leading of the Holy Spirit yields lasting results for the Kingdom of God.

8. Exercise spiritual authority.

This needs to happen in the political, economic, and religious gates of the nation. It is time to stand in a new level of authority - Esther 8:8 - write a decree concerning the Jews as you please in the King's name." Together with this is the determination that we should take the battle to what has become the enemy's camp (as Jonathan and his armour-bearer did).

The establishment of groups, which resemble teams but are formed for a definite goal. They may or may not be mobile. They may function as prayer, ministry, or consultative units alongside the Assembly, television, hospitals, education, sports, the arts.

To encourage the developing of city, town, rural or area elderships and the exercising of authority on a geographical basis in a spirit of humility.

FINAL OBSERVATIONS

1. This is not just a prayer movement. It is a plan to bring Wales into the kingdom of God. It includes discipleship and the use of teams.
2. Much of what we need to do involves creating openings for the Lord to set His ambushes in people's lives. So much depends on God's presence and empowering.
3. We must always be aware of our past failures, where we have tended to "do" things for God rather than to "wait on His will or pleasure" and then obey.
4. "We" includes everyone who loves God and seeks to serve him in this land, not just the small group we associate easily with.
5. Much of what is listed here is not new; the challenge is to live out the principles and to put into play the strategies. It is not our intention to take up a monopoly on the implementation of these matters, which should fall to the whole Body of Christ in Wales. We believe that much of this material could be applicable to any church or ministry, as well as to new initiatives.
6. Seeking God for His specific will mean change and costly choices, reflecting Jesus who gave everything for us.

Appendix C

Transformation: Mission In A Global World

By Rolf Zwick[85]

Globalization in economics and politics challenges us to develop appropriate concepts for mission and the Church. During the past twenty years the term "Mission as Transformation" described a holistic view of mission.

Background

In preparation for the first 1974 Lausanne Congress in Switzerland, the 1973 Chicago Declaration of Evangelical Concern was issued which called on "evangelical Christians to demonstrate repentance in a Christian discipleship that confronts the social and political injustice". At the Lausanne Congress Dr. René Padilla and Dr. Samuel Escobar from Latin America gave public expression to a missiological understanding that focused on the whole Gospel for the whole person, in their social, political, economic, cultural and religious contexts. The Lausanne Covenant included the emphasis on social concern as part of Christian mission in its paragraphs four and five.[86]

Many projects in the Two-Thirds World already worked with an integrative approach of evangelism and social responsibility but without having reflected on it theologically. In a series of consultations a biblical basis and theological reflection on the relationship of evangelism and social concern took place. At the 1983 Wheaton Conference in the USA a statement on transformation was issued in the track on "The Church in Response to Human Need". It made clear that mission always expresses itself in transformation which means a "change from a condition of human existence contrary to God's purposes to one in which people are able to enjoy fullness of life in harmony with God". This concerns the individual as well as society.

International Fellowship of Mission Theologians

During the 1980s an international network called the International Fellowship of Mission Theologians, INFEMIT, was founded in order to coordinate the theological reflection on mission in the field of poverty and wealth, development as part of mission and contextual evangelism. The leadership of this fellowship included personalities, like René Padilla, Samuel Escobar, Vinay Samuel, Ronald Sider, Bishop David Gitarri, Kwame Bediako, Peter Kuzmic and Chris Sugden. The fellowship organized consultations, opened the Oxford Centre for Mission Studies in 1985 in Great Britain and published numerous books

and the theological magazine “Transformation.”

Toward a Trinitarian Theology

In the 1990s, the understanding of transformation was explored in the area of economics and environment. Also the dialog with the Pentecostal movement was intensified. In this process the theology was sharpened concerning God as creator and humanity as the steward of creation and concerning the role of the Holy Spirit for transformation. The former focus on Jesus Christ as basis for mission was broadened. With the view of God as Creator and the Spirit as a power for transformation the theology became more Trinitarian.

Meeting Twenty-first Century Challenges

After the end of the cold war in 1989, the establishment of only one world power, the influence of postmodern values in all areas of life, and globalization, the challenges to mission have changed again. Entering the twenty-first century the economic and political world in the West has affirmed the priority of the self in the globalization of economies, the dominance of the market and the retreat from state control of business or economic life. At the same time, the power game after September 11, 2001 has left the issue of justice behind.

A theology of transformation can be seen as an appropriate approach to the world as it is. First of all the theology of the kingdom brings us to reflect on kingdom values in times when revenge, hatred, and strife for economic wealth top the agenda of politics and economics. In the field of local engagement transformation theology looks for freedom and power for the poor, reconciliation and solidarity for the weak. In this an integral relation between evangelism and social change comes to the open.

As kingdom workers we are building communities of change in a given context. To arrive there Bible study is crucial and has to be done cross-culturally. At the same time, the structure of the local congregation has to become a liberating, merciful and powerful body. In fact it is the body of Christ in the midst of this world.

Jesus, Lord over All

We want to express the Lordship of Jesus over every aspect of life, economic, religious, personal and political. It does not give priority to any area of life as an area for mission, but insists that the change of a person through the Holy Spirit is at the heart of all real change. This change will effect change in the community and environment, whenever people address issues of life, rooted in a Gospel perspective. “Mission as Transformation” will strengthen civil society so that society as a whole experiences and expresses Christian

values of justice and righteousness.

The Bible in the Two-Thirds World was often seen as an instrument of white, male and wealthy cultures. But mission is determined by the incarnation of Jesus and his sacrifice on the cross. This contrasts all mission strategies not rooted in the context of the people they are aimed at. It also contrasts all pain-avoiding concepts of mission which speak of easy success.

Appendix D

Peruvian Unified Code Of Ethics For The Industry Of Commercial Communications

I. Scope

The Values and Principles and their guidelines included in this document refer strictly to the relationship among those that participate in the activities of Commercial Communications who, for the purposes of this of this Code are the Advertisers, Advertising Agencies and the Media, with the general public.

The Values and Ethical Principles and their guidelines established in this code are relevant to all that participate in activities of commercial communications, be it Advertisers, Advertising Agencies and Media, regardless of their being or not members of their respective trade associations.

This code has been developed in accordance with:

A) The Code of Advertising Ethics of Peru issued which in turn incorporates the International Code of advertising Practices issued by the International Chamber of Commerce.
B) The 1997 Advertising Ethics Handbook issued by the Vatican's Office of Social Communications.
C) The Declaration of Ethical Principles of the International Broadcasting Association issued in Lima in 1955 and Buenos Aires in 1985.
D) The Peruvian National Advertisers Association Code of Advertising Ethics.
E) The Peruvian Association of Advertising Agencies Code of Ethics and Creativity.

This Code of Ethics will be effective July 1st, 2001.

II. Fundamental Values And Principles For The Commercial Communications Industry

1. Truthfulness

The contents of every communication must be truthful and complete and transmitted in an appropriate and honest manner. This includes the obligation of avoiding the manipulation

of truth for whatever reasons.

a) The sources of information must be identifiable, reliable and verifiable. However, the right to protect the confidentiality of sources in relevant subjects related to public interest.
b) Proof of the accuracy of the information transmitted will be presented or will be made available on request.
c) The results of investigations will be presented in a manner that is clear and complete to the public.
d) The public will not be deceived by ambiguity, inaccuracy, omission or incompleteness of the information.

3. Respect To The Dignity Of The Human Person

The respect for the human person, its intimacy, its right and obligation of making responsible decisions and its freedom of choice is imperative. In this regards, any communication that is based on the exploitation of the human being's lowest inclinations or that may compromise its ability to ponder or its freedom of choice is prohibited. Special care must be taken when addressing specially vulnerable groups such as children, the elderly, the poor and people with limited education.

a) The intimacy of the individual will be respected.
b) The image of the human person, especially that of women and children, will not be presented in indecent, dishonest or offensive ways.
c) There will be no discrimination, nor invitations to discrimination based on race, religion, sex, sexual orientation, cultural or economic level, physical limitations, etc..
d) No use will be made of representations or words that denigrate, make ridicule or in any manner offend human dignity.

3. *Social Responsibility*

An authentic vision of human growth in its material, cultural and spiritual dimensions must be communicated. A rigorous respect for moral, cultural and spiritual requirements and responsible social practices must be promoted based on the dignity of the individual, the identity of the community, starting with the family and religious institutions as well with the respect of its democratic authorities, public and private institutions and national symbols.

a) The respect to democratic authorities, institutions and national symbols will be promoted.
b) The image of the family will be respected.

c) Children will not be exposed to material intended for adults.
d) Positive values of human conduct must be presented.
e) No material will be transmitted that promotes or celebrates conducts that are immoral, rude, obscene, antisocial or criminal in nature.
f) Superstitions will not be exploited.
g) No use will be made of fear or affliction unless it is to discourage unhealthy or unsafe practices.
h) No use will be made of bad language (Does not restrict the use of idioms and popular expressions whenever the characters or situation so requires)

ENDNOTES

Preface

[1] See Appendix C, Transformation: Mission in a Global World, by Rolf Zwick for a commentary on the relevance of this paradigm for mission for the twenty-first century and some of the catalytic events, individuals and structures that brought this focus into being.

[2] Stott, John. *Christian Mission in the Modern World.* (Downers Grove, IVP, 1976) p. 10.

[3]. *missio Dei* was introduced at the Fifth International Missionary Council Meeting in Willingen, Germany in 1952. George Vicedom wrote the first major study of *missio Dei* in 1965. Understanding *missio Dei* helps to understand the heart of God for the world. However, with time the *missio Dei* motif became the expression along which missiological understanding flowed in ever broadening and deepening conceptualizations. *missio Dei* became a dynamic rather than a static concept, adapting to contextual and historical pulsations rather than anchored to a biblical foundation. In using the term in the purpose of inquiry the conceptualization of *missio Dei* as the pure mission of God is emphasized. Mission has its origin in the fatherly heart of God. God is the protagonist in the mission and every Christian believer is called to become an active participant in *missio Dei.*

[4] J. Dudley Woodberry, "Toward the 21st Century: Educating People for God's Mission." (Pasadena, CA: School of World Mission, Fuller Theological Seminary). Accessed May 19, 2004. <http://www.fuller.edu/swm/main/vision.html>.

[5] Wilbert R. Shenk, "Recasting Theology of Mission: Impulses from the Non-Western World." *International Bulletin of Missionary Research* 25(3), 2001: 98-107.

[6] Majority World (MW) is the current term used to refer to what was previously known as the developing countries, Third World, or Two-Thirds World.

Introduction

[7]Bryant Myers, *World Vision Intl.*

[8]Jack Dennison, *CitiReach*.

[9]George Otis, Jr. *The Sentinel Group*.

[10]Wheaton '83, sponsored by the World Evangelical Fellowship, provided a platform for further clarification of the response to human need among evangelicals. In the book containing the presentations made at the "Consultation on the Church in Response to Human Need," edited by the co-presenters of the topic "Evangelism and Social Responsibility" a year earlier, Vinay Samuel and Chris Sugden, the final document titled "Transformation" reflects, by its very name, the call for societal transformation (Samuel and Sugden 1987:254-265).

[11]Vinay Samuel and Chris Sugden, eds., "Introduction," *Mission as Transformation*, (Regnum, 1999).

[12]Jack Dennison, *City Reaching: On the Road to Community Transformation* (Pasadena, CA: William Carey Library, 1999).

[13]Adapted from *Evangelism and Social Responsibility,* written during the international Consultation on the Relationship between Evangelism and Social Responsibility, held at Grand Rapids, Michigan, June 19-25, 1982 in which the term transformation replaces kingdom.

Chapter 1

[14] Report received on July 16, 2004 from Ronaldo Faria, Executive Secretary of the Brazil Transformation Project (*Secretário do Projeto Transformação Brasil*)

[15] Article written by Henry Chu, Times Staff Writer, June 7, 2004, titled "Moved by the Spirit to Govern," accessed June 13, 2004
<http://www.latimes.com/la-fg-evangelicals7jun07,1,1066933.story > Moved by the Spirit to Govern

Chapter 2

[16] Iman Santoso (Indonesia) was born in Jakarta. He is the Chairman of the Great Commission Roundtable. He served as a General Secretary of Indonesian IVCF after laying the foundation and pioneering IVCF ministry in 25 cities throughout Indonesia (1972 – 1983). He has been leading LINK Foundation since 1989. LINK has been functioning as a bridge for Churches and Christian organizations through many different networks. Among them are: National Prayer Network, National Research Network, Mission Network, Media Ministry Network, etc. Among his writings are: "The Church in Indonesia", "The National Prayer Network and Christian Unity in Indonesia", "Church in Indonesia".

[17]Born in Jakarta , Indonesia and Married in 1996 to Tety Kotandengan with two children, Nadia (Jan,1998) and Kaleb (Sep,1999). From 1992 to 1998 Irwan worked as Chemical Engineering in Chemical Factory. Since 1998 , he has been the executive secretary of National Research Network /PJRN , a network whose vision is to research the unreached people groups in Indonesia, mobilize churches to involve in mission and send Indonesian Christian to the world. He is a candidate for MA degree in Missiology at Institute for Community and Development Studies, Jakarta.

[18] Rafael Navarro (Philippines): Chito as he is known to friends, is planting churches amongst the urban and tribal poor in the Philippines, and also concurrently Director and Founder of the Foundation for Transformational Development (a poverty alleviation program). He has an engineering degree, a doctorate in ministries, and is an ordained pastor and church planter. In the past, he was a director of World Vision Philippines, director of Church Growth with the Philippines Council of Evangelical Churches, and International Training Coordinator of World Evangelical Fellowship, among other positions. Responding to the poverty in Asia, he established the Foundation for Transformational Development that provides low cost housing technology, appropriate technologies for food production and health maintenance and cooperatives.

[19]Jim Herrington is a pastor in Houston's inner city. He is the founder of Mission Houston and is co-author of two books on pastoral leadership: Leading Congregational Change and The Leaders Journey.

[20]Laura Sorrell is co-owner of Meridian Consulting, a excutive placement firm in Houston, TX. She has been instrumental in the development and implementation a city wide research process that is unprecedented in North America's.

Chapter 3

[21] "President Museveni explains Uganda's success in combating AIDS." Accessed August 21, 2004. <http://www.afrol.com/News/uga003_aids_success.htm>

[22] "Ugandan first lady honored for support of abstinence promotion," Jun 23, 2004, by Shawn Hendricks. Accessed August 21, 2004. < http://www.sbcbaptistpress.org/bpnews.asp?Id=18556>

Chapter 4

[23] Vishal and Ruth Mangalwadi discovered William Carey while fighting the revival of Sati (widow-burning). Vishal followed up his study of Western missions in India with two further books, *Missionary Conspiracy: Letters to a Postmodern Hindu* (1996) and *India: The Grand Experiment* (1997) which led Christianity Today to describe him as "India's foremost Christian intellectual." Vishal & Ruth have lived with untouchable peasants in mud-huts. Vishal has served God in prison, at the headquarters of two national political parties, authored 13 books, and lectured in 28 countries. Currently the Mangalwadis are producing a television series entitled, *The Book of the Millennium.*

[24] In 1992, we stand at the 200th anniversary of two key events that launched Carey into his 40-year missionary career. In 1792 he published *An Inquiry into the Obligations of Christians to Use Means for the Conversion of the Heathen . . .* " (Beals 1992).

Chapter 5

[25]Howard A. Snyder serves as Professor of the History and Theology of Mission at Asbury Theological Seminary, Wilmore, Kentucky. Previously he pastored in Chicago and Detroit, and he and his wife served as Free Methodist missionaries in Brazil, 1968-75. His Ph.D. in historical theology is from the University of Notre Dame (1983). His books include The Problem of Wineskins (1975), The Community of the King (1977; rev. ed., 2004), and, with Dan Runyon, Decoding the Church: Mapping the DNA of Christ's Body (2002). He was a plenary speaker at the 1974 International Congress on World Evangelization in Lausanne, Switzerland.

[26] See in particular Vinay Samuel and Chris Sugden, *Mission as Transformation: A Theology of the Whole Gospel* (Irvine, CA: Regnum Books International, 1999).

[27] Sandra Richter, "Stewardship of the Environment: A Christian Value," unpublished paper, Asbury Theological Seminary, 2004.

[28] Francis A. Schaeffer, *Pollution and the Death of Man: The Christian View of Ecology* (Wheaton, IL: Tyndale House, 1970), 66-68.

[29] The biblical meaning of "economy of God" is more fully elaborated in Howard A. Snyder, *Liberating the Church: The Ecology of Church and Kingdom* (Downers Grove, IL: InterVarsity, 1983; Eugene, OR: Wipf & Stock, 1996), chapter 2, "The Economy of God."

[30] Charles Colson with Ann Morse, "Reclaiming Occupied Territory," *Christianity Today*, August 2004, 64.

[31] G. K. Chesterton, *The Everlasting Man* (London: Hodder and Stoughton, 1927), 247.

[32] Calvin B. DeWitt, "Ecology and Ethics: Relation of Religious Belief to Ecological Practice in the Biblical Tradition," *Biodiversity and Conservation* 4 (1995), 838-48.

[33] Here Pentecostal and Charismatic Christians have a key contribution to make, exploring the contribution of the doctrine of the Holy Spirit to issues of environmental stewardship.

Chapter 6

[34] William (Bill) O'Brien serves as the President of the American Missiological Society.

[35]Jones, E. Stanley, *Is The Kingdom of God Realism? (* New York: Abingdom-Cokesbury, 1940), p. 60

[36]Ladd, George Eldon. *The Presence of the Future*. (Grand Rapids, MI: Eerdmans, 1974), p. 320.

[37]Newbigin, Lesslie. *Mission In Christ's Way* (Geneva, Switzerland: WCC Publications, 1987), p. 2.

[38]Ladd, George Eldon. *The Presence of the Future*. (Grand Rapids, MI: Eerdmans, 1974), p. 265.

[39]Willard, Dallas. *The Divine Conspiracy*. (San Francisco: Harper Collins, 1998), pp. 385-386.

[40]Willard, Dallas. *The Divine Conspiracy*. (San Francisco: Harper Collins, 1998), pp. 367-368.

Chapter 8

[41] See "Transformation vs. Reformation," Roger Armbruster, FCA Leadership, Vol. 3, No. 8, August 2001, p. 3. FCA Leadership is a journal of the Fellowship of Christian Assemblies, and is published monthly by Fellowship Press, 4909 East Buckeye Road, Madison, WI 53716-1898.

[42] John Milton, Area Pagitica (1644), p. 31.

[43] Oswald Chambers, *So I Send You* (City?: Marshall, Morgan and Scott Publications Ltd., 1988), pp. 35-36.

[44] Armbruster, "Transformation vs. Reformation," p. 3.

[45] Edwards, pp. 231, 232.

Chapter 9

[46] Marketplaces come in many forms, flavors, and textures, but each is reflective of the people and culture to which it belongs. Consider the almost infinite, contrasting variety: the Great Silk Trade Route of Marco Polo, the Plaka of ancient Greece, the forum of the Roman Empire, the stock market on

today's Wall Street, the Ponte Vecchio of Florence, the Bazaar of Istanbul, the shops and street carts of Kowloon, the commodities markets in Chicago, the factories of Nanking, Piccadilly Circus in London, the Ginza in Tokyo, the Plaza in Santa Fe, the floating market of Bangkok, the flower market in Almaty, Kazakhstan, the farmers market in Londrina, Brazil, the spiced market of Tashkent, Uzbekistan, the city markets of Arusha, Tanzania, Cuzco, Peru, and Juarez, Mexico, and the flea markets and the black markets in every corner of the world. In spite of their diversity, all have one thing in common. All involve people seeking to trade goods, to barter wares, and to earn money in order to survive, then thrive, with the hope and goal of positively transforming their lives at the global, national, state and personal levels.

[47] See Laura Nash and Scotty McLennan's eye-opening, Harvard-based research on the relationship between the business community and church leaders in *Church on Sunday, Work on Monday: The Challenge of Fusing Christian Values with Business Life*. San Francisco, CA: Jossey-Bass (2001).

[48] There are many causes for this antipathy, but three factors that have fueled the discord deserve special mention, but that are beyond the limitations of this paper: the sacred-secular divide; the Holy Hierarchy; and mammon—each of which is based on misguided and unbiblical perceptions.

[49] See my article, "Toward a Marketplace Missiology," in *Missiology: An International Review*, Vol. XXXI, No. 1, January 2003, published by the American Society of Missiology.

Chapter 10

[50] "The Transformed Person" is the first in a series of six Bible studies on transformed living being developed by Michael Cassidy, who has more than 40 years ministry experience in Africa and around the world.

Chapter 11

[51] Ed Pousson lectures in Bible and missions in Theological Centre for Asia, Singapore. He has ministered in Asia for 14 years and has worked with various committees and networks mobilizing missions to unreached peoples. Before that he served in Haiti and Africa. He has written one book on missions, (*Spreading the Flame*, Zondervan 1992), and several articles and prayer guides. He has a Doctor of Missiology from Fuller Seminary, where he served as a teaching assistant to Dr. C. Peter Wagner. Ed and his wife Lai Kheng have two sons ages 21, 18, and a daughter, age 12.

Chapter 12

[52]Originally titled: *Social Transformation: The Church in Response to Human Need* this was the Wheaton '83 Statement made by the participants at the Consultation on the Church in Response to Human Need, one of three consultations held at Wheaton '83. In the book containing the presentations made at the consultation edited by the co-presenters of the topic "Evangelism and Social Responsibility" a year earlier, Vinay Samuel and Chris Sugden, the final document titled "Transformation" reflects, by its very name, the call for societal transformation (Samuel and Sugden 1987:254-265). In 1999 *Mission as Transformation A Theology of the Whole Gospel, published by* Regnum Books, the authors bring together twenty-five years of biblical reflection on mission practice with the poor from around the world.

Chapter 13

[53]Van Engen, Charles, Dean Gilliland and Paul Pierson, edits. *The Good News of the Kingdom: Mission Theology for the Third Millennium*. (N.Y.: Orbis, 1993), p. 1.

[54] I believe one of the greatest obstacles to world evangelization today is the persistent hang-over of the "3-self formula." Holding too tightly to that introverted and institutionally-ossified formula as the goal of missions activities has tended to created churches all over the world that exhibit a fourth "self:" selfish.

[55] For a summary treatment of this view, see C. Van Engen: 2000 and C. Van Engen: 2001.

[56]This development began with the 1938 meeting of the International Missionary Council in Tambaram, India (International Missionary Council 1938). See C. Van Engen 1996:148-149.

[57]For a look at some of the developments in this way of thinking, see C. Van Engen 1996:145-158.

[58] Henry, Carl. *The Uneasy Conscience of Modern Fundamentalism*. (G.R.: Eerdmans, 1947).

[59]McGavran, Donald. *Understanding Church Growth*. (G.R.: Eerdmans, 1970), p.35.
Wagner, C. Peter. *Church Growth: State of the Art*. (Wheaton: Tyndale, 1989), p. 16.
For a summary treatment of these developments in Evangelical Protestant mission theology, see C. Van Engen: 1990.

[60]See, e.g., Donald McGavran 1977.

[61]It is hard to underestimate the impact that the move to integrate the IMC into the WCC at the New Delhi conference of the IMC in 1961 had on Evangelical mission theology. see C. Van Engen: 1996, 132-133, particularly footnotes 19-22 and 1996:150, footnote 14.

[62] Van Engen, C. *Mission on the Way: Issues in Mission Theology*. (G. R.: Baker, 1996) pp. 128-136.

[63] Lindsell, Harold. "Faith Missions since 1938" in Wilbur C. Harr 1962, edit.: 230.

[64]See, e.g., John A. Mackay 1963:13; J.C. Hoekendijk 1966: 108 and C. Van Engen 1981:382; C. Van Engen 1996:150.

[65] R.K. Orchard, *Witness in Six Continents*, 1964.

[66]Cf. David Bosch 1980: 167.

[67] Van Dusen, Henry. *One Great Ground of Hope: Christian Missions and Christian Unity*. (Phil.: Westminster, 1961).
Vicedom, Georg. *The Mission of God: An Introduction to a Theology of Mission*. (St. Louis: Concordia, 1965).

[68]Williams, Colin. *Where in the World*. (N.Y.: NCCC, 1963).
Williams, Colin. *What in the World*. (N.Y.: NCCC, 1964).
World Council of Churches. *The Church for Others and the Church for the World.* (Geneva: WCC, 1968).

[69]See, e.g., H.H. Rosin, "*Missio Dei:* An Examination of the Origin, Content and Function of the Term in Protestant Missiological Discussion;" 1972; James Scherer 1987: 93-125; James Scherer, "Church, Kingdom, and *Missio Dei*: Lutheran and Orthodox Correctives to Recent Ecumenical Mission Theology 1993: 82-88"; Johannes Verkuyl: 1978: 328-331; 197-204; David Bosch 1980: 242-248; 1991: 389-393;C. Van Engen 1981:277-279, 305-323; 1991: 108; 1996: 150-153; Andrew Kirk 1999: 229; Jan Jongeneel and Jan van Engelen 1995: 447-448; Jan Jongeneel 1997: 59-61; D.T. Niles. 1962; George Vicedom "*Missio Dei*" in Stephen Neill, Gerald H. Anderson and John Goodwin, edits. 1971: 387; John McIntosh, "*Missio Dei*" in Moreau, Netland and Van Engen, edits. Evangelical Dictionary of World Missions, 2000, 631-633; Lesslie Newbigin The Open Secret 1978: 20-31; Roger Bassham 1979: 67-71.)

[70]Stephen Neill 1959: 81; quoted by Johannes Blauw 1962:109.

[71]See, e.g., C. Van Engen. *God's Missionary People: Rethinking the Purpose of the Local Church*. (G.R.: Baker 1991) pp. 101-118.

[72]The first major publication of the Latin American Theological Fraternity (LATF) was entitled, El Reino de Dios y América Latina (The Kingdom of God and Latin America). Since then the LATF has consistently emphasized what Padilla and others have called "integral mission." See, e.g., Orlando Costas 1974; 1982; Mortimer Arias 1980, 1984, 1998, 2003; René Padilla 1986; Samuel Escobar 1998; 1999; 2002; Timothy Carriker 1992; and Valdir Steuernagel 1991, 1992

[73]Cf., e.g., John Mbiti 2003.

[74]One way that I have attempted to do this is to borrow from Stephen Neill's definition of mission "the intentional crossing of barriers from Church to non-church in word and deed for the sake of the proclamation of the Gospel" (Neill: 1984 video). I define mission as follows. "God's mission works primarily through the People of God intentionally crossing barriers from Church to non-church and faith to non-faith, to proclaim by word and deed the coming of the Kingdom of God in Jesus Christ through the Church's participation in God's mission of reconciling people to God, to themselves, to each other, and to the world and gathering them into the Church through repentance and faith in Jesus Christ by the work of the Holy Spirit with a view to the transformation of the world as a sign of the coming of the Kingdom in Jesus Christ."

[75]Interestingly, all the English language translations I checked translated this with "be transformed." The New English translated the verse as, "Adapt yourselves no longer to the pattern of this present world, but let your minds be remade and your whole nature thus transformed. Then you will be able to discern the will of God, and to know what is good, acceptable and perfect."

[76]Verkuyl, Johannes. *Contemporary Missiology: An Introduction*. (G.R.: Eerdmans, 1978), pp. 197-204.

[77]Verkuyl, Johannes. *Contemporary Missiology: An Introduction*. (G.R.: Eerdmans, 1978), p. 31.

[78]Van Engen, C. *God's Missionary People: Rethinking the Purpose of the Local Church*. (G.R.: Baker, 1991), pp. 87-132.

[79] Boer, Harry. *Pentecost and Missions*. (G.R.: Eerdmans, 1961).

[80] See. C. Van Engen, "Faith, Love, and Hope: A Theology of Mission-on-the-Way," in *Mission on the Way*, 1996, 253-262.

[81]Bavinck, J.H. *An Introduction to the Science of Missions*. (N.J.: Presbyterian and Reformed, 1977), p.155.

Bosch, David. *Witness to the World The Christian Mission in Theological Perspective*. (Atlanta: John Knox, 1980), pp. 126-127.

Verkuyl, Johannes. *Contemporary Missiology: An Introduction*. G.R.: Eerdmans, 1978), p. 21.

Moreau, Scott, Harold Netland and Charles Van Engen, edits 2000, *Evangelical Dictionary of World Missions*. (G.R.: Baker), p. 1002

[82] Newbigin, Lesslie. *The Gospel in a Pluralist Society.* (G.R., Eerdmans, 1989), pp. 222-223.

Appendix A

[83]From an unpublished manuscript, *If Jesus Were Mayor.* Quoted with permission from the author. Bob Moffitt is the Founder and Executive Director of Harvest.

[84]John 15:10; John 5:19

Appendix C

[85]Rolf Zwick , from Germany, has led a city wide youth ministry in Essen, Germany since 1996. Before that he was a parish pastor in Wuppertal, Germany for nine years. Before that he served as a pastor with the Methodist Church in South Africa and the South African Council of Churches. He is member of the board of directors of the Oxford Centre for Mission Studies.

[86]5. Christian Social Responsibility

We affirm that God is both the Creator and the judge of all men. We therefore should share his concern for justice and reconciliation throughout human society and for the liberation of men from every kind of oppression. Because mankind is made in the image of God every person regardless of race, religion, color, culture, class, sex, or age has an intrinsic dignity because of which he should be respected and served, not exploited. Here too we express penitence both for our neglect and for having sometimes regarded evangelism and social concern as mutually exclusive. Although reconciliation with man is not reconciliation with God nor is social action evangelism, nor is political liberation salvation, nevertheless we affirm that evangelism and sociopolitical involvement are both part of our Christian duty. For both are necessary expressions of our doctrines of God and man, our love for our neighbor and our obedience to Jesus Christ. The message of salvation implies also a message of judgment upon every form of alienation, oppression and discrimination and we should not be afraid to denounce evil and injustice wherever they exist. When people receive Christ

they are born again into his kingdom and must seek not only to exhibit but also to spread his righteousness in the midst of an unrighteous world. The salvation we claim should be transforming us in the totality of our personal and social responsibilities. Faith without works is dead.
(Acts 17:26,31: Gen. 18:25; Isa. 1:17; Psa. 45:7; Gen. 1:26, 27; Jas. 3:9; Lev 19:18; Luke 6:27, 35; Jas. 2:14-26; John 3:3-5; Matt. 5:20; 6:33; II Cor 3:18; Jas. 2:20)

6. The Church and Evangelism

We affirm that Christ sends his redeemed people into the world as the Father sent him and that this calls for a similar deep and costly penetration of the world. We need to break out of our ecclesiastical ghettos and permeate non-Christian society. In the Church's mission of sacrificial service evangelism is primary. World evangelization requires the whole Church to take the whole Gospel to the whole world. The Church is at the very center of God's cosmic purpose and is his appointed means of spreading the Gospel. But a church which preaches the cross must itself be marked by the cross. It becomes a stumbling block to evangelism when it betrays the Gospel or lacks a living faith in God, a genuine love for people, or scrupulous honesty in all things rather than an institution, and must not be identified with any particular culture, social or political system or human ideology.
(John 17:18; 20:21; Matt. 28:19-20; Acts 1:8; 20:27; Eph. 1:9,10; 3:9-11; Gal. 6:14; II Cor. 6:3-4; II Tim. 2:19-21; Phil. 1:27)